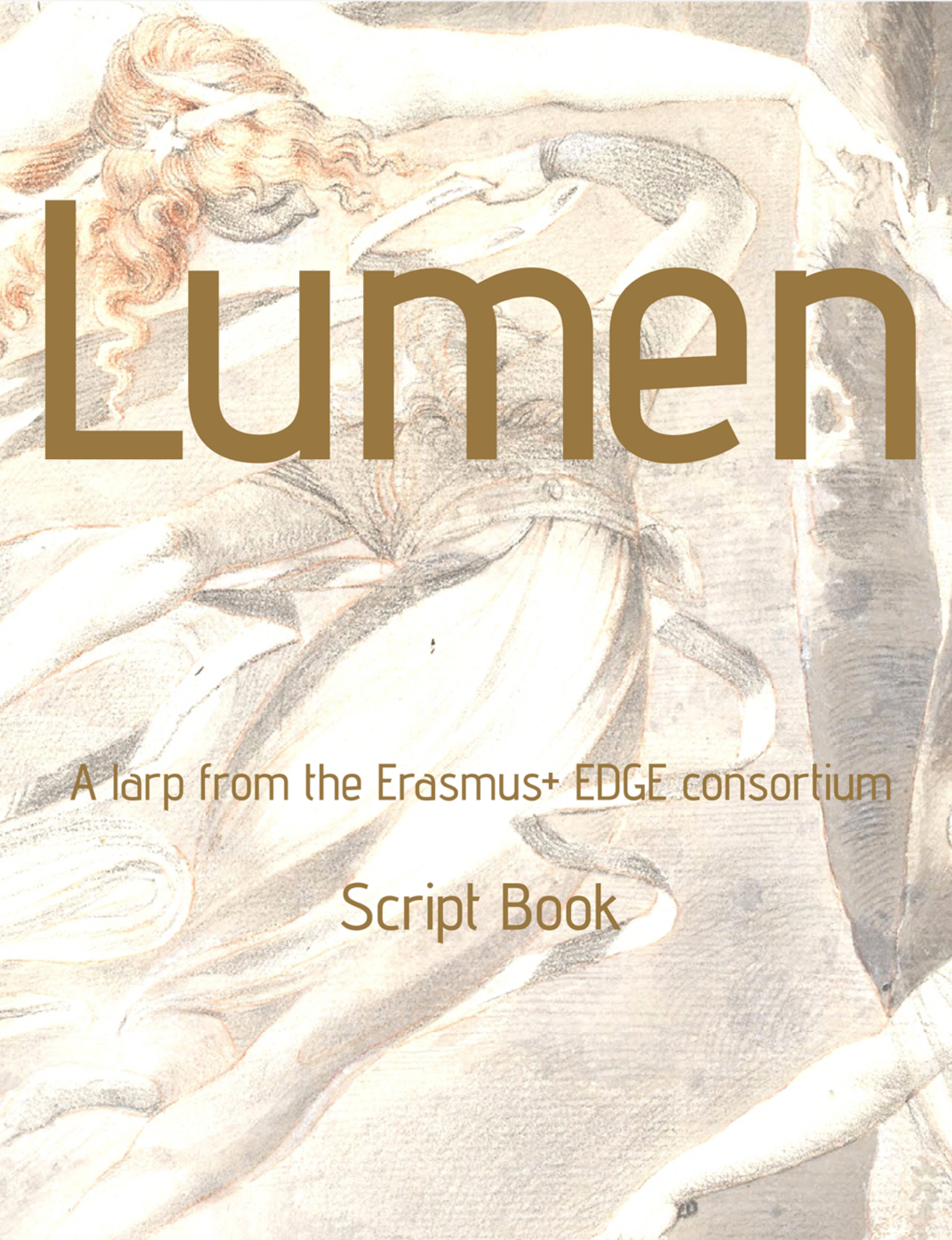

Lumen

A larp from the Erasmus+ EDGE consortium

Script Book

Lumen Credits

This larp was developed for Empowering Game Design Education with Transformative Role-playing Games (EDGE), an Erasmus+ Cooperation Partnership in Higher Education. EDGE infuses transformative role-playing game design curriculum at the Bachelor's, Master's, and informal education level with expertise on transformative game design from two higher education institutions: Uppsala University and Turku University of Applied Sciences. EDGE also brings together three larp organizations in Europe with both practical and academic specialties: Dragons Nest, Chaos League, and Avalon Larp Studio, as well as several volunteers. For more information: https://erasmusedge.eu/

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Contents

CHAPTER ..... Page

1. Preface 7
2. Transformative analog role-playing games 11
3. Implementing our model in Lumen 15
4. Production 24
5. How to play a Guide or Assistant Guide 29
6. Inclusion of Deities and powers 31
7. Modules 34
8. Appendices 37

    Appendix A -- Introductory Briefings 38

    Appendix B -- Deities, Colors, and Powers 54

    Appendix C -- Workshop: How to Play this Larp 60

    Appendix D -- Workshop: Metatechniques 63

    Appendix E -- Workshop: Safety 65

Appendix F -- Lessons 68

Lesson 1 -- Transformative Leisure Design 68

Lesson 2 -- Ritual, 69

Lesson 3 -- Identity 71

Lesson 4 -- Conflict 72

Lesson 5 -- Inclusion 74

Lesson 6 -- Culture Design 76

Appendix G -- Character Design Workshop 78

Appendix H -- Deitiy Embodiment Workshop 84

Appendix I --Challenging Pairs Workshop 86

Appendix J -- Scenario Design Workshop 87

Appendix K -- Ritual Encountering Challenge 90

Appendix L -- Debrief Scripts 91

Appendix M -- Website text 94

Appendix N -- Archetype Cards 102

Appendix O -- Fate Cards 133

Appendix P -- Plot Design Workshop 160

Appendix Q -- Dearest V Plot 164

Appendix R -- Lumen Badges and Deity Cheat Sheet 165

Appendix S -- Selection & Interveiw Questions 173

1 - Preface

Welcome to the ***Lumen*** larp script! In this document, you will find all the information needed to run ***Lumen*** and the workshops surrounding it.

Lumen is an educational larp (edu-larp) developed as part of a curriculum on transformative analog role-playing game (RPG) design. By larp, we mean live action role-playing game (larp), which involves physically embodying the characters and moving through space rather than simply imagining or narrating what actions your character performs in the fiction. Edu-larps use this format to focus specifically on training specific skills and/or teaching educational content. In this case, we teach the basics of transformative RPG design through playing a larp intended for these purposes.

In many ways, ***Lumen*** is an experiment. It guides players through an experience of personal transformation through their characters that is tied to their own personal goals as participants that they decide in pre-game workshops. While this experience is facilitated by non player-characters (NPCs) known as Guides, the characters are taught the basics of transformative RPG design and given a structure for creating short nano-games for other characters based on each other's chosen goals.

Thus, the larp is quite ***meta***, meaning we as players are reflecting about the process of design while playing and designing within the fiction. Larping itself can be quite mentally and emotionally intensive, and practicing educational content can add to that cognitive load. While new players can engage, we also recommend recruiting veteran players and designers if possible to help each other through the experience. These players can be Guides and/or player-characters. We will discuss these roles in more detail below.

Note that this larp script is meant to be ***modular***, meaning that many of the sections can be run as standalone exercises or removed completely, such as the pre-game lectures and nano-game Lessons. Therefore, you can also consider this larp script a toolkit that can be adapted to the needs of your group, logistical capabilities, and local cultural contexts.

Lumen is based on Bachelor's and Master's curriculum developed by the project in transformative role-playing games, with an emphasis on analog role-playing games, i.e., games played with minimal technological interfaces, such as in-person or online over video conferencing. These games allow for a high degree of player agency and co-creative, spontaneous play rather than pre-programmed choices and movement designed by a developer.

However, the project also explores integration of advanced technologies in such designs, considering what benefits and drawbacks of such practices. Therefore, you will find in this larp script not only instructions for analog role-playing facilitation, but also instructions for using the Lumen app, as well as running VR Larp experiences before and during the game.

Importantly, while ***Lumen*** focuses on personal transformation within the players themselves, while such effects can feel

therapeutic, this work is not intended as therapy in the traditional sense. The Guides are not in a client-therapist relationship with the participants, nor are the other players. Therapeutic larp would entail more framing, likely in the form of one-on-one or group sessions off-game with a mental health professional. Make sure your participants understand this distinction. However, ***Lumen*** could be run in this manner, but would need to be heavily adapted and have sufficient mental health professionals involved in the process and clear client contracts. That being said, we do recommend having mental health professionals or paraprofessionals as Assistant Guides or off-game safety team members if at all possible.

Lumen was developed as part of an Erasmus+ project called EDGE by partners from Avalon Larp Studio, Chaos League, Dragons Nest, Uppsala University, and Turku University of Applied Sciences, as well as expertise from volunteer Josephine Rydberg from Stockholm University of the Arts.

The larp is intended to provide an embodied experience of the content featured in our other outputs. We have two textbooks freely available online:

- *Transformative Role-playing Game Design* (2024); and
- *Implementing Transformative Role-playing Games* (2026)

For considerations on integration of advanced tech, we also offer:

- ***Erasmus+ EDGE Tech Toolkit*** (Suominen 2025)

We strongly recommend reviewing these resources if you plan to run some of all of the modules in ***Lumen.***

We also recommend reading *Larp Design: Creating Role-play Experiences* (Koljonen et al. eds. 2019), which has informed much of our thinking. See the References page for more information on these resources.

What is a larp script?

A larp script contains the materials necessary to run and play a larp. It does not necessarily explain how to ***play*** a larp, it assumes some familiarity with the form. However we have included a workshop for new and experienced larpers that we hope will give some guidance about how to play ***this*** larp. We are not sure ***Lumen*** is a suitable introduction to the form for complete beginners; we strongly recommend having some organisers, facilitators and/or players who have larped before.

If you do want to know more about how to play these games there are amazing resources available online.

How to read this script

We have included all of the materials we used to run ***Lumen*** in this script.

This book contains 8 chapters:

Chapter 1 is an introduction to the game and a discussion of how it works as an educational and transformational tool. It gives an overview of the vision for the game and the story world where it takes place.

Chapter 2 gives a more detailed explanation of transformative analogue games.

Chapter 3 deals with how this model applies to ***Lumen***. This chapter also describes the various stages of the game including preparation off-site, the workshops, runtime, and debriefing.
Chapter 4 talks about the production and logistics and talks through what is needed to run the game.
In Chapter 5, we explain the role of the Guides: the non-player characters (NPCs) who support the players through the larp.

In Chapter 6, we discuss the 'Deities' who represent supernatural metaphysical constructs that work diegetically within the story world.

Chapter 7 discusses the modular design of the game, presenting some core modules that

are needed to run the larp and some optional ones that you can choose to include.

Chapter 8 gives a sample Timeline for the workshop and the game so you can see what should happen and when.

We then present a series of Appendices that contain the detailed scripts of workshops, sample text for the website, and the pre-larp lessons that will introduce and teach transformative game design.

Modular design

While we first present the larp design as a whole, we acknowledge that many of you may not have 3-4 days, enough space, or the right amount of players to run the full larp. You may wish to only run the character creation workshop or run the Lessons as standalone exercises. Therefore, we have also separated the larp into ***Modules***, meaning components that are independent of one another, so you can decide which parts best fit your context. We will discuss this design in more detail later in Chapter 7 of this document.

Lumen as a transformative larp

a) What is a larp?

Larp is a co-operative game of make-believe: a form of embodied and physical role-play where the participants pretend to be their characters within a storyworld. In this larp, ***Lumen***, the storyworld appears at first to be much like our own. The game is set in the present day at a location known only as Hope. The players take on the role of one of the Seekers—people who have come to this place looking for something that they need: help, healing, answers, or a life change.

Unlike traditional tabletop role-playing games, ***Lumen*** is not moderated by a storyteller who dictates what does and does not occur. Whilst there are minor rules that affect play, in ***Lumen***, there are no dice rolls or mechanics to determine success of failure. You play the character by doing what they would do, saying what they would say. This happens in real time and—ideally—without dropping the character and commenting or speaking as yourself. If you want your character to run out into the storm to let the water from the rain wash away your tears then you—as your character—will need to go outside for real. As far as possible, in ***Lumen***, you play a larp with your whole body.

That being said, larps sometimes also offer various rules and methods— called ***metatechniques***—to control intensity and safety. In this way, the characters can perform rituals or other acts of magic far beyond the possibilities of the real world.

There are many different types and styles of larp. We categorise ***Lumen*** as an edu-larp, in which larp is applied as a method for learning.

b) Vision for the game

A group of seeming strangers come to a spiritual retreat at the same time at a place called Hope. Called Seekers, they have travelled from many countries and for countless different reasons: some are hurting, some grieving, others are broken, and others still at a crossroads in their life.

What they discover in this place is a connection to ancient divinities, a wellspring of magic, and techniques for transformation that they can use to change themselves, each other, and, perhaps, the very course of the world. But first they need to uncover and resolve the secrets and threads of fate that bind them together.

Because ***Lumen*** is designed to encourage personal and social change for the players, they are asked to consider their own life journey, the lessons they have learned from it, and the direction they want to take their journey in the future. Their character is based in part on these factors, encouraging some degree of ***close to home*** play.

c) Story world

When Hope is ready, Hope will bring people here. Each Seeker knows at least two others present but were unaware they were also attending. Sometimes Hope brings smaller groups and sometimes larger, but they always have important insights to share with one another and issues to work through together for the next steps in their individual journeys.

Some Seekers stay at Hope for long periods of time, keeping the place ready for the next group. Other Seekers wander and occasionally return to help newcomers on their journey, receiving an intuitive message that "it is time again." In both cases, these individuals become Guides who help newcomers through their process, guiding them in creating rituals of transformation for one another.

Their work is supported by wisdom and energy from ancient deities, who can move through the Seekers and Guides alike, offering them enhanced insights and capabilities. However, such experiences can be taxing, especially for Guides who have been at Hope for many years. Seekers must learn to summon these capabilities within themselves rather than relying on powers granted by the deities.

Other Seekers experience Hope once, then leave to continue their life. If their retreat was successful, they have learned the necessary skills and worked through their struggles enough to be of service to others in the wider world, spreading the magic of play.

Lumen is set in the modern world (2025 at the time of the first run), but will tend to place real life events and geopolitics in the background in favour of personal stories. Some of the Guides may be significantly older and some of the rituals may reflect other times. The frame of the outside world versus the world of Hope is a part of the design.

The characters are folks from the real world — contemporary, 21st century — who are attending a spiritual retreat. Some of them have come willingly, others have been persuaded or perhaps even pressured to attend. Their faith in the ability of any kind of spiritual retreat or practice to affect change will be varied and variable. Some may be people of faith, while others are jaded or even cynical.

The Seekers can come from any society, culture, or background, with the recommendation that players should design characters with backgrounds similar to their own. Diversity and inclusivity are a part of the design of this larp. At the same time, no player-character should portray sexism, racism, homophobia, transphobia, ableism, or other forms of bullying. Players are also asked to be careful to avoid cultural appropriation of a marginalized group and reproducing stereotypes.

Keep in mind that including deities and powers can be sensitive for players from spiritual and/or religious backgrounds. Ideally, you are not enacting deities outside of your cultural background and especially not from marginalized communities if you do not belong to them. We consider Roman deities safer in this respect as Rome colonized much of the world and spread their religion. However, players may still be uncomfortable even in this instance, so be mindful. One option is to invent your own pantheon and try not to create something obviously inspired by existing deities. As mentioned before, you can also choose to work with abstract concepts as if they were entities, e.g., "the Spirit of Love." You can also choose to remove this element from the game and the other activities should be sufficient.

d) Printed Materials

You can find a repository of our printed materials at https://zenodo.org/records/21859459.

2 - Transformative analog role-playing games

Many people have experienced transformative moments or experienced big life changes catalyzed by role-playing games. These impacts are considered ***incidental***, or accidental, meaning the designers did not intentionally design for them and the players were not onboarded to play a transformative game with specific goals. Therefore, these experiences are often quite specific to the individual, for example having a realization about one's gender or one's childhood during a science fiction larp about a future in which space travel is possible.

In other cases, the designers may have specific goals, such as raising awareness on a specific social issue, but the players are not expecting to experience transformation per se. These games are often played in one's leisure time and players have their own motivations for engaging which may or may not align with the designer's intent.

In transformative role-playing game design, such intents are stated openly and players opt-in to potentially experiencing them. In this way, by signing up to the larp, players are already primed to experience some sort of change, which may or may not occur depending on the person. In such games, other forms of transformation are also more likely to happen, ones the designers cannot predict that are specific to the individual. Such changes are also welcome in our model and should be processed as valuable. Ultimately, while we do not subscribe to the notion that the games themselves "change," people, our approach focuses on creating conditions within which participants are more likely to experience personal and/or social change.

We have designed ***Lumen*** for multiple forms of transformation. The first is learning how to design and implement games based on our model, which the players experience through ***Lumen*** itself, but also in the four nano-games designed by the characters and played within their core Gem groups, as we call them. Players choose transformative impacts for themselves they would like to explore through their characters. Each character is assigned a partner who will design a nano-game specifically tailored to their partner's individual goals.

Furthermore, we encourage the creation of an off-game community of care and support throughout the process, aiming toward small-scale social transformation. Our belief is the more participants experience communities built upon consent, negotiation, mutual care, and intentional transformation, the easier it will be for them to collaborate with each other in the future to create such experiences and/or transform social dynamics in their daily lives. In other words, ***Lumen*** is intended to provide a small microcosm of social organization and values we might like to see out in the "real world."

Importantly, the values espoused by the designers and types of change encouraged by ***Lumen*** are prosocial and progressive in nature, meaning skills and attitudes aimed to cultivate greater peace and justice in the world for all people, not only a few. Such a perspective inherently accepts the premise that aspects of our personal, social, and cultural life are capable

of changing for the betterment of everyone within them through conscientious processes, e.g., a ***conflict transformation*** approach (Lederach 2014).

a) Our model of transformative role-playing game design

In our model, transformative role-playing games are designed with highly specific and intentional ***framing*** activities surrounding them. These activities are intended to help build trust and the perception of psychological safety in the group, as well as to prime participants for potential transformation based on clear, transparent goals. As larp can be quite intense and self-expression through play can feel vulnerable, we emphasize the development of a ***transformational container*** of play through various practices to support the process before, during, and after the game.

In ***Lumen***, we provide a one-hour lecture to explain these concepts to participants before play (see Appendix A for slides). Since they are designing for one another based on the model, we want to make sure they receive the information when they are fully able to process it. We also send the textbooks ahead of time if they would like to engage in deeper learning. In edu-larps, it is best to introduce key content you want participants to learn before the larp starts. That way, when they receive prompts in-game to use the learning, they are already familiar with the content. This practice decreases overwhelm.

As a basic overview, our model of transformative game design is outlined here, based upon our textbooks (see References). We consider role-playing games ritual spaces that have three phases:

* **Before phase/Preparation:** Workshops, lectures, costuming, other ways to prepare for the ritual
* **During phase/Liminal Stage:** The game itself, an in-between phase where social identities within a community can shift (van Gennep 1960; Turner 1974)
* **After phase/Return:** Deroling, debriefing, processing, integration practices

i) Pre-game

Framing the game with pre-game exercises is critical to transformative role-playing game design.

1) Defining the desired impact

In our model, we use three different terms for the desired impacts depending on the type of transformative game to help distinguish between them. Such terms imply different expectations for care, support, and processing throughout the experience.

* **Transformative Leisure:** Transformative impact
* **Therapy:** Therapeutic goal
* **Education:** Learning objective

We further define four categories, which can be used in any of the types of transformative larps and provide some examples.

* **Educational Goals**
* **Emotional Processing**
* **Social Cohesion**
* **Political Aims**

For examples, see the goals workshop (Chapter 3).

2) Safety

Establishing and maintaining psychological safety is important in all three stages of the game. Role-playing games have established methods for this, including:

* Session 0s;
* Safety mechanics;
* Consent discussions; and
* post-game debriefing; etc.

3) Workshops

We always recommend including pre-game workshops, which can contain several exercises within them. All activities in a workshop should prepare the participants for play with the transformative impacts in mind. Ideally, they will be able to practice key skills or techniques, not just listen to briefing information.

Examples of types of workshops include:

* Character creation;
* Character relations;

* Learning names;
* Practicing mechanics or metatechniques;
* Learning key information related to transformative goals;
* Explaining safety structures; and
* Calibrating with co-players.

4) Enroling

A clear transition ritual moving between player to character and daily life to the fictional world can be helpful.

ii) During the game: Runtime

Like in workshops, all activities taking place during the runtime of the game should be designed to serve your desired transformative impacts. We also recommend that players have the ability to use safety techniques, consent negotiations, and calibration during the game, whether during distinct Act Breaks built into the larp, or during play itself.

iii) After the game

1) Deroling

Like entering the game, we recommend having a deroling exercise to ritually emphasize the shift from in-character to out-of-character at the end of the game.

2) Debriefing

Essential to the transformative play process is reflection. While reflection can take many forms, like many educators, we emphasize that verbal debriefing is critical in supporting the transformation process and reinforcing learning objectives. Thus, we recommend holding a ***debrief***, which allows players to process the experience. The game itself is usually not enough. Debriefs can be ***structured*** through turn-based facilitation and no crosstalk between players, ***semi-structured*** with more flexibility allowed, or ***unstructured***, allowing for organic conversation. We recommend structured debriefing to give everyone the chance to speak without interruption and focus on their own experience.

The specific questions you ask in a debrief are highly important. These can have

script. Here, we focus on providing a descriptive overview so you can see the big picture of the larp.

a) Pre-game off-site practices

* **Website:** A resource that features all the important information about the game, including details about the educational goals of the larp, logistics, safety, accessibility. Such pre-game materials are important for expectation management and shared intentionality (see Appendix M for the website text).

* **Application process:** Players were asked to submit a written application asking questions about their interest in the game, initial transformative goals, and target groups with which they plan to use the curriculum. From these applicants, we selected a smaller pool to interview. During these interviews, we asked for more information about their plans to use the content with their target groups. Importantly, we also asked if they would be willing to support one another in processes of personal transformation, which helped set expectations that players are encouraged to take care of each other both in-game and off-game (see Appendix XXX for application questions).

* **Social media:** We created a Facebook group for people who are interested in the larp. After player selection, we created another group only for players, as well as a Discord.

* **Webinar:** We held a webinar three months before the larp to go over logistics, costuming, and other topics.

* **App:** We created an app that featured aspects of character creation that

specific goals:

* **Emotional processing:** Processing the emotional experience, sometimes according to goals;
* **Intellectual processing:** Processing according to general intellectual concepts or themes related to play; and
* **Educational processing:** Processing according to specific learning objectives, which is common in educational settings.

3) Integration Practices

In our understanding, lasting change requires integration of takeaways into daily life, not just temporary engagement during and after play. Therefore, we recommend facilitating or encouraging players to engage in *integration* practices after the event, including one or more of the following:

* **Creative Expression,**
* **Intellectual Analysis,**
* **Emotional Processing,**
* **Interpersonal Processing,**
* **Community Building,** and
* **Returning to Daily Life.**

For more details of our model, see our textbooks.

3 - Implementing our model in Lumen

For ***Lumen***, we engaged in several practices guided by the model. We will detail them here to demonstrate how we emphasized framing exercises both in- and off-game. Some of these practices are typical for many larps, whereas others are specific to edu-larps. Keep in mind that even the purely practical parts can be very helpful for players to feel safe at the larp and supported by the organizers.

Many of the specific workshops, lessons, debriefs, and other exercises described are included in the appendices at the end of the players could review the larp and use during it, including a note-taking feature and a map.

* **Emails:** We sent emails to participants that featured links to the educational content, costuming recommendations, logistical updates, and copy of the design task they will use in play so they could review ahead of time.

b) Pre-game onsite practices

Our run of ***Lumen*** featured numerous onsite practices, some of which took place during runtime and some of which we are now recommending organizers run during workshop activities. For clarity, we focus here on our current recommendations based on the materials we have created:

i) Site tour

While immensely practical, site tours can also be important to support players. For example, we recommend making clear where the safety room(s) and organizer room(s) are.

ii) Introductory briefing

We recommend the briefing information to include:

* Introducing the team and their organizing duties, especially the safety team;
* Reminding players about the setting;
* Reading out loud the transformative goals of the larp;
* Describing when they should wear their ceremonial costumes; and
* Explaining their character's Choice according to the plot. In our run, they were asked to Choose to stay or leave ***Lumen*** after the retreat (see Appendix P for plot generation instructions);
* Running a brief goals exercise, in which they choose a transformative goal for their character, then share it with another player while introducing themselves (see Appendix A); and
* Logistics about Gemstone groups, within which they will design and play the nano-games.

iii) X-Cards and Veils

At this stage, we recommend choosing some global X-Cards (Stavropoulos 2014) (sometimes called Lines, Edward 2003), i.e., topics that will not be allowed to enact at the game. Some topics can remain part of the game, but become Veiled, meaning explicit parts are not played out. If you

use our application form, these will be outlined by the players ahead of time and you can choose to make them hard rules. In our run, we X-Carded child abuse, bullying, sexual abuse, animal cruelty, domestic violence, and present threat of suicide.

Also, make clear any rules for if they discuss such content; for example, if bullying has a global X-Card but a character experienced bullying as an important part of their backstory, you can give them instructions to gain consent from all co-players present off-game before discussing this content. They should do so in a relatively private location rather than in the main room. If other characters approach, they should pause their conversation and inform them of the content so they can choose to opt-in or opt-out of the scene.

Because in ***Lumen***, we have an emergent character creation and relations process, new content will likely emerge not on the list. Therefore, we have another round of X-Cards at this point. The organizer collects these and announces any new topics that should be X-Carded, e.g., death of a parent. Importantly, no questions should be asked as to why, but you may need to ask clarifying questions. If a topic is not possible to X-Card, the organizers should explain why. In those cases, players should calibrate individually with one another as usual.

iv) How to play this larp

At ***Lumen,*** we anticipate that players will have vastly different ideas of what a "role-playing game" means, especially if they come from different cultures. To encourage co-creation and having a shared vision for the larp, we included a workshop in which smaller groups of players were invited to evaluate different playstyles and agree upon which ones were most resonant with the experience they wanted to have. Examples include:

* Player Agency Matters
* Remember You Have Alibi
* Live in the Moment
* Adapt to Changes
* Respect Others' Boundaries
* Communication is Key

Our perspective is that this exercise was an excellent ice-breaker, helping players better understand one another and the shared experience they were co-creating.

v) Metatechniques

At our run, we localized the magical metatechniques. As we were playing outside of Florence with an Italian team, we included specific powers and colors corresponding to major Roman deities. Players were given a badgeholder with a laminated list containing the names of deities, their corresponding powers, and their colors.

In this game, we ran a metatechnique workshop. We had one gestural metatechnique -- holding one hand up to our temple and pointing two fingers outward -- which indicated a player was using the power. In addition, we had long satin sashes they could tie around their wrist to clearly indicate they were drawing insight from the deity, a visible indication that they were working with that energy. The player could also telegraph that they were using a power verbally, i.e., "I call upon the power of Jupiter to enhance my leadership skills" or something similar. Importantly, other players could decide how they would respond to the power and such abilities should never be used in a coercive fashion. Players were given the opportunity to practice using powers during the workshop.

While such a practice can be helpful in processes of personal transformation, we do not think it essential to running ***Lumen.*** If you are not comfortable working with historical or fictional deities, you can also use abstract concepts instead, such as Beauty, Integrity, Creativity, etc.

vi) Lessons

Since players are asked to design a nano-larp for each other based on a worksheet with choices for workshop activities, game activities, and debriefing options, our view is that they need an embodied sense of these various options before they start designing. While they are free to diverge from the Lessons or Scenario Design worksheet, the whole group should agree to that choice. At the very least, all players have the same starting point.

For the first run, we played the Lessons in-game led by the Guides. While this practice is technically possible, we found that players found it difficult to stay in-character playing essentially a larp within a larp. While this larp within a larp structure worked fine for the Scenario Design, it

was more challenging for the Lessons, as it was unclear whether or not they should be critiquing the process as themselves or their characters, even if both are technically designers. For this reason, we recommend instead running the Lessons as part of the workshop schedule before the larp, perhaps devoting much of one day to them so everyone can take the 6 Lessons. We provide a suggestion for a structured workshop day for this purpose in (See 'Schedule for the Core Modules' in chapter 7).

Note that all Lessons should also feature a workshop and debrief. These are included in the scripts.

The 2 Lessons we recommend that all participants play are:

* **Transformative Leisure Design:** Players learn the difference between transformative leisure, educational, and therapeutic role-playing games. In ***Lumen***, they will be designing transformative leisure experiences for one another at ***Lumen***, meaning there are no expectations of educational framing, nor is there an established client-therapist relationship between the characters. Instead, they are practicing how to design a tailor-made scene based on practicing a specific skill with a certain transformative impact in mind, which they will do for one another in their supportive pairs (see later in this document).
* **Ritual:** Players learn the basics of ritual theory, including the preparation, liminal, and return phases. They learn principles of designing rituals to be participatory. They also learn about three common themes for myths: creation, the hero / heroine's journey, and maturation / apotheosis. Then, they practice a basic ritual demonstrating a person's journey through these three phases of life, then are able to decide on small changes, playing it again. They will be designing rituals during ***Lumen***, so this Lesson is intended to provide them with embodied examples of how to do so.

The following Lessons either have components of nano-games or are full games in their own right. If you are short on time, you can make separate "tracks" with players taking 2 of them; however, we rather recommend all players take all of them. These lessons represent challenging topics designers often choose as subject matter, allowing players to explore these concepts in a focused way:

* **Identity:** This Lesson emphasizes the ***intrapersonal***, meaning relations between parts within ourselves. Players enact the Inner Committee within a character's head who is trying to make a decision, including the Inner Parent, Inner Child, Inner Critic, and Memories of the Past. As scenarios involving parts of consciousness communicating with one another are fairly common, this Lesson is intended to give an example of one way to design such a nano-game.
* **Conflict:** Adapted from materials from Erasmus+ ROCKET, this Lesson emphasizes the ***interpersonal***, meaning relations between people. In this lesson, characters within a group discuss a conflict, each inhabiting different conflict styles: competing, accommodating, compromising, avoiding, and collaborating (Thomas and Kilmann 1974), then trying a different style as the same character. As conflict is a common topic in role-playing game design, this Lesson demonstrates how conflict theory and practice can be explored through play.
* **Inclusion:** The Lesson emphasizes the ***positional***, meaning aspects of our place within society that affects our worldview. In particular, it focuses on "odd person out" instances, when one person feels excluded from the other three, even if such exclusion was not their intention. Based upon theories of groupthink and conformity, this Lesson is intended to demonstrate how challenging it can be for one individual to self-advocate, even in an otherwise supportive group setting.
* **Culture Design:** The Lesson emphasizes the ***ideological***, meaning the aspects of our worldview that are inherited through systems of ideas transmitted through culture. This Lesson is more of a workshop with a short scene at the end than a full

nano-larp. It involves designing a ritual activity for a fictional culture based on a co-created religious or philosophical belief, then briefly role-playing it. The Lesson is intended to give designers practical experience with culture design, while also avoiding cultural appropriation and stereotypes.

vii) Character creation and relations

At ***Lumen***, we have a character creation and relations workshop onsite. We have created an expanded version here that includes more time for backstory development (see Appendix G). Players are guided to choose one archetype card that represents their personal journey up until this point, then another card for the archetypal journey they would like to explore next. These two cards are kept in their badge holder to be used as physical objects during rituals and other role-playing, i.e., they are ***diegetic*** objects that exist in-game as well; their character has also chosen these archetypes. Note that players are encouraged also to browse the cards and select their archetypes in the Lumen app before the larp, but they can change their choices during the workshops and even during game play by asking a Guide to help them find a new card or use the app to find one.

During this workshop, based on the archetypes, we also establish a relationship with another character, with whom they form a ***supportive pair***. These characters build each other up and will eventually design nano-games for each other based on their goals. The pair will specify their relationship with one another through the use of the Fate Cards (see Appendix O). Then, two sets of supportive pairs are joined to form Gemstone groups, which are the main core group for the game. Finally, we ask them to pair with another person outside of their Gemstone group, with whom they form a ***challenging pair***. Groups of challenging pairs will design a workshop together during the larp to work through points of resistance inside themselves and between each other.

Note that ***Lumen*** is best played in a player base that can be evenly divided by 4, with one Guide assigned to each Gemstone group, i.e., a ratio of 1:4 Guides-to-players. We realize this is a high number of facilitators at scale, but because of the personal development dimension, we think it important for Guides to oversee the process. Also, we do not recommend making the Gemstone group size larger than 4.

viii) Safety workshop

While no organizer can assure participants a space will be safe, the concept of establishing and maintaining a space that feels safe enough for players to feel brave is essential to the design of ***Lumen***. The design is based upon active, enthusiastic consent and the principle, "The only person who gets to decide what happens to your character is you." Similarly, while all activities are considered essential parts of the ***Lumen*** experience, players can opt-out if needed. However, they should inform their Gemstone group, Guide, and/or safety team if they need to opt-out of important game activities such as the Scenario Design Task and subsequent playtests.

The safety workshop covers the following topics:

* **Consent**

* **Introducing the safety team and safety room**: Players are encouraged to support one another, but are also welcome to approach the safety team if needed. In our run, some organizers played Assistant Guides, who had the dual role of helping characters through their transformative journey, but also providing emotional safety support in-game or off-game as needed.

* **Safety techniques**, including:

  Off-game: A general word that can be used to communicate anything off-game. Examples include:
  - "Off-game: Cut."
  - "Off-game: Please play softer." or just "Off-game: Softer."
  - "Off-game: Be right back."
  - "Off-game: Can we calibrate in the other room?"
  - "Off-game: Pronouns are they/them."
  - "Off-game: Opt-out."

  Okay Check-In: A way to non-verbally check on others by making an O with one's hand. The other player replies

with thumbs up, thumbs down, or a flat hand / so-so signal. If the player responds with these latter two, the first player should ask how they can help.

Lookdown: This mechanic has a hand over the eyes, indicating "don't interact with me in- or off-game." A player using the Lookdown can choose to stay physically present or leave.

X-Card: A word used to request that content just introduced should be removed, usually followed by a short description, e.g., X-Card: Spiders, or X-Card: Death of a Parent. The other players should continue the scene as if nothing happened, avoiding the subject matter. Can sometimes involve making an X with one's fingers or arms along with the verbal signal.

* **Further calibration** with their supportive pair and challenging pair players, as well as the rest of the group

ix) En-roling countdown

To guide players into the game, we recommend that one of the Guides count down from 10 to 1 as everyone stands in a semicircle. Players should close their eyes if they feel comfortable doing so, and the Guide should gently lead them into the fiction, e.g., "10...9...8 ***You have just arrived*** at Hope ...7...6...5 ***What will you discover here?*** ....4....3 Will you find the answers to what you Seek? ....2...1." The same Guide should also lead the first ritual, so the transition into character is smooth.

c) Runtime

As mentioned above, while we held in-game Lessons during our run at ***Lumen***, this script will recommend running these during the pre-game workshops. This practice will free up more time for players to focus on their personal transformation, design work, and interpersonal character dynamics. This next section will detail our recommended sequence of activities for the runtime of the game.

i) Welcome ritual

Each day is book-ended by a welcome ritual and a closing ritual. These rituals are designed to be short, participatory, and meaningful.

In the first Welcome ritual, arrange the players in a semicircle with one Guide facing them. The rest of the Guides should stand in a line on one side of the semicircle so they can model the movement they want the characters to follow, e.g., on the left side.

The ritual leader Guide will welcome everyone to Hope and ask them to open their badge holder and pull out the first archetype card they chose, representing their journey up until this point. The Guide will ask them to place the card face up in their badgeholder. This is a symbolic way to honor the journey so far and indicate the first day will be working through that story.

Then, the Guide will ask each other Guide to take turns crossing to the center, saying their name, and stating their intention for this retreat, e.g., "I am Kara and my intention is to find inner strength." Then, they should cross to the right side and start to form a semicircle in the other direction. This movement helps players bodily transition more deeply into character.

After the Guides complete their intentions, the player-character Seekers will do the same. When they cross to the right side, their assigned Guide will hand them their badge, and say "Welcome to Hope. I am [name]. I will be your Guide," inserting their character name. They will direct the Seekers to place in their badgeholder on the other side. The result should be the badge with the character's name and pronouns on the front side, and the visible archetype card on the back side.

This badge process serves two purposes. The first purpose is logistical: it allows the organizers time to record the characters' names, assign them to Gemstone groups, decide who is best as a Guide to lead that group, print the badges, and laminate them so they stay firm in the badge holder. The second purpose is symbolic: it provides a place and sense of belonging to the seekers as they are welcomed by their Guide.

After the last person has crossed the threshold, the semicircle should now be on the other side of the room facing the other direction. The ritual leader Guide will give a short speech explaining that the Guides have been waiting for them, and explaining what will happen for the

rest of the day. After this speech, the characters are encouraged to spend some time getting to know their Gemstone group.

ii) Goals workshop

After some social time, the character should assemble in their Gemstone group with their Guide. Ideally, each Gemstone group will have a specific place on the site where they always return for Guide meetings to help ritualize this practice of gathering. During this workshop, the Guide will ask each of the players to:

1. Introduce themselves by name;
2. Share their pronouns;
3. Explain their journey so far; and
4. Describe their stated goal.

If their goal has changed since the off-game Goal workshop or if the character is unsure of their goal, the Guide can ask about what intention they stated in the opening ritual. The Guide should reassure the characters that goals can change throughout the retreat, but having a goal as a point of focus helps the group's intentionality.

The Guide should also explain that tomorrow, they will be designing a scenario for one another based upon these goals, but assure them not to worry about that tonight, as they will cover it tomorrow.

After the workshop, the characters should have more social time. The Guides should monitor the groups in case anyone needs assistance or has questions.

iii) Deity embodiment workshop

In the evening, the Guides should host a Deity Embodiment workshop (or the symbolic equivalent, if you are using this metatechnique). This workshop should take place in the Ritual room. All deity sashes should be available here, ideally with 5-10 of each depending on the amount of players. Drums and other ritual equipment should also be here. Remind the character to return any equipment if they take it out of the Ritual room.

The Deity embodiment workshop should be optional, but encouraged. Each Guides chooses 1-2 specific deities to draw power from and demonstrate the use of the metatechnique to a group of 4-6, this time through role-play. The Guide can choose to take on aspects of the deity, i.e., speak as them, or can merely be influenced by the power, e.g., behaving more confidently. The Guide wraps the sash around their wrist and indicates through role-play that the power and insight is moving through them. Then, the Guide asks if the characters have any questions for the deity, and responds as if in a formal audience for 5-10 minutes.

tomorrow, they will be designing a scenario for one another

The Guide should then ask if any volunteers in the group want to try to wear the sash and work with the deity. If so, the Guide will help them with the sash and activate their power, then ask the first question, prompting the others to ask as well. If no one is interested in trying that deity, the Guide should switch to the second deity. Ideally, the Guide should have modeled both by the end of the workshop.

After the demonstration, the Guides should give the characters some time to experiment with the different scarves and role-play in the room. Remind them that the goal is to let the deity teach them how to access parts of themselves that are already there, but dormant, and that drawing power from the deity for too long can be exhausting.

At the end of the workshop, some of the Guides should linger in the room and agree to have longer Audiences. The Seekers can approach and request a specific deity. Ideally, the Guide can take them to a more private area of the space so as not to get interrupted during the audience, which should not last more than 5-20 minutes. Players often benefit greatly from these one-on-one scenes, especially if they are having trouble comfortably expressing themselves in larger groups. Audiences are especially helpful for helping a character work through any inner resistance or blocks to their

personal transformation.

Some Audience scenes can be deeply personal and intense. We recommend having an Assistant Guide nearby who is also part of the safety team in case the character needs further processing, or the player needs to discuss the scene off-game. (See Appendix XXX)

iv) Closing ritual first night

As the last scene of the first night before breaking character, a ritual leader Guide should run the Closing ritual. The Guides should bring ritual instruments that add ambiance, such as fire torches if legal and outside or LED torches if not. They can also bring drums or other instruments. In our run, we had one Guide holding a torch at each of the four corners of the inner courtyard while players assembled on the side of the semicircle they left at the end of the first ritual.

The ritual leader Guide will explain that another day comes to an end, and if something has not yet been resolved or processed, we have more time tomorrow. The ritual leader Guide then asks them to cross through from right to left -- the opposite direction as the morning -- ending up on the other side of the semicircle. When this is complete, the ritual leader Guide counts down again, "10...9...8 Our day at Hope comes to a close ...7...6...5 We allow all the impressions of the day to float through our mind ...4...3 And slowly begin to return back to ourselves ...2...1."

v) Derole and debrief

As ***Lumen*** is an educational larp, the debrief should be considered an essential part of the process. However, if necessary, players can opt-out, just as with all activities. We recommend making it clear that players should not engage in loud social activities such as parties during the debrief or post-larp evening hours. They can, however, calibrate quietly with one another if needed.

The debrief leader should arrange groups of 2-12 in a circle and sit with them. First, run a short de-role for the players, such as having them say their character name, then their own name, such as "I was Kara, I am now Steph." Then, ask the questions on the debrief script in sequential order, requesting that each person answer in order in the circle. Make sure that each person gets the same amount of time to answer each question or Pass if they wish. Discourage "crosstalk," in which people engage with each other conversationally. Ask them to focus on their own experience rather than making assumptions or accusations about other players. At the end of the round, if a player has Passed, ask again if they would like to share before moving on to the next question.

The official debrief should last no more than an hour as everyone should have time to rest. If you are willing to stay longer to help them process, tell them when the official debrief is done and offer to stay longer for those who wish to linger. You may also need to set a boundary and rest instead.

vi) Morning Ritual: Day 2

The players should be assembled in the semicircle where they ended the closing ritual the night before. The ritual leader Guide should count down again, "10...9...8 Here you are again, returning to Hope ...7...6...5 What did you learn yesterday about yourself? ...4...3... What do you hope to discover before the end of the retreat? 2...1."

The ritual leader Guide greets the players and asks them to change their archetype card on the backside of their badgeholder to the archetype they are seeking to become. The ritual leader Guide then asks players to imagine one word to describe what they explored yesterday. The Guides can model or stay to the side. The ritual leader Guide demonstrates how to proceed after they cross from left to the center, "I am Kara and I explored strength." They will each cross to the right and make the semicircle again on the other side of the room.

The ritual leader Guide will then explain what will happen today starting with the Challenging pair workshop followed by the Guide workshop for Scenario Design Task. Then, the characters will work in their Supportive pairs to design scenarios for one another, then playtest them together back to back in their Gemstone group. In the evening, there will be the Encountering Challenge Ritual followed with Audiences with the deities again.

Finally, the ritual leader Guide will explain that the characters have a Choice at the end of the day: will they go out in the world and share what they have learned, helping others? Or will they stay at Hope and help Guide new Seekers?

Characters should have some social time

before the next activity.

vii) Challenging pair workshop

The workshop leader Guide will ask the characters to stand next to their Challenging pair partner. The workshop leader Guide will ask them to spend some time discussing their challenges with one another. After about 15 minutes, the workshop leader will combine two pairs, who will form a new group and a Guide will work with them to discuss their challenges with each other. Ideally, these groups will be different in composition from the Gemstone groups, but this is not a necessity.

The workshop leader Guide will explain that the goal of the exercise is not necessarily to resolve conflicts or challenges, but rather to allow characters the opportunity to explore these dynamics more deeply and fully feel the emotions associated with them. Explain that the characters will have the opportunity to transform these challenges in the evening if they choose to take part in the Encountering Challenge ritual design activity together.

The Guides will choose two Deities, similar to the night before: one that represents to them Harmony and one that represents Dissonance. The Guide will ask each pair to share their challenges with one another and ask: What wants to be expressed right now: the desire for Harmony or the clash of Dissonance? The pairs will choose and the Guide will embody one or the other based on the need. This time, the Guide will ask the pair probing questions aimed at either creating greater Harmony or allowing the Dissonance to express itself depending on the deity. This process should last no more than 15 minutes. Then, the Guide will undergo the same process with the second pair for the next 15 minutes. After this phase ends, the Guide will remove the sash and debrief with the characters in-game.

The characters should have some social time after this task.

viii) Goals workshop for Scenario Design Task

During this workshop, the Guides will meet with the Gemstone groups. Remind them that tonight, they will make a Choice about whether to leave Hope or stay. The Guide should then check in with the group and process anything that may have arisen with the Challenging pairs. Then, they should ask each person in the group if their goals have changed. Explain that this information is important, because they will soon transition into the Scenario Design Task. If characters are having trouble finding a goal, ask them to reflect on the Archetype card they have chosen for the future.

Then, hand out the Scenario Design Task and explain the instructions to the Gemstone groups, clarifying any questions they might have about the stages. Each designer should facilitate their own game and design a scenario for 3 others. The Guide can also take part in the scenario if the designer requests it. Tell them that before the playtesting starts, they must inform each other of any important content of the scenario and remind each other they can opt-out if needed. If this happens, tell them to ask you to take their place.

The Guide should help the group choose the right spot to playtest their scenarios

ix) Scenario Design Task

After this, instruct the characters to spend the next hour discussing the scenario design with their Supportive pair partner, ideally over a meal. After the hour, remind them to fill out the worksheet if they have not done so already. They may also choose to design a different scenario if everyone agrees as long as it focuses on their partner's transformative goals.

x) Scenario playtests

The Guide should help the group choose the right spot to playtest their scenarios for one another. Ideally, you will not be in the same space as other groups, or outside if the weather is nice enough and everyone can spread out. If you do need to share space with other groups, remind them to

mind the noise levels as needed.

The group will decide which order to run the scenarios. Remind them to tell the group the content and allow them to opt-out as needed. Remind them also of the safety techniques and that if any topics come up that were previously X-Carded, all members should agree to play on that content and they should not be physically enacting it. The Guide should remain nearby in case this happens or the facilitator needs help.

The scenarios should last no longer than 45 minutes including workshop, runtime, and in-game debrief. Make sure they have 15 minutes between playtests, but start again promptly, as the block will take 4 hours.

The characters should have social time after all scenarios are complete.

xi) Encountering Challenge Ritual

Invite the characters to join the Encountering Challenge Ritual in their Challenging pairs. If one member of a pair does not want to join, Guides can step in instead, or you can ask them to adapt the ritual accordingly.

The ritual leader Guide will provide the instructions, but should not take an active role in the ritual planning process. The goal of this exercise is to allow the characters an opportunity to make larger group experiences together based on emergent creativity. Break the characters into groups of 6-8 with their Challenging pairs. Ask the group to brainstorm ways to encounter challenges through ritual. For example, some members of the group could represent the challenge symbolically, and the characters experiencing the challenge will need to interact with this symbol in some way. The goal is to brainstorm and enact a ritual that will allow characters to transform their conflict in some way: experience a catharsis, express their emotions, confront their fears, defeat their resistance, etc.

When the groups are ready, have them enact the ritual in the center of the room while the other members form an outer circle around them. Ideally, they should take part in some way based on the direction of the ritual group, for example chanting, drumming, clapping, or other forms of participation. The ritual group can also choose to enact the ritual somewhere privately. If so, we recommend having a place already in mind set aside for this purpose.

Each Guide should hold a short debrief for each group, allowing them to share about the experience and ground back into themselves.

xii) Deity Audiences

A few Guides should make themselves available for Deity Audiences in the Ritual room before the final Claiming ritual. If characters are frustrated or confused, Guides may want to recommend they seek an Audience depending on the circumstances.

xiii) Claiming ritual Day 2

For the final scene of the game, the Guides should bring again the ritual instruments, fire torches, etc. in the same configuration as the night before. However, this time, the characters will make the Choice. The ritual leader Guide will explain that if they want to stay at Hope, they will return back to the side they are on after passing through. If they want to leave, they will cross over to the other side and form a semicircle as usual.

Then, the ritual leader Guide will ask everyone to close their eyes and think of what they would like to Claim from this experience. Each Guide should model the Claiming first to give everyone the opportunity to reflect, e.g., "I am Kara. I claim my resilience in the face of challenge." Instead of moving in a line, characters can approach the center whenever they are ready to do so, then move to the side of their choice.

After the Choice is done, the ritual leader Guide will count down, "10...9....8... You have had a significant experience here at Hope...7...6...5 Consider all you have learned here and still want to learn...4...3... You are returning back to yourself, your own life, and your own goals... 2...1."

xiv) De-role and Debrief

Same droning and debriefing process as before, but this time you should also offer options for Integration at the close of the debrief. See the Debrief script.

Also, consider how you will say goodbye to the players. At least some Guides and Assistant Guides should be available to talk as the players leave depending on their needs.

4 - Production

The production for ***Lumen*** is purposefully quite sparse. The goal is for the larp to be accessible for people to implement and attend, and ideally run in many settings with minimal props. However, if you want to run a more elaborate version with props and scenery, that is also possible.

Spaces needed and site setup

Space in a larp is a fundamental element. While in most events people look for a venue that is fascinating and somehow "marketable" to potential participants, with ***Lumen*** we tried to take a different path. We chose to prioritize practicality and accessibility.

Of course, nothing prevents you from looking for a charming location, but for the purposes of the game we envisioned a venue that is easy to find and use.

Lumen takes place in modern times, so it is not important for the location to be historical. What matters is that it is sufficiently isolated to create a sense of separation from the outside world and intimacy among the participants.

Simple version:
Any country house, scout group house, or accommodation for group holidays can work. The important thing is that it has enough beds, a kitchen, and at least 2–3 common rooms. A big plus would be having some outdoor space, ideally a bit of nature, such as a lawn or a small wooded area.

Players need space to split up and play in smaller groups, or simply to wander alone or find a moment of concentration.

Make sure the location has bathrooms and, most importantly, that it is accessible for people with limited mobility. If the location has limitations (for example, a lack of wheelchair ramps), it is essential to inform participants in advance.

In short, ***Lumen*** requires:

* Accommodation for players and crew members
* Two or three common rooms (ideally one large enough to host all participants)
* Bathrooms
* Spaces for cooking and/or eating meals
* Outdoor spaces (if available)

Sound and lighting design

The sound design of ***Lumen*** is intentionally very minimal, again with the aim of keeping costs as low as possible. It is entirely possible to organize this larp without any sound amplification or audio files. However, you may use Bluetooth speakers to add sound to certain areas or to mark specific

moments.

There are many models available on the market at all price ranges. In this case, we recommend placing them in the common areas. Always be careful not to raise the volume too much, so as not to disturb more sensitive players.

If needed, you can download free audio tracks from platforms such as YouTube, Jamendo, or the Freesound Archive. We recommend drone music or meditative tracks.

When dealing with large rooms, make sure they do not have a strong echo. A room like that makes it difficult to understand what is being said. This is particularly important in workshop rooms, where lessons or talks for all participants will take place.

If the echo is too strong, we recommend holding the scene outside, in the open air, where echo and reverberation are not an issue.

The lighting design is based on the charm of analog lighting. To create a magical and intimate atmosphere, we recommend nighttime lighting using candles, either real ones or warm-light LED candles. Where you feel it is appropriate, you may also consider using torches or large bonfires. If the location allows it, why not use a fireplace as well.

Working with Technology

As part of our goal of the Erasmus+ EDGE project is to experiment with the integration of advanced technology into analog role-playing games, this section will discuss such use in Lumen. If you choose to integrate tech of any sort, we recommend considering these considerations throughout the design process and weaving it into the larp in a purposeful manner that serves the narrative and/or logistics. Tech included as a side add-on is often considered an annoyance to players, whereas well-integrated and supported tech can enhance the experience and even become integral to the fiction.

i) Wifi

Since Lumen has both a mobile app and the option to use VR, a stable and high-quality internet connection at the venue is essential. We strongly recommend evaluating the location's connectivity well in advance. If possible, temporarily increasing available bandwidth for the duration of the event can significantly improve reliability.

It is also important to review the existing WiFi setup, including the number and placement of access points, their manufacturers, supported standards, and overall age. In many cases, bringing a preconfigured WiFi access point is advisable. This allows you to connect directly to the venue's internet service and maintain better control over network performance.

In our case, we anticipated connectivity challenges based on a prior site visit. The building's thick stone walls and maze-like layout significantly weakened both mobile and WiFi signals. To address this, we deployed a dedicated Mesh WiFi network using three access points. Mesh systems allow overlapping coverage areas, extending signal reach while improving overall connection quality across the play space. Many modern Mesh solutions also support additional nodes and separate guest networks for players.

Despite these measures, substantial network enhancements were necessary due to the building's structure and the near absence of existing WiFi coverage. Additionally, when using the Convento Dell'Incontro world in VRChat, there is a limit of five users connected simultaneously from the same WiFi network. This constraint must be considered when designing the network setup and distributing users across connections.

ii) The Lumen AR app

Since we had an on-site character creation process, we quickly realised that it could be challenging for players to remember all the relationships they had formed with others or the archetype cards they had chosen. While we left the physical cards available in one of the rooms so that players could pick new ones if needed, having all the cards accessible on a personal device—as well as space for personal journals

and notes about relationships—proved to be a useful alternative to carrying notebooks during play.

The Lumen AR app was developed using the Unity game engine for both Android and iOS devices. Use of the app is not mandatory; however, it significantly supports familiarisation with the archetype cards, memory management, and character creation well in advance of the larp event. Through the app, archetype cards can be scanned using the mobile device's camera or you can browse and select the cards manually, and then assign them either to the player's own character or to the character of another player they encounter during the game. By using the app, it is also possible to run the experience without physical cards altogether.

Because we implemented an on-site character creation process, it is particularly important to introduce the app early. In practice, the app should be demonstrated well in advance of the event—ideally several months beforehand—via videos or a webinar. This allows players to understand its functionality and begin planning aspects of their character ahead of time, reducing cognitive load during the actual event. Based on the feedback some players valued the option to read about ***Lumen*** or familiarise themselves with the archetype cards while traveling to the venue..

It is worth noting that the app was developed specifically for the ***Lumen*** game. As such, it is not directly adaptable for use in other games unless the source code is downloaded from GitHub and modified using the Unity game engine. This ensures that the app remains tightly integrated with Lumen's design goals and mechanics, but it also limits its use outside that specific context. The repository for the Lumen AR app is available here at this link.

iii) VRchat setup

In ***Lumen***, we had an option to play in VRchat. VRchat is a freely accessible and social virtual reality application with a high amount of customization options and mods. VRlarp has become a phenomenon in its own right, so we wanted to experiment with using VR to enhance the spatial immersion and otherworldliness of certain scenes. Players could opt-in to joining a workshop online in virtual reality before the larp. They could also choose to have a deity audience in VR in a custom world built by Laura K. Nemeth to look like an augmented version of the larp site in Florence. Players could choose to consult with a deity at different points in their character journey. This kind of scene is easy to include outside of the Gemstone group schedule.

If you would like to include this option, to ensure a smooth transition, make sure your players are used to navigating in VR and can find their way around VRchat. With people not accustomed to VR, it is important to prepare headsets with logins and appropriate virtual models so they can step into virtual ***Lumen*** immediately without having to transit through apps loading, digital lobbies, and other liminal spaces inside a VR headset.

As an organiser you are advised to allocate someone experienced to help the players get into VRchat. Things that quickly become second nature to people who have spent a little time in VR can be utterly confusing to a beginner.

When choosing virtual models please consider the ethical implications of the aesthetics you choose. Choosing an inappropriate model will not only distract players from the immersion into the story but may cause harm and alienate your players from the experience altogether. By appropriate virtual models, we mean that we recommend choosing physical forms that are not specific to the lived experience in the bodies of our players and any stereotypes of representation that might accompany them. You can, for example, have non-human models.

There is a world in VRchat created especially for ***Lumen*** called ***Convento dell'Incontro***, it has more than a passing resemblance to the old convent that housed the original run, with some augmentations. You can find it by doing a world search in the VRchat menu.

Please note that the change to VR may change the players style or tone of the game for the players. To make sure that onboarding players into VR does not overwhelm, you can prepare the players with a VR workshop to get this out of their system ahead of time. Alternatively, be prepared as you play the deity to take charge of the scene and clearly guide your players by asking questions or telling them to leave when you decide their session is over, etc.

Another possible use for the VR is to use it as a platform to meet players before the game play to build character story and/or facilitate networking opportunities. You may also choose to use it after the event to resolve narratives for characters that might have been left unfinished during runtime. Finally, players could potentially use it as a meetup space after the larp to process the larp experience or plan future adventures together, such as co-designing their own larps or attending games with one another.

If used onsite, we recommend having VR players stand at some distance from each other, or even in different rooms, so they can listen in the VR headphone without interference from their actual voices. It is also good to have someone "catch" the player as they take the headset off. People new to VR often feel a little confused or disoriented when they find themselves back in the physical world about which they had all forgotten for the last 10-20 minutes.

Costumes

We recommend having some sort of costume for Guides to wear. The same type of costume can be used narratively in the larp. Seekers can come to Lumen wearing their street clothes for the first day, then switch to their costume on the second day as a way to mark their growth at Lumen. We recommend these costumes be somewhat ceremonial in nature. Generic robes, for example, in a color of their choice, can work.

At our run, we asked them to pack some sort of robe, preferably in the Greek or Roman toga style, but not necessarily. The color of the costume could be meaningful to the character, for example to signify working with a specific Deity, or they could mean nothing. While White was the default color for Seekers, some Guides also wore white, which is perfectly fine. These costumes do not need to be fancy or expensive; indeed, it also makes sense for the narrative for it to feel awkward trying on the robes or tying them for the first time, and some players used flat bedsheets, which work well for this purpose. The important part is the experience of putting the costume on and wearing it in the group, which indicates both one's commitment to the process as well as belonging in the group. Less expensive costumes make the larp more accessible.

Click here to see the Lumen Pinterest board that we put together for our run. If this link does not work, share sample images with participants of robes in a variety of colors and shapes that are ancient Roman or Grecian inspired. If you choose another visual aesthetic, we recommend creating something similar to help inspire the players.

Importantly, we do not recommend drawing inspiration from cultures

Props and Other Materials

Similarly, we have made the larp require few props to make it easier to run. Here we present how we ran ***Lumen***, and what we believe to be the bare minimum for props and other materials.

i) Card decks, lanyards, badgeholders, and badges

For the character creation workshop, you will need approximately 2 decks of both the Archetype and Fate cards per group of 36. We recommend having some extra decks as backups just in case for some reason several

players pick the same card, though unlikely. While players can also use the Lumen AR app to browse the cards, the workshop involves them moving through the space and glancing at all the cards at the same time, which can be a helpful tactile and kinetic experience. Similarly, having the physical cards they chose during the game can help players remember the choices they made during character creation, while also becoming props in their own right during rituals and other scenes. That being said, an app-only version of the game is a more cost-effective option if available.

Throughout this larp script, you will see instructions related to badge holders. Since players need to remember information during the game, we recommend having clear plastic badge holders hanging from lanyards that serve as a pouch for the following items:

* **The badge,** which includes the name, pronouns, and role in ***Lumen*** (Seeker, Organizer, Guide, Safety, or Assistant Guide); in our run, we color-coded Safety with the Assistant Guide badges to to show the overlap of roles (see Appendix R);
* **The Deities, Powers, and Colors Cheat Sheet,** which lists this information for use in play;
* **The Archetype card** representing where they are now**,** which they choose during the character creation workshop;
* **The Archetype card** that represents their desired outcome - where they want to be.

Since paper tends to bend, we recommend either using card stock to print or using a laminator for the badge and the Deities and Powers Cheat Sheet. If you order the Archetype cards, they will come on card stock, but if you print them, they will also need to be laminated.

When ordering badge holders, make sure they are the right size for these materials. The cards are 6,99 by 12,07 cm, as are our badge templates, so we bought badge holders that were slightly larger. Ideally, they will be clear plastic and therefore mostly unnoticeable.

We also recommend providing lanyards to hold the badges to create a uniform aesthetic for the game. Since in our run, we allowed players to bring costumes of any color, we purchased slim, satin-like lanyards in multiple colors: 20 in silver, and 30 in multiple colors. Upon check-in, players were asked to choose a lanyard based on their desired aesthetics for their costume. Since some players are quite focused on the right aesthetic for their costumes, both the badge holder and the lanyard should be as discrete and complementary as possible.

You can also choose to run Lumen without badge holders, but assume some players will probably lose these initial materials over the course of the larp. One option is to give everyone a small physical journal or pouch, but again, these are more easily left somewhere. If you are unable to print the Cheat Sheet for all players, we recommend having a copy by the sashes (if using Deities).

ii) Sashes

If working with Deities or some other archetypal representation, we recommend using long, thin sashes, ideally in a soft, attractive material like faux satin. Some players are sensitive to texture, so avoid rough or jagged materials.

The sashes should correspond as closely as possible to the colors listed on the Deities, Powers, and Colors Cheat Sheet, although in practice, this can be challenging to determine, especially when ordering online. Furthermore, some players have challenges perceiving certain colors. Assure the players that the powers will still "work" regardless of the color or if wearing the sash at all. The sash is there as a support tool.

For our run of 42 players and Guides, we ordered spools of thick ribbon in 14 colors. We cut 10 long sashes (around 1mt long and 10 cm wide) from the spool in each color, which ended up being plenty.

We kept all the sashes in the Ritual room, which is also where we held Audiences. We recommend any activities that involve Deities to take place in this room if possible. Otherwise, Guides and characters should carry the sashes with them to another location if needed. We also instructed everyone to return sashes if they were done with them. Some players wanted to take their sashes home as an integration practice, so we also recommend having them available to take when players are leaving.

5 - How to play a Guide or Assistant Guide

Lumen has two types of facilitators: **Guides** and **Assistant Guides.** In practice, they serve the same functions in the game, so all the guidelines below for Guides are also relevant for Assistant Guides. However, Assistant Guides are also members of the safety team, meaning players are directed to find them if they need to process something off-game or they are feeling overwhelmed or unsafe. Having safety team members that are embedded in the fiction can sometimes help players remain engaged in the game, but can also help guide them out as needed. For this reason, Assistant Guides should avoid central duties in the game when possible, such as ritual leader duties.

In our ideal design, each Gemstone group would be supported by both a Guide and an Assistant Guide, but we realize this is unrealistic. Instead, we acknowledge that sometimes Assistant Guides will be unavailable, for example if overseeing the playtests from the Scenario Design Task. For this reason, ***Lumen*** also recommends having an off-game safety team available during all waking hours.

Guides are present in ***Lumen*** to provide structure and support for the player-characters. Learning something new or experimenting with new ways of behaving can be intimidating or frustrating. Guides are there to provide an anchor for the Gemstone groups during the process of figuring out their goals for the retreat, learning how to draw power from the Deities (if included), designing their scenarios, running the playtests, helping characters navigate conflicts, and processing content relevant to the character's personal lives.

These tasks require a certain set of skills. Guides should be mature, supportive, emotionally intelligent, and good at active listening. They should be willing to hold space for difficult conversations. However, they should also be good with setting boundaries or delegating to others if they feel overwhelmed by a situation, e.g., the safety team.

The most important principle to understand when playing a Guide is that you are in a power position over the players, whether you perceive it that way or not. Fictionally, your character knows much more about what happens at Hope and what to expect than the Seeker characters. Outside of the fiction, you are a part of the organizing team, which means you have been granted a certain amount of status as a trusted member of the team. Some players will come from play cultures in which facilitators have control over the plot or what happens to the player-characters.

In ***Lumen***, we try to use this power wisely -- to help characters navigate their personal challenges and social dynamics with others. Guides are not there to generate content for players like performers, but rather to hold the space in such a way that players feel safe enough to be honest and vulnerable through their characters. With this intention in mind, we have some practical advice for playing a Guide.

Guides should not focus the larp on their own invented plots or personal needs. In some larps, mentor characters are instructed to give tasks to players to generate play for them. This is

not the case at ***Lumen***, unless those tasks relate to the character's personal development and agreed upon through role-play. For example, if a character is struggling letting go of a loved one, the Guide might suggest the Gemstone group create a goodbye ritual to help them. Such a task is not connected to the Guide or their personal story. This is important because players can sometimes ignore their own storylines when presented with organizer-generated plots, thinking these plots hold important secrets or will lead them to cool scenes in the game. While Guides should develop their own personal story -- ideally through participating in the character creation workshop with one another, this story should not become important to role-playing with the Seekers. The difference is a subtle nuance that can be difficult to navigate practically, but please internalize it.

Additionally, Guides should do their best not to interrupt players, lecture them with information, or otherwise dominate the scene. While a dynamic Guide can help players go deeper into character or kickstart a scene when players are unsure what to do, they can also easily take over the scene. Unless you are explaining something important, like the structure of the Scenario Design Task worksheet, the goal is not for you to transmit information or be the center of attention. Rather, you should engage in supportive, active listening to help them better understand themselves or process something that will help them get to the next stage of their development.

Ask consent before touching players, e.g., "May I hold your hands?" or "May I give you a hug?" They may feel quite vulnerable at ***Lumen***, and touch can sometimes feel unsafe for people in such states. On the other hand, touch helps some players feel more relaxed and connected. Through consent negotiations, you can determine what feels best for you, individual players, and the Gemstone group as a whole.

The same is true when sharing personal information about your characters, or encouraging Seekers to do so. Make sure you remember the X-Carded topics from the workshops and remind players about them if needed. For example, if a character starts to tell a story about being bullied, you can say, "Off-game: Does everyone here consent to discussions of bullying?" If the characters want to enact bullying in a scene, such as during the Scenario Design Task, you can gently remind them that such explicit play is not allowed at ***Lumen*** and to find another way to represent the bullying through play, for example, symbolically through one of the character looming over the bullied character. You can also recommend they play the scene somewhere private if possible, for example if the scene is likely to involve yelling or intimidating postures.

Ultimately, the Guide is not only a facilitator for the structure of the game, but also an emotional support for the player-characters. If you are not comfortable processing personal content with player-characters, dealing with intense emotions, or feel you lack the skillset to support others in this way, playing a Guide may not be the right role for you. You can instead, for example, work on the logistics or the tech team, which also serve a vital function for the game.

6 - Inclusion of Deities and powers

Including Deities and powers associated with them can be a powerful way to jumpstart experiences of transformation. However, you should consider carefully if you wish to do this, and if so, how.

a) Considerations for Deities, rituals, and other spiritual content

In our run of ***Lumen***, we used the Roman pantheon for our deities, as the larp was run in Florence by an Italian team with Greek partners. One of the main designers is of direct Italian descent and holds neo-pagan spiritual beliefs. Keep in mind that even if you have consultants on the team who have these backgrounds, players may still find the content objectionable. This is a risk to take seriously whenever working with spiritual and/or religious themes.

Along these lines, we do not recommend appropriating the cultures of others, e.g., exoticizing Eastern spiritual traditions, borrowing practices from Indigenous communities. This practice can feel deeply offensive and even harmful, even when done based on research and respect. This issue is especially important if the culture in question has been erased, modified, or stolen from dominant cultures through processes of imperialism and colonialism. Of course, history can be complicated, even when considering the Greek influences on the Roman pantheon and current controversies around stolen historical artifacts.

Similarly, words like channeling and possession by Deities have specific spiritual meanings in some cultures, which is why we have avoided using them and recommend you do so as well. From our perspective, aspecting is a safer word, meaning invoking aspects of the Deity while communicating with others, sometimes also called embodiment.

Instead of using these words, we recommend you say something more general, such as “drawing from the power of the Deities” or “gaining insight from the Deities,” which do not connote specific spiritual practices in existing traditions. In this regard, we are not “playing” the Deity, but rather becoming inspired by the archetype within it. Similarly, you should be careful not to play a caricature of the Deity, but rather consider what qualities you perceive that Deity to possess, and try to emulate those. We have made suggestions along these lines for the powers. For example, when working with Jupiter in our game, characters could not throw thunderbolts, but they could assume an air of greater authority or leadership in-game.

You may wish to avoid using or adapting existing or historical religions completely. Alternatively, you can adopt a You Know What You Know (YKWYK) philosophy, in that your character has the same knowledge base as you as a player. If you learned about Roman mythology mainly from books, so did your

character. If you have participated in neo-pagan rituals using the pantheon, so did your character. This approach also acknowledges any biases or cultural appropriation that might be inherent to your knowledge base. If you know mainly about indigenous rituals through reading early Western anthropologists who never participated in them, make that clear. If you learned a specific Eastern meditation practice from a White Westerner, disclose that. In Lumen, we decided to work with well-known Deities spread through imperialism that still have a strong impact on popular culture and neo-spiritual practices.

Importantly, religion and spirituality are not the focus of Lumen, but rather a fictional way to create permission -- called alibi -- for players to discover and express less developed aspects of themselves. We believe in the power of ritual and archetypes, and in embodying them to discover competencies within us we did not know we had. Similarly, the larp is based strongly on theories in depth psychology developed by Carl Jung. In depth psychology, engaging with archetypes through practices of active imagination can lead to experiences of personal transformation called individuation, especially when well-integrated after the experience. The archetypes in character creation obviously serve this purpose, as do working with Deities who are fairly ubiquitous in Western culture and already have cultural associations attached to them.

Similarly, we follow the work of Victor Turner in believing that ritual is an inherent component of human social organization that is critical for building and maintaining community cohesion. Larp itself is a ritual, and playing rituals within rituals can lead to deeper states of immersion and insights that might not be gained without the activity. The use of one's physical movements, voice, and instruments are common cross-culturally. While we cannot always divorce our practices from our previous knowledge of cultures, we recommend being careful not to adopt clear practices from existing traditions unless you are deeply embedded within them, e.g., specific dances, vocalizations, or drumming practices.

You may wish to bypass the Deities altogether and adopt the concepts instead as archetypes. Drawing from Plato, such archetypes can also be found in more abstract concepts, such as Virtue and Love. That being said, if you find it meaningful in your local context to work with spiritual material relevant to your own background, we encourage you to localize the game accordingly, e.g., Nordic players choosing to work with the Norse pantheon.

Importantly, your organizers and players alike may have vastly different spiritual or religious beliefs, especially in an international context. Some players may believe in spiritual practices such as drawing on the power of gods, whereas others may view such practices as purely fictional. Again, while we are not recommending larping actual spiritual practices here, we encourage you to be accepting of a plurality of views here, from atheism to devotion, and to encourage such acceptance in your players. For example, you could make activities that feature Deities optional and make sure not to include them in any mandatory group rituals.

Whatever you choose to do, we strongly recommend signposting this content and how you will work with it in-game on your website before sign-up and in communications leading up to the larp so that players can opt-out if needed and manage expectations accordingly.

If you would like to learn more about how we recommend working with culture, archetypes, and spirituality, see our textbooks.

b) How to play a Deity

On a more practical note, we recommend that you do not consider the Deity a fully-fledged character with a personality and backstory. Instead, work with the Deity as a source of power, insight, and inspiration. Our experience is that working with archetypes can sometimes give you access to wisdom you did not know you had. This is the principle to focus upon in Deity audiences. You are not role-playing the deity themselves; you are role-playing your own character drawing power and insight from your conception of a Deity. That role-play can include a change of voice or posture and/or include lessons from that Deity's backstory into your communication, but the character is still fully present. Alternatively, you can simply wear the

sash and role-play as your character, imagining yourself feeling emboldened by these granted powers.

Importantly, powers should not be used to force effects on other people or overpower them. This principle is especially important for Guides, who are already in a power position over Seekers. The powers are intended to help bolster existing qualities within you and your players that are underdeveloped, suppressed, or otherwise invisible.

Thus, when characters request Audiences with the Deities, try to figure out what is most needed by the character. Are they wanting to switch careers to become an artisan? Then, drawing strength from Vulcan might be appropriate. Are they wanting to find true love and a committed relationship? Then interacting with Venus might be beneficial for them. On the other hand, if they struggle with hurt from past relationships, working with Persephine might be more appropriate.

Therefore, you should familiarize yourself with the basics of the Deities provided in this document. Ask questions of the characters and use your own intuition to suggest which Deity might be best to work with. When you agree upon a Deity, take the associated colored sash. If in a main room, ask the Seeker to lead you to a less crowded or public space of their choosing based on what feels most appropriate for them. As these scenes can be quite powerful, sometimes players feel vulnerable in group settings or loud rooms if they need to express strong emotions. Ideally, you will still stay close to the main play space, especially if you are also on the safety team, so that others can find you if needed.

Then, tie the colored sash associated with that Deity around a part of your body that makes it visible, e.g., your wrist, arm, or neck. Wrists are helpful because they move along with the player's hand, marking a clear visual distinction. We recommend some sort of cue in your role-playing to indicate that you are now connected to the Deity, whether verbal or non-verbal. Maybe your posture is more erect, or you say, "I commune with Venus to better understand the mysteries of love."

Similarly, make it clear when you are breaking this connection with the Deity. One technique is to ask the Seeker if they would like to try on the sash. That way, they can connect with the archetype on their own rather than relying on you, which is important for personal transformation. To use the previous examples, once the sash is off, your posture could slump to indicate returning fully to your character, or you could say, "Wow, I had never thought about love in that way."

Importantly, your role as a Guide in the larp is not to tell the Seekers what to do. You can provide guidance, but asking questions that lead them to their own truth can be much more empowering than giving explicit direction. You can also focus on your own experience through the use of "I"-Statements, for example, "When I experience love, I accept that I will have to also accept I may lose that love. What is it like for you?" That gives the Seekers an opportunity to either resonate with the statement or counter it, again, guiding them to their own answers.

Try to limit these scenes to 5-15 minutes if possible, especially if few Guides are available. Others may be waiting. Ideally, your scenes catalyze further interactions between the Seekers, rather than incentivizing them to interact solely with you as a Guide. If you are not sure how to end the scene, you can always say, "I'm afraid I will need to take the sash off now. Connecting with the Deity is exhausting for me.

7 - Modules

While we have described the larp with all the elements we have designed included in this book, we recommend considering a modular approach when considering these parts. Indeed, we have included as appendices some of the designed elements we did not end up including. You may have several days or only one day with your participants. You may only have time for a brief Lesson or Workshop. We recommend considering which parts you find most central to your goals with your particular target group, as well as any financial or logistical considerations you might have.

a) Core Lumen modules

The following modules are considered core to the full *Lumen* experience. In some cases, you can find scripts for these modules in the Appendices below. In other cases, we recommend building your own scripts based upon the descriptions we have provided in previous chapters.

* **Introductory Briefing:** World Briefing, Learning Objectives, Narrative Arc
* **Workshop:** X-Cards and Veils
* **Lecture:** Transformative Role-playing Game Design
* **Workshop:** How to Play this Larp
* **Workshop:** Metatechniques
* **Workshop:** Safety
* **Lesson 1:** Transformative Leisure Design
* **Lesson 2:** Ritual
* **Lesson 3:** Identity
* **Lesson 4:** Conflict
* **Lesson 5:** Inclusion
* **Lesson 6:** Culture Design
* **Workshop:** Character Creation and Relations

During game core modules

* **Ritual:** Welcome
* **Workshop:** Goals (Day 1)
* **Workshop:** Deity Embodiment
* **Deity Audiences** (Day 1)
* **Ritual:** Closing (Day 1)
* **Workshop:** Challenging Pairs
* **Workshop:** Goals for Scenario Design Task
* **Scenario Design Task with Worksheet**
* **Scenario Playtests**
* **Ritual:** Encountering Challenge
* **Deity Audiences** (Day 2)
* **Ritual:** Claiming (Day 2)

Post-game core modules

* **Debrief Script:** Mid-game
* **Debrief Script:** End of Game

b) Additional modules

We have also designed additional modules you might want to include:

Pre-game additional modules

* **Workshop:** Plot Design
* **Introductory materials:** Dearest V Plot

c) Introductory and logistical materials

We have also included some introductory and logistical materials that you can use or adapt when running ***Lumen***.

* Website Text
* Player's Handbook
* Deities, Colors, and Powers
* Badges
* Lumen Deity Cheat Sheet

d) Essential Lumen modules

If you only have time to run the most essential elements of ***Lumen***, we recommend prioritizing the following run-time activities.

* **Ritual:** Welcome
* **Workshop:** Goals for Scenario Design Task
* **Scenario Design Task with Worksheet**
* **Scenario Playtests**
* **Ritual:** Claiming

Untested content

Please note that the following modules were either written after the run of Lumen, or were not tested as a part of that game:

* Workshop: Challenging Pairs
* Ritual: Encountering Challenge
* Lesson 7: Embodiment 101

Schedule for the Core Modules

Day 1: Pre-game

* Breakfast (1 hr)
* **Introductory Briefing and Goals Workshop** (45 min)
* **Workshop:** X-Cards and Veils (15 minutes)
* Break (15 min)
* **Lecture:** Transformative Role-playing Game Design (1 hr)
* Break (15 min)
* **Workshop:** How to Play this Larp (30 min)
* **Workshop:** Metatechniques (15 minutes)
* Lunch (1 hr)
* **Workshop:** Safety (1 hour)
* Break (15 min)
* **Lesson 1:** Transformative Leisure Design (45 min)
* Break (15 min)
* **Lesson 2:** Ritual (45 min)
* Break (15 min)
* **Lesson 3:** Identity (45 min)
* Dinner (1 hr)
* **Lesson 4:** Conflict (45 min)
* Break (15 min)
* **Lesson 5:** Inclusion (45 min)
* Break (15 min)
* **Lesson 6:** Culture Design (45 min)
* Free time (2 hrs 15 min)

Day 2: Pre-game

* Breakfast: 1 hr
* **Workshop:** Character Creation and Relations (2 hrs 30 min)
* Calibration time (30 min)
* Lunch: 1 hr
* Costuming time (1 hr)

Day 2: During game

* **Ritual:** Welcome (30 min)
* Getting to know your Gemstone group (1 hr)
* **Workshop:** Goals (Day 1) (1 hr)
* Free time: (1 hr 30 min)
* Dinner: 1 hr
* **Workshop:** Deity Embodiment (1 hr)
* **Free time and Deity Audiences** (Day 1) (1 hr 30 min)
* **Ritual:** Closing (Day 1) (30 min)
* **Debrief Script:** Mid-game (1 hr)
* Free time: (1 hr)

Day 3: During game

* Breakfast: 1 hr
* **Workshop:** Challenging Pairs (1 hr)
* Free time: 1 hr
* **Workshop:** Goals for Scenario Design Task (1 hr)
* Lunch in Supportive Pair to discuss scenario ideas: 1 hr
* **Scenario Design Task with Worksheet** (1 hr)
* Break: 30 min
* **Scenario Playtest 1** (45 min)
* Break: 15 min
* **Scenario Playtest 2** (45 min)
* Break: 15 min
* **Scenario Playtest 3** (45 min)
* Break: 15 min
* **Scenario Playtest 4** (45 min)
* Dinner: 1 hr
* **Ritual:** Encountering Challenge (1 hr)
* **Free time and Deity Audiences** (Day 1) (1 hr 30 min)
* **Ritual:** Closing (Day 1) (30 min)

Day 3: Post-game

* (Optional for players) Debrief Script: Mid-game (1 hr)

Day 4: Post-game

* Breakfast: 1 hr
* Debrief Script: End of Game (1 hr+)

b) Additional modules

We have also designed additional modules you might want to include:

Pre-game additional modules

* **Workshop:** Plot Design
* **Introductory materials:** Dearest V Plot

8 – List of Appendices

- Appendix A -- Introductory Briefings:
  - World Briefing
  - Learning Objectives
  - Narrative Arc
  - Lecture:Transformative Role-playing Game Design
- Appendix B -- Deities, Colors, and Powers
- Appendix C -- Workshop: How to Play this Larp
- Appendix D -- Workshop: Metatechniques
- Appendix E -- Workshop: Safety
- Appendix F -- Lessons
  - Lesson 1: Transformative Leisure Design
  - Lesson 2: Ritual
  - Lesson 3: Identity
  - Lesson 4: Conflict
  - Lesson 5: Inclusion
  - Lesson 6: Culture Design
- Appendix G -- Workshop: Character Creation
- Appendix H -- Workshop: Deity Embodiment
- Appendix I -- Workshop: Challenging Pairs
- Appendix J -- Scenario Design Task with Worksheet
- Appendix K -- Ritual: Encountering Challenge
- Appendix L -- Debrief Scripts: Mid-Game and End of Larp
- Appendix M -- Website Text
- Appendix N -- Archetype Cards
- Appendix O -- Fate / Relationship Cards
- Appendix P -- Workshop: Plot Design
- Appendix Q -- Introductory materials: Dearest V Plot
- Appendix R -- ID Cards and Deity cheat sheets

Appendix A— Introductory Briefings

World Briefing, Learning Objectives, Narrative Arc

[The style of this session should be welcoming and enthusiastic. It is a bit of an infodump, so keeping the energy levels up is a good plan!]

Introduction

[Give a welcome that is accurate for the time of day, for example "Good morning everyone, I hope you rested well and have enjoyed breakfast!]

The plan for this session is as follows: I am going to give you an overview of the storyworld for this game, talk through the learning objectives, and give you an overview of the narrative structure of the game. We'll have a break after that, and then we will spend the rest of the session creating characters and relationships between them right up until the break which should be at around [Time]

The big round of pronouns

Get everyone to introduce themselves, their pronouns, and to say where they are from. This should include the guides as well, who can introduce themselves.

World Briefing

Welcome to Lumen. This is a larp about a group of seeming strangers – the seekers – who attend a retreat at a mysterious location known as Hope.

There is magic to be found at Hope, for those who truly need it. Through unorthodox rituals and mystical practices the seekers confront their deepest struggles and guide others through processes of transformation.

Secrets unravel, bonds form, and relationships are tested. Will they find healing—or something far more unexpected?

Lumen takes place in an analog of the real world, or at least a version of the real world where magic exists. In the Storyworld, the location called Hope is a place where magic exists, and this magic, combined with the theories and techniques taught there allows the characters to perform rituals that have real effects on their lives and the lives of others.

The metaphysics of how and why this works is not important to the larp. Your characters might want to think about it or to talk about it, but investigating it is not a part of the game design. We ask that you explore the fantastic element and the delight of this revelation, but don't try to deconstruct it.

Time moves differently in Hope. This does not mean that people have been here for hundreds of years, but that it is possible to lose track of the passing of time because of the wonders found in this place.

Learning Objectives

During this larp we will teach you how to design, playtest, and give feedback on transformative role-playing games with specific growth-related goals.

You will also have the opportunity to

explore through play your own specific growth-related goal(s) and to assist other participants in exploring their own.

You will have an opportunity to apply theories and best practices of transformative analog role-playing game design within a larp experience.

Narrative Arc

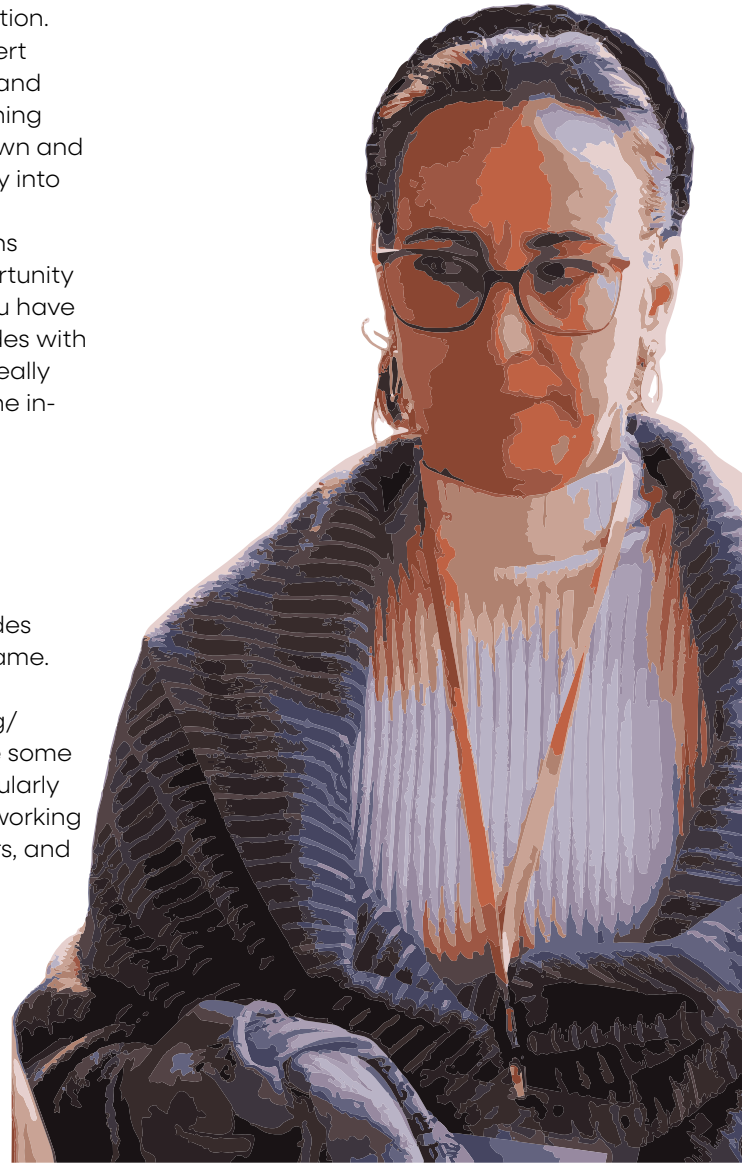
Lumen has a three act structure. Act one will start today at around [insert time] and will run through until [insert time]. This Act deals with your character's arrival at Hope, the discovery of the magic that can be found in this place and an introduction to the methods of transformation.

Act 2 will be [insert time] until [insert time] and during that you will learn more and practice some of these methods by designing and performing rituals to help both your own and one another's characters by putting theory into practice.

Act 3 starts at [insert time] and runs through until [insert time] . This is the opportunity for you to resolve the narrative threads you have created together, possibly to help the guides with their own transformational journeys, and really to try out what you have learned during the in-game classes inside the story.

Lecture 1

On the following pages we present the slides used for the introductory lecture for the game. You will also find a link to these slides with the printed materials at https://zenodo.org/records/21859459. You will need to change some of the information for your own run, particularly when it comes to introducing the people working on your team. Appendix B — Deities, Colors, and Powers



TRANSFORMATIVE PLAY
INITIATIVE
Welcome and Goal Setting Workshop
Sarah Lynne Bowman
UPPSALA
UNIVERSITET
Presentation at Lumen larp for Erasmus+ EDGE -- October 2, 2025

The Team

Welcome to Lumen!

- This larp is created for the **Erasmus+ EDGE project**
  - A Cooperation Partnership in Higher Education
  - **5 partners:**
    - Uppsala University (Sweden)
    - Avalon Larp Studio (Norway)
    - Chaos League (Italy)
    - Turku University of Applied Sciences (Finland)
    - Dragon's Nest (Greece)

3

Meet the Onsite Team

Logistics: (blue badge)

- **Alessandro Giovannucci** and **Mafalda Morganti** (Chaos League)
- **Taisto Suominen** and **Pirjoriitta Peltola** (Turku University of Applied Sciences)

Guides (blue badge):

- **Josefin Westborg** (Uppsala University)
- **Halfdan Keller Justesen** (Avalon Larp Studio)
- **David Bussak** and **Clista Townsend** (Volunteers)

Assistant Guides / Safety Team (purple badge):

- **Kjell Hedgard Hugaas** and **Sarah Lynne Bowman** (Uppsala University)
- **Josephine Rydberg** (Volunteer)

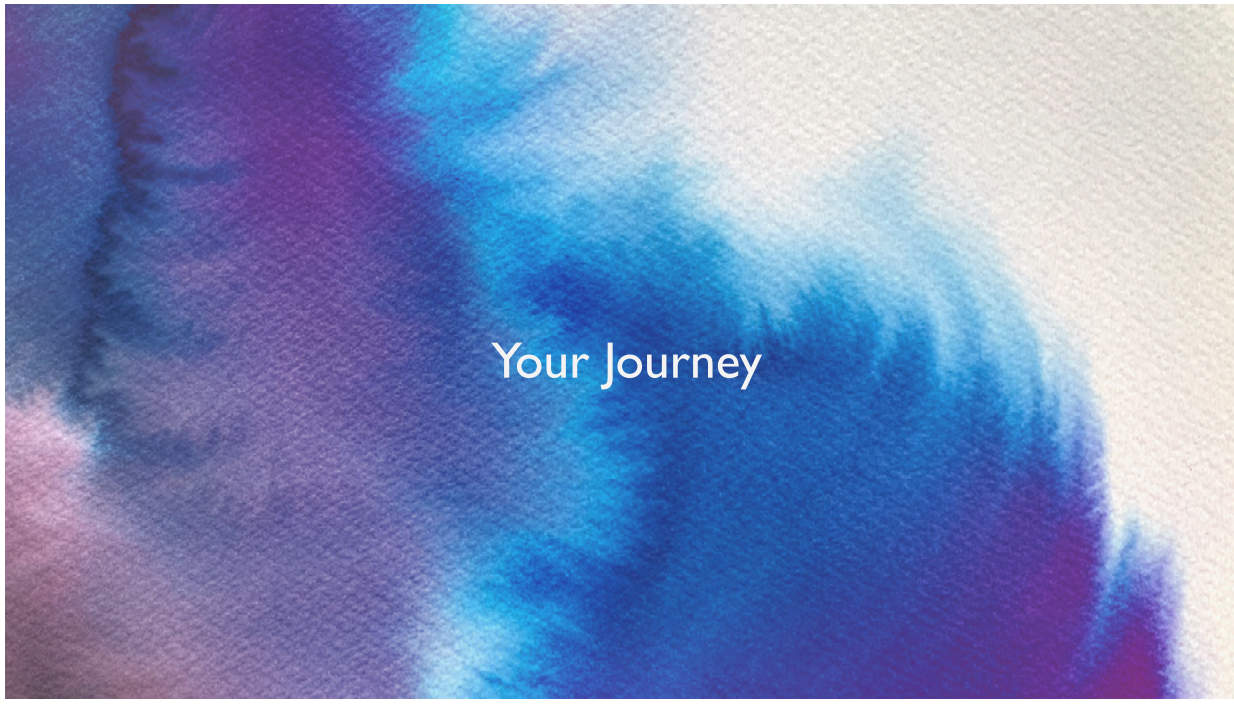
4

Big Thanks to the Remote Team

- **Simon Brind, Sagalinn Tangen,** and **Martine Svanevik** (Avalon)
- **Elektra Diakolambrianou** and **Angie Bandhoesingh** (Dragon's Nest)
- **Andrea Giovannucci** (Avalon)
- **Dimitra Nikolaidou** (Volunteer)

With us in spirit!

5



The Setting at Lumen

Welcome to **Lumen**. This is a larp about a group of seeming strangers – the seekers – who attend a retreat at a mysterious location known as Hope.

There is **magic** to be found at Hope, for those who truly need it. Through **unorthodox rituals** and **mystical practices** the seekers confront their d**eepest struggles** and guide others through **processes of transformation.**

Secrets unravel, bonds form, and relationships are tested. **Will they find healing**—or something far more unexpected?

7

The Setting at Lumen

Embrace the **journey of change,** build a **community**, **support** others, and **rediscover hope** in this unique, immersive experience.

Lumen is designed to **teach elements of transformational analog role-playing game design** through play itself.

9

The Setting at Lumen

Costuming:

- You are Seekers at Hope. You can choose to wear your ritual costumes the entire time, or only part of the time. (Same principle for Guides)
- For sure, please wear your ritual attire **Saturday and Sunday.**

10

The Setting at Lumen

Your choice:

- On Saturday, you will be asked to make a choice as your character. **Your options:**
  - **Stay** as a Guide at Lumen, helping new Seekers
  - **Leave** Lumen spreading transformative play to others in the outside world
  - Some other choice of your own.
- **Don't worry about the choice now.**
  - We will revisit it on Saturday, but you can role-play around it if you wish.

11

Activities at Lumen

Practically:

- We will spend much of our times in **lessons**, which will teach you how to design for:
  - Transformative goals
  - Ritual activities
  - Personal and social conflicts
  - Culture
- Unlike other "school larps," because of the educational content, all activities are opt-out, instead of opt-in
  - You can leave at any time, but the default is to attend all activities

Educational Journey

12

Activities at Lumen

Practically, you will also:

- Design a 45 minute nano-game for one another, practicing with the tools you were taught, played in groups of 3-4 (your core groups, or **gemstone groups**)
  - You will learn who your design partner and gemstone group are tomorrow during the character creation workshop
- We will explain the design task in more detail in the coming days and help you in the process

Educational Journey

13

Activities at Lumen

Practically, you will also:

- **Off-game:** Choose a personally relevant goal for yourself that you wish to explore at Lumen
- **In-game:** Your character will also have a goal, which your design partner will use to construct an experience for you.
    - This goal can be the same as your off-game goal or different, but ideally should be related
    - Your goals can change over time, just inform your design partner

Personal Journey

Activities at Lumen

Your objective:

- To try to find a balance between the two
- You will be assigned a Guide, who is here to help you

Educational Journey

Personal Journey

The Technology

Lumen Players Wifi

- The WiFi network for players is named LumenLarpes and the password is the name
- WiFi coverage is strongest near the GM Room
- Please avoid heavy use of the WiFi, as the organisers also need access for their work.
- We may temporarily disable the LumenLarpes WiFi to ensure the organisers have reliable internet access. Thank you for your understanding.

LumenLarpers

Password: LumenLarpers

17

Transformative Goals

Bowman and Hugaas (2019) detailed four categories of transformative goals on Nordiclarp.org:

1. **Emotional Processing**
2. **Social Cohesion**
3. **Educational Goals**
4. **Political Aims**

We will hand out worksheets with more details.

19

Transformative Goals

Spend **five (5) minutes** reading through these categories.

- Circle **one (1) primary goal** for your personal journey (or write one yourself).

20

Transformative Goals

Then, spend ten (10) minutes introducing yourself to another participant:

1) Name
2) Pronouns
3) Your goals
4) Any fears or apprehensions you have coming into this experience

21

X-Card and Veils

Role-playing communities have developed safety tools for dealing with sensitive content

- **X-Card (tabletop):** Point to an X, make an X with your arms in larp, state content
  - Remove content from the game, no questions asked
  - Similar to a Line
  - **Example:** X-Card: romantic play with my character

- **Veils:** This content can still exist / this action still takes place, but we don't enact it through play
  - Similar to "fade to black"
  - **Example:** Veil on romantic scenes with my character

X-Card and Veils

Global themes we will not **enact** in play:

- Child abuse
- Bullying
- Sexual abuse
- Animal cruelty
- Domestic violence
- Present threat of suicide

Note: These topics may be part of a character's backstory.

You may discuss these topics with others **only if you obtain consent first from everyone present.**

24

X-Card and Veils

We will now pass around **two (2) notecards.**

Please write down anonymously on each card:

- Additional X-carded topics you wish to add **(if applicable)**
- Any content you wish to draw a line around **(if applicable)**

You will have two (2) duplicates.

- Keep **one (1)** to bring with you tomorrow to the Character Creation Workshop.
- Hand **one (1)** to Kjell, who will collect them.
    - We will discuss any new global themes tomorrow as well

25

Questions?

Lumen Transformative Goal Workshop Handout

Spend **five (5) minutes** reading through these categories. Circle **one (1) primary goal** for your **personal journey** (or write one yourself).

1. Emotional Processing

- Exploring aspects of self/selves
- Exploring aspects of personal experience
- Shadow work
- Trauma/Grief processing
- Building confidence
- Practicing emotional regulation
- Catharsis
- Practicing mindfulness/ Meta-awareness
- Transforming the ego
- Identifying/practicing personality traits
- Reframing past experiences
- Being seen/Witnessed
- Recognizing desires/Fears
- Self-expression
- Sense of belonging
- _____

2. Social Cohesion

- Increasing empathy
- Teamwork
- Leadership
- Holding space
- Conflict resolution/Transformation
- Prosocial communication
- Perspective taking
- Collaboration/Co-creation/Cooperation
- Building understanding
- Exploring intimacy/Relationship dynamics
- Exploring community dynamics
- _____

3. Educational Goals

- Intrinsic motivation
- Content exposure/Mastery
- Promoting active engagement
- Self-efficacy/Perceived competence
- Multitasking
- Problem solving
- Scenario building
- Creative thinking/Innovation
- Critical thinking
- Skill training
- Understanding systems
- _____

4. Political Aims

- Raising awareness
- Challenging default assumptions
- Paradigm shifting
- Promoting activism
- Social engineering
- Persuasion/Rhetoric
- Critical ethical reasoning
- Debate
- Global citizenship
- Expansion of worldview
- _____

Appendix B — Deities, Colors, and Powers

Initiate Color: White

Jupiter: Gold

The King of the Roman Pantheon is Jupiter, who rules over Mount Olympus and is the god of thunder and lightning, as well as law and order. You can recognise Jupiter by his symbols — the thunderbolt, the eagle and the oak tree — and as a sky god he is often shown among clouds or sitting on top of Mount Olympus.

Jupiter is a powerful and brazen figure. At Olympus, he rules over the gods and humans alike, peering down at the mortals from the mountaintop. When angry, Jupiter often punishes by calling forth mighty lightning bolts to express his displeasure. Jupiter is known to beguile and seduce mortals by turning himself into an animal or mating with them in a transformed state. These dalliances are viewed by his wife Juno as infidelities, and he often faces her wrath, but he is king, after all, and so the behavior continues. When one views the whole world as one's domain, the needs of others can become secondary.

Possible themes: structural authority, systems, anger issues, fatherhood, infidelity, masc authority figures, ruling.

Power: Authority and leadership

Juno: Silver

Juno is the wife and sister of Jupiter, and is queen of the gods. Her symbols are the peacock, the cuckoo and the cow — animals she considered sacred — and her chariot is pulled by peacocks instead of horses.

Juno is the goddess of marriage, childbirth, and fertility. Although she is often depicted as reserved and calm, she often seeks revenge for Jupiter's many affairs with mortal and immortal women, punishing them and their offspring. The common phrase "Hell hath no fury like a woman scorned" could very well be rephrased to describe Hera on Olympus.

Possible themes: marriage, pregnancy, childbirth, motherhood, femme authority figures, jealousy.

Power: Righteousness and determination

Neptune: Navy Blue

God of the sea, horses, and earthquakes, Neptune is often shown driving a chariot of horses or sea creatures and wielding the trident he used to control the waves.

As his brothers Jupiter and Pluto rule the skies and the underworld, Neptune was given control of the sea and protected sailors and seafarers. However, Neptune can also cause misfortune if not given due respect, such as shipwrecks, isolation on islands in the sea, or becoming lost. Neptune is the god of powerful emotions and unconscious drives. If Jupiter represents one's conscious will, Neptune's realm are the uncontrolled thoughts and chaotic dreams that lie below the surface. Although easily angered, especially when ignored or overlooked, Neptune also represents a more sensitive, vulnerable masculine figure, one more in touch with the emotional rhythms that influence our actions.

Possible themes: Travel and exploration, diving deeper, dealing with the aftermath of a natural disaster, being emotionally overwhelmed, learning to "surf the wave" of life's highs and lows, sensitive masculinity, feeling like you're drowning and learning to swim.

Power: Emotional calm in the storm and adventurousness

Mars: Red

You can recognise Mars by his armour and weapons — usually a spear and a shield — and the god is sometimes accompanied by a boar or a vulture. Mars was seen as second only to Jupiter, and was considered to be the protector of Rome.

The son of Jupiter and Juno, Mars is the god of violent warfare. While his half-sister Minerva represents the more "noble" and wise aspects of civil conduct during war, Mars was revered as a disciplined warrior and divine strategist, a god whose strength was guided by purpose. His superior skill, raw power, and unwavering confidence in his own abilities make him an attractive patron for warriors of many kinds, whether engaged in violence or more ruthless forms of "peaceful" conflict. Because Mars is the energy of competition in motion, he bestows strength and emboldens action with righteous fury; whether such righteousness is warranted or not is open to debate.

Possible themes: Surviving war, violence, abuse, competition, righteousness, dealing with conflict, being at war with others or yourself.

Power: Strength and protection in conflict

Minerva: Grey or Light Blue

Mars' half-sister is the goddess Minerva. Goddess of reason, handicraft, wisdom, and war, she is the daughter of Jupiter and according to legend, sprang fully grown from his forehead, dressed in armour. Minerva is often shown wearing a helmet to demonstrate her prowess in war, and her symbols include the owl and the olive tree.

Minerva is known for her cunning and strategic mind. Because wisdom guides her actions in war, she is always several steps ahead of her opponents. Unlike Mars, who enjoys war, Minerva sees the consequences of actions far down the line. Thus, she is also associated with peaceful negotiations and diplomacy, as many times the least costly strategy is to avoid war altogether. Minerva is also a patron of the arts and often chooses heroes and heroines to sponsor, granting them special gifts and advantages in return for doing her bidding. Such heroes often serve as proxies for her various maneuvers and plans.

Possible themes: Diplomacy and compromise; building and deconstructing your "armour"; learning vulnerability; dealing with control issues; planning long-term strategies.

Power: Wisdom and strategizing

Ceres: Light Brown/Beige

Ceres is the goddess of agriculture and the harvest. She is often depicted with crops such as barley and wheat, or a cornucopia of produce. She was the mother of Proserpina who was abducted by Pluto and forced to live in the underworld for six months of the year. According to mythology, when her daughter was abducted, Ceres searched for her continuously, preoccupied with grief, and as a result, her attention was diverted from the harvest and plants began to die. When Proserpina returned for part of the year, Ceres cared for the earth again and things began to grow and this cycle was said to create the seasons.

Ceres presides over the fertility of the earth and the natural cycle of life and death. While Juno represents the act of motherhood and Venus represents desire in lovemaking, Ceres is the embodiment of fecundity itself -- the very essence of bringing life into existence. She presides over the natural cycles of growth, abundance, and fallowness, promising a return to nourishment once more even when all seems dark, cold, and barren. Thus, creation itself is also Ceres' domain, as is coping with loss when something is uncreated and needs to pass on to the underworld. Ceres also holds hope for those

undergoing a deep descent of the soul, holding the light of renewal to remind them how to ascend yet again.

Possible themes: Fertility, grieving a person, recovering after the loss of a child/miscarriage, being estranged from family, relationship with one's child, finding/celebrating life after death, holding hope.

Power: Providing comfort and tending to growth

Apollo: Orange

Apollo is the only god in the classical pantheon to share the same name in both Greek and Roman traditions. The twin brother of Diana, Apollo has many associations including the sun, music, archery, prophecy, and healing. His symbols include (naturally enough) the sun; a bow and arrow; a lyre; and a swan. Apollo and Diana were the children of Jupiter and Latona. On hearing of Latona's pregnancy, Juno — Jupiter's wife — banned Latona from giving birth on land. Latona found the island of Delos (in the Cyclades archipelago of Greece), which was a "floating" island and wasn't anchored to the mainland, and gave birth to Apollo and Diana safely there. When the twins were born, swans are said to have circled the island seven times — hence their association with Apollo — and the island later became sacred to him.

Apollo is a proud and vain god, representing the golden son who is skilled at many things and easily excels. His domain is the intellect, which includes logic, but also divine insight and inspiration. Thus, Apollo is often the patron of scholars, musicians, and mystics alike who seek a clear channel to enlightened expression and mastery. Physical prowess is also associated with Apollo, who like his sister Diana favors the sharp precision of the bow and arrow. Like his father, Apollo has been known to take liberties with humans, especially maidens, coveting their purity of soul for his own use. Thus, Apollo is also associated with the oracular, cryptic wisdom flowing through the women mystics who countless kings and paupers alike have consulted for clues to their fates. The Romans also viewed Apollo as a source of political stability and medical knowledge, as well as a guardian against infectious disease.

Possible themes: Excellence in the arts, academia, intellect, prophecy, divine insight, law, healing from a specific wound/trauma, physical therapy, planning for the future, success, skill, sons.

Power: Foresight and inspiration

Diana: Dark Brown

Apollo's twin sister Diana is the goddess of the hunt, wild animals, and childbirth. She is often shown with a stag or hunting dog. You can recognise her as the only goddess who wears a shorter dress, with the hem lifted and tied with a belt so she can run with ease. One of her most famous myths is the story of the hunter, Actaeon. According to Ovid's ***Metamorphoses***, Actaeon stumbled into Diana's grove as she bathed, catching a glimpse of the goddess naked. In retribution, she splashed him with water, cursing him and transforming him into a deer, and he was subsequently killed by his own hunting dogs.

Diana is the goddess of the natural world. Unlike Ceres, who represents the human-made practice of agriculture according to the seasonal wheel, Diana's domain is wild nature, forests, and animals untouched by human hands. She is the champion and protectress of anyone in need of protection from men, especially maidens and others who have been subject to violence and subjugation. Diana teaches such individuals the wild, untamed parts of themselves that follow the laws of instinct, not the laws of men. For Diana, the structures unholding civilization are often unjust, only benefit a few, and counter the ways of nature. While Diana is often called upon to bless the hunt, she warns of the dangers of exploiting or harming the natural world beyond the need for survival. Such actions often evoke Diana's retribution as an embodiment of consequences for harms caused by greed, lust, and misuse of power.

Possible themes: Chasing/hunting for something you want to have or achieve, connection with nature, justice, asexuality, grieving a pet, cutting ties, isolation, protecting the vulnerable, environmentalism.

Power: Advocacy and independence

Venus: Pink

The goddess of love, sex, and beauty, Venus is said to have emerged from the white foam generated when the titan Saturn threw the severed remains of his father Caelus into the sea. Venus' symbols include doves, roses and myrtles. Although Venus was married to Vulcan, the master blacksmith, she had multiple affairs, including with the god Mars. She is almost always accompanied by Cupid, the god of love or lust, who is often described as her son. Her Greek name, Aphrodite, gives us the word "aphrodisiac," while the word "venereal" is derived from Venus.

Venus is the goddess of desire, which can take many forms. The most obvious association with Venus is sexuality and lovemaking, and indeed she can help awakening such impulses within an otherwise slumbering or repressed libido. However, she also represents desire for union, bestowing upon her favorites a special magnetism that draws others to want to draw closer to them: lovers, leaders, performers, and sages alike. She is the impulse to create, to bring together two separate forces, and manifest something new, fueled by the passion of desire, whether for intimacy, knowledge, or ecstatic experience. Embracing one's desire can be unpredictable and carries great risks, which Venus can help navigate, although devotees should be forewarned that such drives can also turn quickly into obsession. However, the fruits of chasing one's desire can prove bountiful, as Venus is also associated with prosperity.

Possible themes: Desire, sexuality, sexualisation, romantic love, relationships, broken hearts, jealousy, obsession, beauty, prosperity.
Power: Magnetism (not coercive) and intimacy

Vulcan: Bronze

Venus' husband was Vulcan, the god of fire, a master blacksmith and craftsman to the gods. Vulcan made weapons and tools for the gods and select mortals — like Mercury's helmet and winged sandals, Achilles' armour, and Aeneas' shield. His symbols include the anvil, hammer, and tongs. Vulcan became the patron of craftsmen, and volcanic fires were often considered to be his workshops. Vulcan gives his name to "volcano," and, less excitingly, vulcanised rubber. He walks with a limp as a result of a badly broken leg in childhood; in some stories, this injury was inflicted by Jupiter when Vulcan tried to protect Juno from his rage.

While often underestimated by the other gods due to his disability and quiet demeanor, Vulcan is competent and steadfast. An unparalleled craftsman, Vulcan creates weapons and armor, but also furniture and other practical objects with exquisite artistry. He represents quiet competence and devotion to one's work. Therefore, Vulcan is often the patron of apprenticeship and mastery, the dogged perseverance required to mold raw materials into artifacts that are both functional and beautiful. This devotion also extends to Vulcan's loved ones. His loyalty and support is well-established, although he is often taken for granted by his family, especially his spouse, Venus. Vulcan represents the determination of humanity to shape the world and persistence in the face of adversity.

Possible themes: Devotion to mastery for one's craft or trade; molding reality; transfiguration; loyalty; improving the lives of others through hard work; living with a disability; insecurity about your appearance; being shunned or bullied; feeling/being used for your talents; body dysmorphia; the relation to your body and beauty ideals.

Power: Alchemy from one state to another and forging creativity

Mercury: Yellow

The messenger of the gods was Mercury. Mercury's symbols include the caduceus — a staff intertwined with two snakes — as well as his winged sandals and cap, and a tortoise. Mercury was the second youngest of the Olympian gods, older only than Bacchus, and was the son of Jupiter and the nymph Maia.

Mercury can travel quickly between divine and mortal worlds with his winged sandals. Thus, he represents communication,

both verbal and non-verbal, as well as travel and transportation. Mercury is often dispatched to send messages across long distances, including when two parties are in conflict. Mercury is also responsible for transporting souls to the underworld, and escorting them from one plane of existence to the other. He is the patron god of merchants and thieves alike, as he is often known as a playful and witty trickster. He can sometimes be heard by shepherds as they guide their flocks from place to place, imparting a compelling story, clever riddle, or a diverting tune for a flute. Mercury is often called upon by doctors, nurses, and other healers, especially in situations that others may deem a lost cause, as he can also accompany souls back to their bodies in exceptional cases.

Possible themes: Mediating, speaking up for yourself and others, changing your trajectory, learning how to speed up/slow down, learning about communication, travelling, healing, miraculous recovery.

Power: Adaptability and mediation

Pluto: Black

Pluto is the king of the underworld, and the brother of Jupiter and Neptune. He is the spouse of Proserpina, whom he kidnapped and held in the underworld as a maiden against her mother's wishes.

A serious and self-isolating god, Pluto presides over the land of the dead, both literally in the case of people who die, but also figuratively in terms of aspects of the unconscious we are not always ready to confront. When mortals die, he ushers them to the realm in the underworld in which they will next reside. This process is often determined by their previous deeds. Thus, Pluto holds the answers to the mysteries that haunts many mortals during life: knowledge of what happens to the soul after death. To ease his loneliness and find respite from his somber responsibilities, he abducted Proserpina, who became his wife and co-ruler in that domain. He offered her the pomegranate fruit, which she chose to eat, binding her to the Underworld and to his side for part of the year. When heroes in myth travel in the underworld while still alive, Pluto often gives them an important quest to complete, which becomes important to their journey. Pluto is also connected to the acquisition of material wealth, symbolized by the cornucopia, or horn of plenty.

Possible themes: Fear of death, ego death, dying, being/feeling overlooked, life transitions, endings, prosperity, wealth, career changes, isolation, loneliness, covetousness.

Power: Accepting finality and acquiring abundance

Proserpina: Purple

Proserpina is the queen of the underworld and the daughter of Ceres. She is the spouse of Pluto.

Once youthful and vibrant, Proserpina was the maiden goddess who was abducted by Pluto and brought to the underworld with the intention of making her his bride. After her abduction, Ceres fought to release her, grieving the loss of her daughter until all crops fell fallow. However, Proserpina chose to eat the forbidden pomegranate fruit offered by Pluto, representing her entrance into sexual maturity. For this reason, Proserpina can only return to the surface world part of the year. As she lives part-time in the underworld and part-time on earth, she is connected to the changing of the seasons and the abundance following the fallow periods, as symbolized by a sheaf of wheat, which she holds as a reminder that the bounty of the world will come once more even when hope seems lost. In addition to the captured maiden, she is also the self-possessed queen of the underworld in her more mature form. Holding her torch, Proserpina serves as a guide when lost souls are at a crossroads and unsure how to proceed.

Possible themes: Chosen family, relationship with parent, torn between two worlds, abuse, trauma, depression, grief, the unknown, sexuality, fertility, abundance, crossroads, life choices, navigating in the dark, descending and ascending.

Power: Processing grief and transitioning

Bacchus: Green

Finally, we come to Bacchus, the youngest of the Olympian gods. Bacchus is the god of wine, vines, fertility, and festivity. He is most often shown with grapes and vines, as well as big cats like panthers, leopards, and tigers. In ancient Rome, the people held Bacchanalia: raucous festivals celebrating the god, which often included theatrical performances, costuming, intoxication, and ecstatic states.

Bacchus represents the process of dancing on the edge of life, sacrificing oneself in death, and then becoming reborn in the next season of life. Such changes can be literal, as in notions of reincarnation, or returning from a near death experience. They can also be metaphorical, such as a part of oneself dying and/or transforming into something else. At the core of Bacchus' myth is transfiguration and resurrection: that the form may change but the sacred core essence of the soul remains intact, and may even be purified by the process. Unlike Pluto and Proserpina, Bacchus does not dwell in the underworld, nor does he simply transport others from the above to the below; he is the one transported, again and again. Thus, Bacchus represents celebration in the knowledge that rebirth is possible through ecstatic, wild presence and communion with others while one is alive. However, embracing this wildness has risks, as unchecked inebriation can lead to indiscriminate and even violent behavior.

Possible themes: Ecstatic experiences, spirituality, substance abuse, recovery, relying on liquid/artificially induced courage, doing things under the influence that you later regret, addictive personalities, social anxiety, indulgence, death and rebirth, near death experiences.

Power: Living in the present and letting go

Appendix C — Workshop:How to Play this Larp

Before this workshop

Print out 5 copies[1] of the guide to larping and cut them into individual paragraphs.

We suggest reading through the script in advance because the ending is a little complex.

If you have no experienced larpers or role-players in a group then you will need to do more active facilitation. Either use Guides as facilitators or change this workshop to a review of the section in this book "How to Play This Larp" with a discussion of each point.

Where you do have experienced players, try to split them up so that there is at least one in each smaller group.

Introduction

The purpose of this workshop is to facilitate a discussion about how to play larps in general and **this** larp in particular. Some of you may be experienced role-players or larpers, but you may also come from different cultures and traditions, so what we want to do here is to try to learn how to play together

* In a long-form larp with a lot of players there is space to learn how to play the game iteratively; you can step back and watch others for a while, try things out, and step away to think about how it worked afterwards. For a larp like Lumen, with a relatively small ensemble group of players, we can't rely on this.
* Do we have anyone here who has **never** role-played before?
*

Do we have anyone here who has **never** larped before?

Thank you, that is useful to know. Tomorrow you will take part in some workshops that will create your characters and some relationships between the characters in the game.

Exercise

We are going to split you into groups of seven and give you a set of hints and tips for playing larps; in your groups we'd like you to review and prioritise these; decide which you think are the most important to use and remember.

[If there are first-time larpers or non-roleplayers in a group, ask the other players in the group to help explain the terms to them during the exercise]

There are no right or wrong answers here. We are going to take 20 mins on this exercise and then we will come back together and have a discussion.

Embody Your Character

Once the larp begins, you embody your character (as much as you feel comfortable.) This means you try to behave as the person written on your character sheet: Move like them, talk like them, even breathe like them. Try to react to situations as your character would.

1 Groups of 7 players, so if there are 35 in total then you'll need 5 etc.

Understand The Character

Develop a deep understanding of your character's background, motivations, fears, and desires. Know their strengths and weaknesses. The more you know about your character, the easier it is to embody them authentically.

Physicality and Movement

Consider your character's physical attributes and how they move. Are they graceful, clumsy, or imposing? Pay attention to posture, gestures, and the way your character carries themselves. Small physical details can make a big difference in portraying your role convincingly.

Voice and Speech

Experiment with different tones, pitches, and speech patterns that align with your character. Consider their accent, if any, and the pace at which they speak. Practice using your character's voice to enhance the overall portrayal.

React to the Environment

Respond to the larp environment as your character would. Take note of your surroundings, react to events in the game world, and interact with props and other characters. This helps you stay in character and contributes to the overall narrative.

Stay In-Game

Strive to stay in character as much as possible. Avoid breaking character or discussing out-of-game matters during the larp, unless absolutely necessary. This helps maintain the immersive atmosphere for everyone involved. Use the off-game space if you need to take a break or to have an out of character conversation.

Adapt to Changes

Be flexible and adaptable. Characters, like real people, can (and should) evolve and change based on their experiences. Embrace unexpected developments and let your character grow organically throughout the larp.

Relax

Don't worry about performing for others – it isn't a play – just let yourself explore the story world through your character's eyes and with their whole body.

Interact with Others

Talk to other players 'in-character'. Ask questions, share stories, and make decisions as your character and based on what your character knows and feels. The interactions between characters shape the story, so feel free to engage with others.

Remember You have Alibi

The characters you create tomorrow might be very like you - we call this ***playing close to home*** - but they are not you. It is okay for the character to behave in a way that you would not behave in real life, to say something you would not say or to do something you would not do.

Live in the Moment

Pay attention to what's happening around you. The larp might have a specific theme or story, and unexpected things might occur. Stay in the moment, react naturally, and let the story unfold.

Focus on Role-Play

Don't worry too much about memorising the rules. The focus is on role-playing and storytelling. If you're unsure about something, ask the organisers or other players.

Respect Others' Boundaries

If you're unsure about an interaction, especially if it involves other players, check with the people involved and with organisers. Respect others' boundaries and communicate openly.

Communication is key

Calibrate and discuss boundaries with your fellow players and use safety tools provided by the organisers if needed. Consent and player well-being are fundamental to a positive larp experience.

Embrace Immersion

Dive deep into your character, think, feel, and react as they would in the given scenario. The goal is to blur the lines between player and character.

Player Agency Matters

In larps, your choices significantly impact the story. The narrative evolves based on collective decisions. Don't be afraid to take the initiative and contribute to the unfolding drama.

Let time pass, take a moment to be still

Larps may unfold over hours or even days. Be present in the moment, savouring the experience. Let the narrative breathe and enjoy the organic development of the story.

Artistic Expression

Larp is an art form. With that in mind you should expect elements of art and performance. You can contribute to this by exploring creative expressions to enhance the atmosphere. Engage with the narrative on an emotional and artistic level.

[Set a timer for 20 Mins]
[Move between the groups and listen / provide guidance if necessary]
Conversation (25 mins)
[Once the timer has run out, Go around the groups and ask for their top three selections]
Is there anything you would like to add to this list?
[If there are any inexperienced players as them if they have any specific questions]

Summary

Thank you for taking part in this session. If there is a single piece of advice we'd like to offer to more experienced role-players is that we recommend treating every larp as though it is your first larp, and learning how to play it – from scratch – alongside your co-players rather than relying on your previous experiences.

Remember, larps are about shared storytelling, emotional engagement, and collaborative creation. Embrace the freedom to shape the narrative and enjoy the journey into a world where the boundaries between reality and fiction blur.

Thank you.

Appendix D — Workshop: Metatechniques

Note: This workshop details a specific meta-technique one can use in order for players to call upon aspects of the deity in order to enrich their own play. The specific meta-technique is interchangeable with other similar techniques, and if you have a specific one in mind, you can easily insert it into this workshop. When doing so, feel free to use the parts that are still relevant to your run of the game.

Tasks to complete before the workshop

* Familiarize yourself with the script. Make sure that you understand why the possibility to use deity powers is part of this game.
*
* Have sashes for all the deities available in the room where you run the workshop.

What happens in this workshop

In this workshop, the players will learn the meta-technique that they can use when their character is drawing on aspects of the deity and using this power in-character. It is important to note The powers are here to help you as a player when you feel stuck. They are not intended for you to project your will on another player, but rather as a way to invite others to support the play you want. In addition, by invoking a power, you might also find within yourself skills and knowledge that you were not aware that you had.

So, while we are dealing with potentially very powerful deities, the game is not designed to be a space for any type of power play or playing out power fantasies. The aspects called upon are intended to be more subtle and possible to embody without the need for special effects or for other players to imagine impossible things happening.

What to do

1. Show the players how to signal that they are calling on aspects of the deity:
    a. Wrap the sash of the specific deity around your wrist/hand/arm.
    b. Put your hand up to your temple in an "I'm thinking/considering kind of way".
    c. Speak your invocation:
        i. For example: "I call on Minerva to grant ME the wisdom I need right now."
1. Explain to the players that they can either invoke a power to their own character, or direct it at another character. If they direct it at another character, instruct them to point at that character with 2 fingers, and then speak their invocation:
    a. For example: "I call on Apollo to grant YOU the foresight to navigate the challenge you are facing."
    b. The recipient/target of the invoked power decides what (if any) the effect will be. Maybe it works for a short while. Maybe it works for a long time. Maybe nothing at all happens. Maybe it does something completely different than intended. Play around with it, and support each other's play.
2. Make sure to make the point that in order to

make all of this playable, it is important that players signal as strongly as possible what they are about to do. The easiest way is by just saying out loud exactly what they are about to do.

3. Have the players form pairs. Tell them to grab some sashes and practice how to invoke the power of a deity in the way that was just modelled for them.
    a. Let them know that it is okay to check the Deity Cheat Sheet!

Let the players practice for whatever time is left of the workshop or until they feel that they have tried it enough.

Appendix E — Safety Workshop

Approximately 60 min.

Lumen favors an approach that considers feeling safe necessary for taking brave action in play. Inspired by discourses within the Nordic larp community and beyond, we believe that all play is inherently risky -- as is life -- but larp can create structures surrounding play that establish some risks as acceptable, while trying to mitigate more serious risks.

All players and organizers must read and follow *Lumen*'s Code of Conduct in the Player's Handbook before, during, and after the larp. This Code expressly forbids harassment of any kind and details actions that the safety team may take in case of incidents. Our intention is for the *Lumen* community to last beyond the larp event itself. Note that our anti-harassment policy also extends to spaces that we do not moderate, e.g., social media posts, private messages, and occurrences off-site. When safety reports are made, while we will try to adhere to confidentiality requests when possible, in some cases, the rest of the organizing team will need to be informed or, if the situation requires it, legal authorities. Consumption of alcohol or other psychoactive substances is not allowed in-game or off-game, including post-game socializing.

Consent and The Main Take-Away

The most important take-away from this workshop is:
"The only person who gets to decide what happens to your character is YOU."

At *Lumen,* we value active, enthusiastic consent, both on the part of the people engaged in the activity and on the part of witnesses. We also want to make clear what we consider enthusiastic consent for both public and private activities before, during, and after the larp.

Active direct verbal communication is always preferred in these situations. Consent may have been obtained prior to the convention, e.g. with established partners. However, do not assume consent. Err on the side of caution and respect. Please note that the Lumen Safety Team considers a person incapable of consenting while intoxicated or unconscious. Furthermore, the use of drugs and alcohol are prohibited at Lumen.

Safety Team and Room

* Introduce the safety team and show the different badges that safety team members wear.
* Explain how to act if you have a safety concern.

If the Code of Conduct violation involves an attendee breaking the law, please call 112 or the local police immediately or request that a friend or a Lumen organizer do so on your behalf. We plan to set aside a private Sanctuary Space with a walkie talkie to summon a Safety Team member during the hours of 7am to 1am.

If a violation of the Code of Conduct transpires, first seek out an individual with a Safety pin on their lanyard, who will have detailed instructions for how to proceed. If you are unable to locate or summon a Safety Team member or the violation occurs at other times, please contact another organizer. Finally, we will provide phone numbers for on-staff Safety members at the start event in case of emergency.

After the event: You may choose to wait until after the event to report a violation, in which case, please email safetylumen@gmail.com.

- Repeat where you can find the safety room, and what the room is intended for.

Safety techniques

As Lumen is an educational larp, we strongly recommend taking part in all in-game activities for maximum learning and community building potential. However, players may opt-out of specific activities if needed. Furthermore, players should calibrate with co-players before initiating physical touch, engaging in romantic play, integrating sensitive content, etc., so that co-players can choose whether or not to opt-in to such experiences.

An off-game space is available to all players. You are welcome to enter this space at any time to be alone, decompress, or request help from a safety team member. This space should not be used for animated off-game conversations. Please use bedrooms for that purpose or go for a walk together away from in-game activities. Sleeping is also off-game, and play will cease at 11 PM every night to give all participants time to rest.

Go through the safety techniques. Explain them, and make the players practice them.

* **Off-game:** This default safety phrase initiates a short off-game conversation about safety or calibration. Aim to practice this phrase especially before the larp, which can be used in a number of situations. You don't have to memorize any wording other than off-game, but here are some examples that may come up in play:
  - "Off-game: Cut."
  - "Off-game: Please play softer." or just "Off-game: Softer."
  - "Off-game: Be right back."
  - "Off-game: Can we calibrate in the other room?"
  - "Off-game: Pronouns are they/them."

* **Okay Check-In:** This mechanic is initiated by making an O with all fingers of one's hand as in American Sign Language to check if someone is okay. There are three nonverbal responses:

Okay symbol. Image by OpenClipart-Vectors from Pixabay.

- **Thumbs up:** This response means, "I'm okay! Keep going. Can also be used proactively to encourage current in-game interactions.
- **Flat hand, or so-so:** This means, "I'm not sure if I am okay."
- **Thumbs down:** This means, "I am not okay." Can also be used proactively to discourage current in-game interactions
- .
  - In the case of flat hand/so-so or thumbs down, the player who initiated the checking should ask the person off-game if they can pull them aside to ask how to help. The player can shake their head to decline.

- **Lookdown:** This mechanic has a hand over the eyes, indicating "don't interact with me in- or off-game." A player using the Lookdown can choose to stay physically present or leave. Other players should find reasons to remove the character temporarily from the narrative without consequence. Lookdown can also be used as a response to the Okay Check-in if no interaction is desired. You may not use Lookdown to watch scenes off-game that do not include your character.

Content / X-Card

At Lumen we are using the X-Card to moderate what content is brought into play. The X-Card simply means, “Please remove this content”. In tabletop, the X-Card may be represented by a card on the table with an X drawn on it. Players can point at the card and say, “X Card: spiders” or whatever content they want to be removed, no questions asked. The X-Card can be used before the game when planning, as well as after the game. In larp, placing one’s arms in an X and saying “X-card” or “X-arms” can be a clear visual alternative.

Based on input from the player group, we wish to highlight some themes that we prefer players not enact (or threaten to enact) in the game:

* Child abuse
* Bullying
* Sexual abuse
* Animal cruelty
* Domestic violence
* Present threat of suicide

If necessary, you may discuss this content in-game, e.g., if it happened to your character in the past, but please check for consent with your co-players first. The Assistant Guides and onsite mental health professional are also in the game to help process difficult topics in-game.

Further Calibration

Use whatever time is left for further calibration between the players.

* Supportive pair calibration
* Challenging pair calibration
* Group calibration

Appendix F — Lessons

Lesson 1: Transformative Leisure, Educational, Therapeutic

In this lesson, the participants will be asked to complete a design task even though they have not been taught the tools that they will practice in the later lessons yet. This might be experienced as quite difficult for the participants, especially for those who might be less experienced with design of role-playing games from before. It is therefore important to communicate that this exercise is about getting a first taste of what we are going to do throughout the lessons. **The goal is not to design a perfect scenario**, and if you feel that you are "failing" in some way, you are most likely learning a lot.

Arrange the participants into lesson groups of 4-5, with people who are not in their core group if possible.

1. (5 Min) Hi and welcome, what we are doing. Make sure to emphasize that the goal here is to get a taste, not to design the perfect game right away.
    a. Transformative goals:
        i. Identify the distinction between designing for transformation in leisure, education, and therapeutic settings.
        ii. Practice designing scenarios based on transformative goals.
4. (10 Min) [Spend some time explaining the three different types of transformative games, and what differentiates them. Then make sure that the participants understand that while ***Lumen*** itself is an edu-larp, their character in ***Lumen*** will be designing **transformative leisure** games, not educational or therapeutic ones].

    We use a classification of three different types of transformative game
    a. **Educational games** are framed as learning experiences with all participants expected to strive for specific objectives.
    b. **Therapeutic games** involve framing the game with therapeutic processing activities run by one or more mental health professionals with a client relationship to the players.
    c. **Transformative leisure games** are played in participants' their free time. While these games have specific goals, the players have various reasons for engaging, ranging from "entertainment" to social connection to self-actualization. Note that transformative leisure games can have educational elements or be experienced as therapeutic, but do not feature the additional framing required for both settings.

    Your character in ***Lumen*** will be designing **transformative leisure** games, not educational or therapeutic ones.

5. (25 Min) Brainstorm (lesson groups):
    a. Choose a transformative goal:
        i. Identify and name emotions while

in a state of heightened intensity resulting from a conflict in the workplace or at home.

ii. Facilitate for faster team-building by leveraging the skills of everyone in a project team in a business setting.

iii. Build critical thinking skills by assessing whether or not information is true in an educational setting.

iv. Encourage creative problem solving as a group by considering ways out of a difficult situation that a group of friends find themselves in.

b. Discuss a specific activity that could practice this goal.

When coming up with activities, it can be helpful to think about framing them as **verbs** that require active participation. For instance, "sitting" is a verb, but not something that requires active participation from the players. On the other hand "changing seats" involves sitting, but also requires players to move from seat to seat.

It is a good idea to not prime players too much with regards to activities, but sometimes they might ask for more input. As a facilitator you can give them some examples if needed. You can come up with your own suited for the group of participants, but here is a short list to get you started:

- Doing the dishes
- Drawing a figure
- Waving or shaking hands
- Stating opinions
- Sharing stories

c. Discuss a specific basic scenario that would make a good framing, including at least 3 characters.

6. (10 Min) Share briefly with the big group, listing **only** the goal, the activity, and 1-2 sentences on the brief scenario idea.
7. (15 Min) Debrief in lesson groups:
   a. Was it challenging to come up with a scenario?
   b. What was surprising or intriguing about this activity?
   c. How might intentionality such as this be helpful to you (or others) in your life path?
8. Recommend they process the experience verbally with a group of 4 for this exercise during the break if they feel ready.

Lesson 2: Ritual

In this lesson the participants will be asked to design and run a ritual. Rituals are recognized as central to cultural, religious, and spiritual practices, but many everyday interactions are also highly ritualized. For many it can be hard to recognize rituals as such when they are just a part of "how we do things around here." This workshop can be challenging for participants, as it requires some vulnerability. Be patient and make sure that the participants understand that they can opt out if they feel the need.

This workshop involves four facilitators, who will lightly embody Deities as they guide participants through the rituals. This embodiment is less role-play, and more drawing strength from the archetype of the Deities.

1. **(5 Min) Hi and welcome.**
   Facilitator Bacchus: Today, we will be enacting a rite of passage involving the past, present, and future. You will have the opportunity to first enact the ritual as planned, then to add minor creative innovations. Many of you will be enacting gods, possibly for the first time, whereas others will be the initiates undergoing the ritual.
   a. Transformative goals:
      i. Identifying the phases and components of ritual design.
      ii. Practicing rites of passage through embodied play.
2. **(5 Min) Theory explanation:**
   What is a ritual? Spend some time explaining this. For designers it is important to understand the 3 distinct phases of rituals, and the role rituals play as rites of passage.
   a. Ritual consists of three phases:
      i. **Preparation:** The pre-ritual stage of leaving daily life and preparing for the experience.
      ii. **Liminal:** The in-between state in which people adopt different roles and practices.

iii. **Return:** Returning to daily life bringing back insights from the ritual.

b. While we use ritual to describe many things in common speech, the academic definition of ritual focuses on significant social practices that build a greater sense of ***communitas***, i.e., communal cohesion (Turner 1995).

c. This ritual will present a rite of passage, in which we will usher initiates from one phase of life to another: past, present, and future.

3. **(5 Min) Ritual group formation:** Break into your core groups and decide who will be the person undergoing the rite of passage, i.e., the initiate.

   a. The initiates will go out of the room and get briefed by one of the ritual leaders that they will be invited into a room, asked to stand in the center of three circles consecutively. They will be asked a question, to which they always respond with their name. Then, they will be told a phrase, which they should repeat before going to the next circle. A drum beat will tell them when to walk and when to stop. At the end of the three circles, they will form a line near the 3rd circle.

   b. The remaining group members will decide who will play past, present, and future in the ritual. Each of these new groups are assigned a ritual leader to assist them, who will instruct them to move to a place in the room

      i. The past group is closest to the door, the present is in the center, and the future is furthest from the door in a straight line.

   c. Then, these players will decide which god they want to embody during the ritual. A staff member assigned to them will hand them their sashes.

      i. **Past:** Ceres takes a ***beige (off-white)*** sash; Neptune takes a ***dark blue*** sash

      ii. **Present:** Venus takes a ***Pink*** sash; Bacchus takes a ***green*** sash

      iii. **Future:** Apollo takes an ***orange*** sash; Minerva takes a ***grey sash***

   d. These group members will be instructed on how to stand and what phrase to tell the person undergoing the rite of passage.

4. **(15 Min) First time performing the ritual:** Facilitators also enact (but not in the circle) Bacchus, Diana, Venus, and Apollo and guide the ritual, prompting the participant with the question. Group members are called forward to the center of the circle. They should be wearing the following colored sash: Bacchus (gold), Diana (silver), Mercury (yellow), Diana (dark brown)

   a. **Bacchus station:** Bacchus leads the ritual as a whole, giving instructions to the group.

   b. **Ceres station:** Starting place at left. Facilitator Ceres stands outside of the circle. The circle is composed of the participants as Cereses and/or Neptunes (with arms stretched toward the earth).

      i. Facilitator Ceres calls forth the initiate from outside the door and points to the center of the circle for them to stand. Once they are in the circle and the drum has stopped, she says, “Who were you?” The initiate should answer with their name, e.g., “Riley.”

      ii. The Cereses and/or Neptunes then say the following phrase, inserting the person’s name: “I was Riley, the embodiment of innocent curiosity.”

      iii. Initiate repeats the phrase.

   c. **Venus station:** Facilitator Venus guides the next stage of the process. Venuses and/or Bacchuses hold their arms out around the initiate extended at chest height.

      i. Facilitator Venus calls forth the initiate and points to the center of the circle for them to stand. Once they are in the circle and the drum has stopped, she says, “Who are you?” The initiate should answer with their name, e.g., “Riley.”

      ii. Then Venuses and/or Bacchuses then say the following phrase, inserting the person’s name: “I am Riley, the embodiment of intentional growth.”

      iii. Initiate repeats the phrase.

   d. **Apollo station:** Facilitator Apollo guides the next stage of the process. Apollos and/or Minervas stand as pillars of strength and raise their arms to the sky.

i. Facilitator Apollo calls forth the initiate and points to the center of the circle for them to stand. Once they are in the circle and the drum has stopped, she says, “Who will you be?” The initiate should answer with their name, e.g., “Riley.”
ii. The Apollos and/or Minervas then say the following phrase, inserting the person’s name: “I will be Riley, the embodiment of mature insight”
iii. Initiate repeats the phrase.
iv. Facilitator Apollo gestures for the initiate to stand on at the end of the line outside of the circle.

5. **(10 Min) Innovation brainstorm:** After all initiates have completed the ritual, Bacchus will explain that these components are the starting points. They will now do the ritual again and each new group (initiates, past, present, and future) will decide on one way they will innovate the ritual. Bacchus will introduce the **technologies of ritual:**
   a. Based on work by Caro Murphy (2023), each person should have a part to play in the ritual in a participatory fashion, even if they are not currently placed at the center of the action. Examples include:
      i. **Music/rhythm:** Playing/listening
      ii. **Physicalization:** Embodied practice
      iii. **Improvisation:** Enabling presence in the moment
      iv. **Performance:** Theatrical elements and scene
   b. Inspired by this material, each group should **choose one (1) action** they will perform that will innovate the existing ritual. This action should not disrupt the movement into the circles, break the circles in any way, or change the wording of the ritual.
      i. Facilitator Bacchus will assist the initiates in choosing this action, Facilitator Ceres the past, Facilitator Diana the present, and Facilitator Apollo the future.
      ii. Only offer examples if the participants are stuck: humming, clapping, dancing, wiggling.
6. **(10 Min) Second time performing the ritual:** The group will now enact the entire ritual again, including each group’s innovation.
7. **(10 Min) Debrief:** At the end of the ritual, Facilitators Bacchus, Ceres, Diana, and Apollo will ask their group the following questions:
   a. How did it feel in your body to experience the ritual?
   b. What differences did you notice in the first ritual experience compared to the second?
8. **(1 min) Facilitator Bacchus announces as the final statement to the group:**
   a. The closing of the ritual has not yet been defined. How might you innovate closing the ritual?
      1. (10 Min) Embodied debriefing (large group, big circle): Diana or Bacchus leads the exercise.
   a. In silence, please move toward the center of the room to indicate feeling a particular emotion, if you feel comfortable doing so.
   b. Indicate where you feel it in your body, if you feel comfortable doing so. Look into each other’s eyes silently and nod, then return to the circle.
   c. Diana or Bacchus reads emotions one at a time: Joy, sadness, fear, curiosity, anger, confusion, love, some other emotion.
   d. Instruct the group to start low and end high with their voices to end the exercise.
   e. Recommend they process the experience verbally with a smaller group during the break if they feel ready.

Lesson 3: Identity

(10 Min) Hi and welcome, what we are doing. This workshop deals with the Intrapersonal dimension of conflict -- in other words, when aspects of our inner world are in conflict.

1. **Content advisory:** This is not about inner abuse, but rather conflict within parts of ourselves. It may bring up strong emotions. You can interpret the roles as you see fit, and use the X-card as needed . Explain yes-and, demo.
   a. Transformative goals:
      i. Identify aspects of the unconscious

within the psyche and dynamics between them.

ii. Embody and externalize inner psychological struggles through play.

2. **(5 Min) Description of roles**
   a. **The Inner Committee (less conscious aspects of identity):** 4 characters, one optional
      i. **Inner Child:** Will express dreams and desires based on a younger stage of the Ego's life. May be eager, mischievous, or timid (choose 1).
      ii. **Inner Parent:** Will give advice on what's best for the Ego from their perspective. May be overprotective, lenient, or strict (choose 1).
      iii. **Inner Critic:** Will express the Ego's fears about their own capabilities and discourage them from taking big risks. May be worried, critical, or pessimistic (choose 1).
      iv. **Memories of the Past (optional):** This part will briefly describe memories relevant to the discussion at hand that all characters recall at the same time (no more than 3 times).
      v. **The Ego (conscious identity):** 1 character
         1. **The Ego (the Guide):** Is trying to make a major life decision that affects their identity moving forward. Will pose questions to the group about what to do or make declarations of what it plans to do, to which the Committee reacts. (The Ego starts and stops the scene).

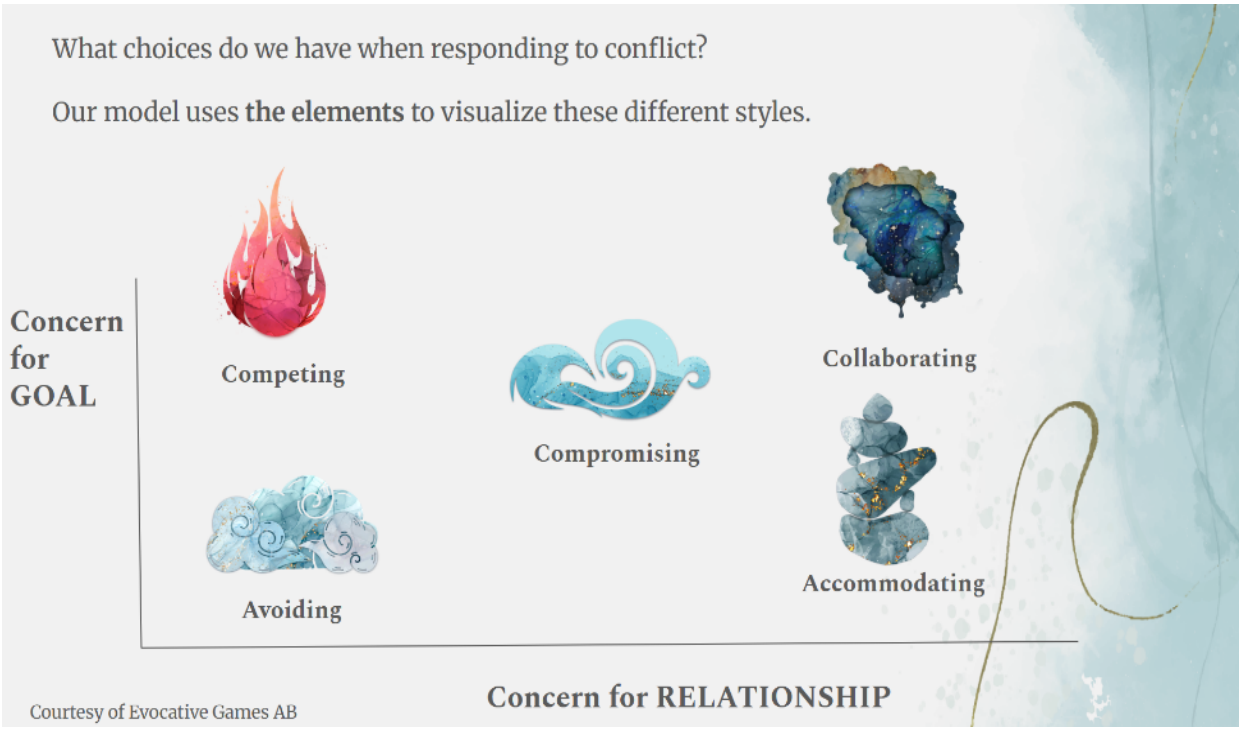
         vi. Assign a name to the Ego and use it while role-playing each scene: In this case, we will use Pearl.

3. **Metatechniques (5 min):** Introduce monologue and Hot Seat, demo monologue.
4. **(5 min) Assigning of roles and life decision (5 min):**
   a. **Choose one (1) life decision:**
      i. Whether or not to ask one's partner of two years to get married
      ii. What programme to choose at the university: the practical choice or the more inspiring choice
      iii. Whether or not to move to a new city for a big career change opportunity
5. **(5 Min) Reverse Hotseat:** The Ego goes first, describing the life decision. Then, the Ego will ask each member of the committee to briefly describe their thoughts on the decision.
6. **(15 Min) Play:** The Ego will take a break from the conversation while the three committee members discuss. The Guide can call for a monologue if a committee member has been quiet. The Ego ends the scene and announces the decision.
7. **(15 Min) Debrief:**
   a. What feelings emerged during this scenario?
   b. Did you relate to any of the characters of interactions in this scene? Why or why not?
   c. What insights did this scenario reveal to you in terms of psychology, if any?

Lesson 4: Conflict

1. (5 min) Hi and welcome. This workshop deals with the interpersonal dynamics related to conflict. We are learning about and experiencing different conflict styles, trigger warning: this is not about abuse, but less harmful conflicts, may bring up strong emotions, interpret the roles as you see fit, X-card. Explain yes-and.
   a. This scenario has been inspired by design work developed by ACC Conflict Transformation Academy and the ROCKET Erasmus+ project.
   b. Transformative goals:
      i. Identify and embody different conflict styles.
      ii. Reflect upon one's own behavioral tendencies in conflict situations.
      iii. Consider how different conflict styles might be valuable.
2. (5 min) Give a short explanation of conflict styles:
3.

   Refer to next page **Figure 1:** The conflict styles along two axes: concern for goal and concern for relationship. Image from Evocative Games AB and Erasmus+ ROCKET (CC BY-NC).



a. Competing

High concern for goal. Low concern for relationship. Competing occurs when someone values achieving their goal above all other concerns, or "winning," accepting that the other person in the conflict might "lose."

b. Avoiding

Low concern for goal. Low concern for relationship. Avoiding occurs when someone deflects attention away from a conflict or withdraws from the situation completely, for example "ghosting." In this metaphor, air becomes less visible, holding stormy feelings inside rather than expressing them.

c. Compromising

Medium concern for goal. Medium concern for relationship. Compromising occurs when someone tries to give each person in the conflict part of what they want, but no one achieves their goal completely, for example "splitting the difference." In this metaphor, water makes way for others but also fills the gaps left behind.

d. Accommodating

Low concern for goal. High concern for relationship. Accommodating occurs when a person sets their own goals aside in order to maintain their relationship with the other person, for example "sacrificing" oneself for others. In this metaphor, earth is the grounding that provides support for others.

e. Collaborating

High concern for goal. High concern for relationship. Collaborating occurs when a person works to problem solve in a conflict, brainstorming solutions that help everyone achieve their goals, for example "win-win." In this metaphor, space provides an blank canvas to imagine possibilities and create new solutions.

It is also important that you emphasize that the participants should try to keep the scene going rather than resolving to explore the dynamics, even if their character wants the situation to be resolved quickly.

4. (1-2 min) In the challenging-pair group. The Guide assigned to the group will have chosen one of the following situations. Every stakeholder has a goal: a vested interest in one of the outcomes for their own benefit:
   a. **Family meeting:** Trying to decide which child will get their own bedroom in their new home. All stakeholders are children in the family and want their own room. The mediators are the parents.
   b. **Workplace meeting at a school:** Trying to decide which new elective to offer students. Each stakeholder wants to teach their own subject: psychology, economics, or sculpture. The mediators are the administrators of the school.
   c. **Friend group meeting:** Where to travel on a joint vacation. All stakeholders have different options (choose 1): a hike across Peru, a museum tour in Europe, or a temple retreat in India. The mediators are planning logistics, but have no strong preference.

5. (5 Min) Assigning of roles
   a. **Robin, The Collaborator (Mediator A):** Is patient and wants to find the best solution for everyone involved, even if it takes time.
   b. **Raven, The Avoider (Mediator B) (Optional):** Is less patient and is uncomfortable with conflict, wants to solve the problem quickly and change the subject.
   c. **Justice, The Compromiser (Stakeholder A):** Is concerned about fairness and everyone getting some of their needs met.
   d. **Storm, The Competer (Stakeholder B):** Is concerned about their needs getting met.
   e. **Echo, The Accommodator (Stakeholder C):** Is concerned about others getting their needs met above their own.
   f. Specify pronouns on your badge

6. (10 min) Hotseat: Each stakeholder should start by describing what solution they most want, why, and how they feel about the conflict. Each mediator should describe their view of the dynamic and what they would like to see happen.

7. (15 min) Play (2 scenes, do not resolve the conflict in first scene)
   a. Play the scene once as the character's default conflict style. Decide to meet again to discuss further.
   b. Then, fast forward a day, and play the follow up scene, trying a different conflict style.

8. (10 min) Small group debrief: In groups of 4, the players will be asked each questions in turn by the facilitator overseeing the group:
   a. What emotions did this process evoke in you, if any? What insight can you gather from these reactions?
   b. Did you find this situation relatable to your own experience? Why or why not?
   c. In what situations might practicing a different conflict style be beneficial in your life, if at all?

9. (5 min) Large group debrief
   a. What thoughts do you have about conflict after playing this scenario?

Lesson 5: Inclusion

1. **(5 min) Hi and welcome,** what we are doing. This workshop deals with the Positional aspects of living in a society -- aspects of our social identities and backgrounds.

   Important content warning:
   a. In this lesson, we are going to explore exclusion through play. The goal here is **NOT** to reinforce feelings of exclusion but to show how common exclusion can be even for well-intended folks, and then practice more effective forms of inclusion.
   b. This is **NOT** about abuse, but less harmful conflicts may still bring up strong emotions. Participants can interpret the roles as they see fit, but make sure to emphasize that they can use the X-card.
   c. Keep in mind that even experiencing unintentional exclusion can be activating. Take care of one another. Remember the

Okay Check-In, Softer, and opting-out as possibilities.

d. In this scenario, you will be co-creating fictional elements. Remember to use the "Yes-and" technique -- accepting people's improvisation and adding to it with your own creativity -- whenever possible..
e. This scenario has been inspired by design work developed by ACC in the *Microaggressions* scenario (Bowman, Hatcher, and Kim 2018) the Conflict Transformation Academy, and the ROCKET Erasmus+ project.
f. Transformative goals:
    i. Practicing effective and empathic ways to help foster inclusion in group settings.
    ii. Developing awareness around the pressures of conformity and in-group vs. out-group dynamics.

2. (5 min) Explanation of conformity and in-group and out-group. Explain that each scenario will be played in 2 short scenes, followed by debriefing when possible:
    a. The initial situation causing feelings of exclusion and a less effective and empathetic way to handle the situation;
    b. A more effective and empathetic way to handle the situation.

3. **(5 min) Choose a situation.** Note that in none of these situations do the people in the scenario intend harm or realize harm is caused.
    a. Different needs: One person needs quiet (Character A), while three others need social time (Character B, C, D). -- Clista
    b. Different belief systems: One person privately holds a different belief than three others (Character A). The three others are making dismissive comments about this belief (Character B, C, D). **X-Card:** Religion -- David
    c. Different language: One person (Character A) has trouble understanding when three others use certain specialized terminology or speak in another language. (Character B, C, D). -- Sarah
    d. Different perspectives (optional): One person has a different view on how to proceed in a situation (Character A) than the other three people in a group (Character B, C, D).

4. **(5 min) Choose groups, assign roles and character relations:**
    a. Assign: Character A, everyone else is B, C, D
    b. Choose one: Siblings, roommates, close friends, classmates, co-workers
    c. Choose a setting: home, school, work, out on the town
    d. Choose a situation: socializing, working on a project, discussing world history

5. **(5 min) Reversed hot seat:** Ask each character why this topic matters to them.

6. **(5 min) Play the first scene.** Character A will confront the group at some point in the scene. The Guide will cut the scene at the height of the tension. If done early, the Guide can ask each person how the scene made them feel (structured debrief).
    a. What emotions did your character feel in this scene?

7. **(5 min) Play the second scene.** The Guide will cut the scene when it feels resolved. If done early, describe how the scene made each person feel (structured debrief).
    a. What emotions did your character feel in this scene?

8. **(10 min) Small group debriefs:** Each group will be asked each question in turn by the Guide overseeing the group:
    a. Did you find this situation relatable to your own experience? Why or why not?
    b. What thoughts do you have about inclusion after playing this scenario?

9. **(5 min) Big group takeaway:** Ask each member to share a one word takeaway popcorn style (i.e., in no particular order).

Lesson 6: Ideological: Culture

1. (5 min) Hi and welcome, what we are doing.
    a. This scenario has been inspired by the culture workshop by Nielsen and Strand (2019) and *This Miracle* by Stark and Fortugno (2015).
    b. Transformative goals:
        i. Practice responsible co-design of cultures in games.
        ii. Explore the function of ritual in culture through play.
        iii.
2. (5 min) Explanation of culture design
    a. Cultures are the shared ideas, customs, and social behaviour of a particular people or society. When working with culture we can intentionally design or influence:
        i. **Everyday scenes,** which emphasize normative behavior within the culture; and
        ii. **Taboos**, meaning behaviors that are considered inappropriate or prohibited in the culture; and
        iii. **Rites**, including rituals members of the culture would know and understand. The role of the ritual is to create a shared experience embodying the concept values of the culture.
        iv. Example of cultural rituals:
            - "Celebrating a graduation of your cousin" is based on a valued behavior
            - "Having an intervention for your alcoholic friend" is based on a taboo.
    b. Today we are focusing on co-designing and enacting culturally informed rituals. Make sure you play the setting seriously and respectfully. This exercise is not about satire or critique. Avoid reproducing cultural stereotypes, and try to avoid leaning on known cultural rituals or symbols from the real world. If any element in your ritual makes you wonder whether you are on the right side of the line, you are probably better off choosing to not include it.
    c.
3. (5 min) Divide the participants into their core groups. They need to choose **<u>one</u>** of these settings:
    a. A religious ritual in a culture that worships an aspect of nature.
        i. Choose one or suggest an alternative: the moon, birds, water, rocks, trees, cats
    b. A cultural event in a society that celebrates embodied expression.
        i. Choose one or suggest an alternative: music, dance, singing, acting
        ii.
4. (10 min) In the group, plan a ritual. The focus should not be on the content of the ritual but the role of the ritual in the culture i.e. why the ritual is being performed. Once again it is important to try to avoid leaning on known cultural rituals or symbols in our world and focus on the basics. Answer **<u>all of these</u>** questions:
    a. Why is the ritual important in the culture?
        i. Choose one or suggest an alternative: a consequence will happen if the ritual does not happen, it brings the group closer together, it reinforces faith
    b. What is the purpose or theme of the ritual?
        i. Choose one or suggest an alternative: fertility, spiritual devotion, emotional catharsis
    c. Choose who will be the ritual leader and define what they will do.
        i. Choose one or suggest an alternative: lead the group in prayer, perform for the group, guide others to express themselves in specific ways
    d. What will the participants of the ritual do?
        i. Choose one or suggest an alternative: repeat phrases prompted by the leader, drum, sing, dance, move in a circle, use items of power or cultural significance, eye gazing
    e. How will the ritual start and end?
        i. Choose one or suggest an

alternative: Walking from one space to another, closing eyes until directed by the guide to open them, standing up versus sitting down, intoning a specific phrase together

ii.

5. (10 min) Play out the ritual.
   a. The ritual leader will guide the participants through the ritual as discussed, beginning and ending as planned. Avoid adding any content not discussed.

6. (10 min) **Small group debriefs:** Each group will be asked each question in turn by the Guide overseeing the group:
   a. What emotions did this process evoke in you, if any? What insight can you gather from these reactions?
   b. Did you find this situation relatable to your own experience? Why or why not?
   c. What thoughts do you have about the relationship between cultures and rituals after playing this lesson?

Appendix G — Workshop: Character Creation

Tasks to complete before the workshop

1. Read through this script a few times. It is quite complicated in places. Keep to time. If you slip by a few minutes early on, it will be super late by the time you finish.
2. Go through the card decks and remove the black cards as these are antagonistic archetypes that are not useful for ***Lumen*** (although they may be relevant for other transformative games / exercises)
3. Sort the archetype cards by colour group and put them out around the workshop space.
4. There should be a list of lines and veils available. These are themes and topics that participants in the larp either do not wish to play on at all (lines) or that they are okay with being referenced but do not wish to play on (veils). This will have been drawn together from a pre-larp questionnaire of players and guides and updated during the introductory workshops. If this list does not exist, it needs to be compiled prior to the character creation workshop so that players don't inadvertently design a character with a theme in their background that will trigger another participant.
5. Put the lines and veils up somewhere they can be seen by all players.
6. If you have an audible sign for calling participants back to the workshop, now is the time to soundcheck it/make sure they work. For Lumen we had the bells of a Church work that we could ring! If they do not then you will need to change the way of signalling the end of the journeys (see below)
7. If your location has an outside space, check whether the weather is good enough for people to go out.
8. Shuffle the Fates Cards
9. If you are using the app, check that the app works.
10. Set up and test AV if you are using a powerpoint deck or print questions if you are not.
11. Ensure that you have a method of timing the exercises so that you can keep this workshop running to time..

Welcome [Read this to the players]

Welcome to the character creation workshop. In this session we will be creating the characters that you will play during the larp.

In a larp the character is the means by which ***we*** enter the fiction. They allow us to interact with other players and to co-create a story. They also provide sufficient distance so that we are aware that the character is not us. This distance – or alibi – frees us from the constraints of our own body, personality, and behaviours. Alibi is one of the pillars that allows the magic to happen.

What we are going to do in this session is to create your characters, their backstories, and some of the relationships between them. We do this in a spirit of playful co-operation, but also with generosity and an invitation to challenge one another - gently - into creating characters who have an aura of reality about them.

Before you came here we asked you to do some preparatory work, by looking at some archetypes and considering the sort of transformational journey you wanted to explore. Your reasons for selecting this journey are your

own. It could be that the area you have chosen resonates with you because it is close to your own lived experience – we call this playing close to home – it could be that you would like to challenge yourself, or to play a story that perhaps belongs to someone else, someone you know or care about. This empathic journey is also valid.

This is how this session will work: First we are going to look at the character archetypes, and you are going to each choose one or two of them as the basis for your character. Then we will work through a series of simple questions designed to add layers to the archetype until you have a playable character.

[If you have completed the Lines & Veils Session] Please remember the Lines and Veils that we spoke about during the earlier workshop, they are available here (point to list) if you need to check. We ask that you avoid these themes.

[Read out the list from the lines & veils]

[If you have NOT completed the Lines & Veils Session] then please refer to Apendix E in this book and do it now.]

Then we will have an exercise where you will ask one another questions in a way that will help you to get to know who this character is, and for others to get to know them too.

We'll take a break, and then we'll go for a series of short walks during which you will create some secrets for your characters, and some shared stories between your character and a few of the others.

Finally we will perform a simple ritual where we will ask you to come up with a name for your character.

You can use the app to make notes about your characters or you can take notes as you go along

Archetype Selection

We have produced a set of archetypes for this larp - derived from Jung - that we will use as the foundation for character creation. We sent a list of these out to you before the larp for you to review. There are twelve archetype families, and each of these have a number of alternatives you can choose from. These are all written on cards which we have placed on tables around the room. We sent these out to you before the larp started so you could think about which of these you are interested in playing.

The illustration below shows the twelve archetype families. You might want to start by thinking about which of these families appeals to you as a player.

Figure 2: The archetype wheel. Image courtesy of Avalon larp studio.

We're going to take (5 mins) now to take a look at these again and for you to consider which archetype or archetypes you might like to play. You will be inhabiting this character for quite a long time, so we recommend that you select ones that you feel comfortable playing rather than anything that is going to exhaust you, but you also need to keep the challenge of transformation in mind as well. This choice is yours, but we encourage you to be brave.

Don't worry about other people's choices; if more than one person wants to play the same archetype we can talk about that and see whether it works. These archetypes have been re-written for Lumen and are designed to have a description of the archetype, the sort of play that they can bring to others and a redemptive question.

Throughout these workshops we'd like you to concentrate on what you want or need as players rather than on the needs of your characters, or other people in the room.

[Here we allow the participants to move and mingle and read the cards and to place their tokens on or near the archetypes they want to play. After 5 minutes the facilitator calls an end to the selection. The Facilitator also needs to assess the balance of archetypes and understand if there is a cluster in the group and/or if more than one player has their heart set on a particular archetype. There is no need to force a spread of archetypes]

With reference to your chosen transformational journey, we'd like you to select two archetypes: Pick the one that represents where you are now – what is my starting point as a person? – and the one that represents where you want to be.

If you are an experienced larper, consider the sort of character you usually play, and where your comfort zone is, and where your 'growing edge' could be. (What do you find intriguing but potentially challenging?)

[Depending on the number of players, split the room into small groups or form a circle.]

We are going to go around the room now / We are going to break into groups and talk about why we have chosen the archetypes - our starting point and end goal. Why are you drawn to playing these types of character? Supplementary questions are useful here, try to encourage players to ask them. It is okay if you don't know the answers. If that is the case, write down the question in the app or on paper and possibly come back to them later.

Solo Exercise

We now have a short questionnaire for you to complete. You can choose to write answers to these questions, to think about them, to draw something, or to approach these exercises in whatever way works best for you.

Firstly, a question for inside your own head. Why are you as a player here? Is there a way that you can work that into your character? Are they here for the same reason as you or for a different reason?

You can decide to put this into a character or to keep it outside of the experience. You will not be expected to share this with your co-players, but you are also welcome/invited to do so if you so choose.

Here are your background questions (Printed on sheet/on a slide)

* What does this character do for a living?
* What is the most boring thing about them?
* Where do they come from?
* Think of a time when your character was happy.
* When was that?
* What was the source of that happiness?

[Give the players 5 mins to work on this]
Based on this exercise, Do you want to change an archetype?

Finding stories through collaboration -10 mins

The wheel of archetypes shows a relationship between these archetypes families by splitting them into four quadrants. The focus of these are not exclusive but rather indicative: those which are about finding stories and legends, those that are about building an emotional connection with others, those that are about service to others or to a community, and those that are spiritual in nature.

You may find that parts of your character seem to be defined by the player group through these workshops. If you are comfortable with that, please lean into it, if not then exercise control over your own character.

There are twelve top level archetypes shown on the wheel. The cards then break them down into sub-archetypes. These add subtle differences to allow multiple characters to exist within the same archetypal sphere. For example, in the Creator Archetype there are also options like Poet, Builder, and Innovator.

So let's start by forming a relationship with a character who is close to you. If you are able to find someone who has a similar archetype choice to you. Make some groups of 2 or 3.

Talking exercise - 30 mins

Talk about your characters a little and discuss how they met, and how they might interact. We want you to create supportive relationships here. Your characters either have a shared history, a similar life path, or will have formed a friendship. We call this a harmonious partnership.

These partnerships are important because they will form the basis for the core groups for Act 1, so if there is someone you really want to play with, please pair up with them!

[After 30 mins are up] In each pair, please choose one of you to be 1 and the other 2. Make a note of this so you don't forget!

Hot Seat (in groups of 4 or 5)

Now we'd like you to form up with another pair who are close to you in terms of archetypes to form a group of four. This group is your Core Group. You will be doing a lot together in Act 1. Please make a note of who is in your Core Group. You are going to take turns to sit in the "hot seat." For about two minutes, other players will ask you questions about your character and you can decide on the answer. There are no right or wrong answers here. If you say something now that you decide doesn't work for your character you can change it. What we are doing now is the equivalent of trying on hats. You might find a hat you like, or you might decide that the hat doesn't suit you. There is no judgement here, only an opportunity for you to watch your character in the mirror.

Sample questions (you do not need to ask all of these)

* Where did your character grow up?
* What does your character care about?
* What is their greatest fear?
* What about their greatest passion?
* How do they feel about authority?
* What are they like when they're comfortable and happy?
* What are they like when they're pressured or threatened?
* Do they have family?

[Keep an eye on the clock and let groups know when it is time to change over so that everyone gets a turn]

[Have a BREAK here for 5-10 mins, encourage comfort breaks, hydration etc, keep it tight. As people return, make a note of the Core Groups and who is 1 and who is 2]

Walking Fates & Secrets

(Assuming the weather is appropriate, and that participants are able and willing to stand and walk) During this exercise if you wish to move around the space or the site you are welcome to do so. We'd like you to go on a series of journeys with some of your co-players. You can either do this by describing a location that you might have visited together or by walking around the site and exploring a little. Each 'journey' should be about ten minutes long.

During this journey we'd like you to talk about some shared history or connection between the two characters. Sometimes this will be a secret -- one character was directly or indirectly responsible for some hurt or trauma – sometimes the nature of the relationship will be more obvious; friends, relations etc. .

To help you with this we have some Fate cards that you can use for inspiration. We are going to give each of you a few cards at random. If you don't like the ones you've been given then

come back to us and we'll replace them.

Each of the cards suggests a type of relationship, and it has a few questions that you will need to answer with the other person in that relationship.

The purpose of this exercise is to create 'Fate Pairings.' (These are like bonds or strings in some Powered By The Apocalypse games)

Fates represent some emotional power that you have over another. Combined with the shared history or shared experience this binds the group of characters together. Your stories are intertwined, although this may not be immediately obvious at the start of the game.

Fates need to be playable and resolvable through conversation, action, or ritual during the larp. These will be most important during Act 3 when you will have an opportunity to resolve these relationships.

[Choose **one** of these] For example:

A Shadow of Betrayal

One character betrayed the other in the past; perhaps they caused direct harm or failed to protect them when needed? The betrayer may seek redemption, while the betrayed may seek closure or revenge (although for the purposes of this larp, that needs to be mitigated and transformed into forgiveness.)

This Fate could be resolved through a sincere apology, an act of atonement, or a ritual of forgiveness that both characters participate in.

The Unspoken Bond

The two characters once shared a profound connection that neither has openly acknowledged. This might be a deep friendship, unspoken love, or a shared trauma. The nature of this bond is powerful but has remained in the shadows.

This Fate can be resolved when their connection is finally acknowledged and explored, either through an honest conversation, an emotional release, or a ritual that brings their connection into the light.

A Mirror Darkly

The two characters see in each other a reflection of what they could have become, had circumstances been different. One may represent a path not taken, a life unlived, or a regretful choice. This reflection creates a tension between them, filled with what-ifs and missed opportunities.

This Fate can be resolved when the characters confront these mirrored regrets, either by embracing who they are now or by attempting to correct past mistakes through action or a symbolic ritual.

We will ring the bells / play a <sound effect> when the time is up for this exercise.

So this is your challenging partnership

Archetypes and Backstories

You should now have some sense of who these characters are, where they come from and their current trajectory. What we would like you to do now is to spend some time working on your backstory - who is this person really, what inspires them? What are they searching for. We are going to give you 10 minutes to think about this and maybe write or draw something. Then we'll come back together for some more talking.

If we have characters here who are opposite one another on the wheel that is super interesting, let's find out where people stand by moving into the four corners of the room. You can see which personality types are close to you, and which are different to you. These oppositions are about energy rather than conflict. By playing with or near those from the other side there will be a push and a pull and this helps stories to emerge. This isn't a larp about conflict and arguments – although these may emerge in play – so we don't want you to think of these characters as antagonists or enemies.

If available, please choose someone or a group from the opposite side, or from an adjoining segment and share a little of your characters' backstory with that player. (20 mins)

Now please return to your harmonious pairings and share these stories again. Ask one another questions and make suggestions about how to connect your characters or have shared

experiences in their backstories that will bring you closer together during the game.

Alone Time - Secrets of the Heart

The final journey is one you will take alone. During this journey we would like you to find somewhere to sit and think about your character's core secret, or desire, or trauma. If you are stuck, try to answer one of these questions:

* What does this character need that they are unable to admit to themselves or to others?
* What is the source of their pain?
* How can they free themselves?
* How do I move from my first archetype section towards the end goal? This final question is the most important, so if you are only going to answer one question, it should be this one!

This is something known only to you - the player - it is something that you may choose to reveal to your character during the game.

Naming Ritual

We will sit and do some meditative breathing (called 'box breathing') where we breathe in for a count of 5, hold for a count of 5, breathe out for a count of 5, hold for a count of five. We will repeat this 5 times.

Relax and let a letter come to you. Turn it around in your head. Is this the right letter for your character's name, or does it belong to someone else. When you have chosen a letter we will go around the room and speak your letter out loud.

When everyone has chosen, do you want to keep your letter, or change it?

People with the same letters please join together. You have a few minutes to choose a name that feels right for you. If you are in a group who have chosen the same letter, please discuss so that you don't have the same name.

[Talk the players through these Five Box Breaths.]

Next We go around the circle and everyone says, My name is <real name> I will be playing a character called <new name> the <archetype>

[Thank the participants for taking part in the workshop]

After the Workshop

1. Take the list of character names to someone who can print out and create the character badges.
2. Make a list of harmonious partnerships / core groups. 1/2
3. Make a list of Fate partners Appendix

Appendix H — Deity Embodiment Workshop

Introduction

The purpose of this ritual working is to teach the seekers the basics of embodiment and to give them some experience of being the vessel for a small aspect of a divinity. Its metafunction is to allow the players an opportunity to play on the idea of embodying something that is not human; teaching them a few of the techniques needed if they are called upon to embody a divinity later in the game. In this respect you can think of it as both a nano-game and a diegetic workshop disguised as a ritual.

Background

The players should get an opportunity to see the storyworld through the eyes and experiences of an embodied supernatural entity. The intention is that they experience some sense of wonder or joy

Learning: Seekers should understand how the embodiment ritual works and should have the opportunity to embody for a few minutes.

Transformative: Players should understand the emotional impact of role-playing if they do not already do so.

Guide Script

“Thank you all for being here. In this session we are going to learn about embodying. This is one of the more advanced magics we teach here at Hope, as it is the method that the guides use to allow the divinities to speak through us.

“We are going to start with something a little easier than summoning and embodying one of the Divinities. Instead, there are various ideas that we can embody, things like ‘Joy’ and ‘Wonder’ and that is where we are going to start.“

“These ideas, or spirits, exist outside of our world, so bringing them into our bodies allows them to experience all of the things we take for granted as though for the first time. A cleansing breath, a gentle touch, the kiss of the wind or of the sun, the taste of fresh water. All of these things will be new, and pure, and magical to the spirit, and so - by embodying them - we also get to experience these things anew with a sense of joy or wonderment!”

Safety

“When you are embodying an idea, if at any time it becomes too difficult for you, you can just clap your hands and it will be gone and you will be back to yourself. If at any time we feel that someone who is embodying is struggling we can also clap our hands and everything will return to normal. “

Prepare the Space

“First we must prepare the ritual space.
How would you like to do that?” (Take some suggestions from participants, give out actions),
Once the space is prepared, explain that this simple embodiment can only take place in this space. By leaving it at any time, a participant will return to normal.

Explain the process

"So what we are going to do is a very simple ritual. We will enter the space, breathe together, and then we shall take turns to embody the spirit of joy or the spirit of wonder. You may find that you can only do this for a few seconds, or that after a minute or two it is too hard and the spirit leaves you. Even if you only embody it for a second, that is still enough.

"When it is your turn, we will call the spirit and you will invite it in. When you open your eyes you will experience our world as the spirit, and it will see and experience it through your body. The rest of us will guide you through it, by offering experiences to you.

Showing the items

"There are a few simple objects, items, and foods here. (examples, some grapes, some water, some flowers, a balloon) so when you are guiding the embodied spirit you can offer these experiences to them)"

Ritual

Everyone forms a circle and closes their eyes. We breathe together for a few breaths.

What I would like you to do is for someone to start counting, by saying the number one. Someone else should say the number two, and we continue that way until we get up to seven. However if two people speak at the same time we'll try it again.

(Repeat this up to three times, unless they make it to seven without interrupting one another).

"There is no correct outcome here. It has helped me to understand how connected we all are, and which of you are already connected to one another."

"Who would like to go first? It doesn't matter if it doesn't work the first time around, there will be time for another go."

Ask the volunteer to move to the centre of the circle.

Get the Seekers to take a deep breath together and speak the name of the spirit they are trying to summon.

Let every seeker have a turn. If they are going on for too long, you can clap your hands to release them.

Expectations

What we are hoping for here is a gentle and almost whimsical nano-game where our players take a few minutes of gentle joy in just breathing and role-playing the embodied experience of seeing the magic in our world through another's eyes.

Debrief

After the rituals are complete, take a moment to thank the spirits and let them go and then ensure there is time for a round of Q&A to debrief the experience for the Seekers:

* How did you feel about the experience?
* What was the hardest part of it for you?
* How do you think it might be different to embody a deity?
* What lesson would you like to take away from this session?

Appendix 1 — Challenging Pairs Workshop

Note: This workshop takes place as part of the fiction, and you as facilitators are playing your guide characters giving the workshop to the characters, not the players.

Tasks to complete before the workshop

Familiarize yourself with the script.

What happens in this workshop

In this workshop, the characters will get to deepen the relationship with the character they are in a challenging pair with. It is not intended to resolve any conflicts or challenges, but rather for giving the characters the opportunity to explore the dynamics in deeper ways.

What to do

1. The workshop leader Guide will explain to the characters that the goal of the exercise is not necessarily to resolve conflicts or challenges, but rather to allow them the opportunity to explore these dynamics more deeply and fully feel the emotions associated with them. They will explain that the characters will have the opportunity to transform these challenges in the evening if they choose to take part in the Encountering Challenge ritual design activity together.

2. The workshop leader Guide instructs the characters to stand next to their challenging pair partner, and asks them to spend some time discussing their challenges with one another.

3. After about 15 minutes, the WS leader will combine 2 and 2 pairs, making new groups of 4 characters. Ideally these groups will be different in composition than the Gemstone groups, but this is not a requirement. Each group will then get a guide assigned to them.

4. The Guides will choose two Deities, similar to the night before: one that to them represents Harmony and one that represents Dissonance. The Guide will ask each pair to share their challenges with one another and ask:
    a. What wants to be expressed right now: the desire for Harmony or the clash of Dissonance?

5. The pairs will choose and the Guide will embody one or the other based on the need.

6. This time, the Guide will ask the pair probing questions aimed at either creating greater Harmony or allowing the Dissonance to express itself depending on the deity. This process should last no more than 15 minutes.

7. Then, the Guide will undergo the same process with the second pair for the next 15 minutes.

8. After this phase ends, the Guide will remove the sash and debrief with the characters in-game.

9. The characters should have some social time after this task. Appendix I — Scenario Design Task with Worksheet

Appendix J —Lumen Scenario Creation Worksheet

This worksheet provides guidelines and constraints for the scenario you are designing for another Seeker and that you will play out in your 4 person groups. Please stick to the format as much as possible so all Seekers develop the same basic repertoire for design.

You will co-design a scenario with **one (1) other Seeker** based on their transformative goal, then switch, for a total of **two (2) planned scenarios.** Please limit planning during this workshop to **45 minutes** and keep time. If assistance is needed, please contact your assigned Guide.

You will together establish one transformative goal, then choose options from the list, including scenario type, adapting the scenario to agreed-upon themes. The scenarios are fully transparent and negotiated ahead of time; no secrets or surprises. You can also negotiate in the middle of the scene using the *Pause* metatechnique (see below).

OVERVIEW

Time: 45 min total
- **Workshop:** 5-15 min
- **Ritual/Nano-game:** 10-25 min
- **Debrief:** 10-25 min

Break: 15 minutes after scenario

Note: Debrief should focus on the participants' personal journey in the scenario, not feedback to the scenario leader. Feedback can be provided after the retreat is over.

SCENARIO

GOAL Short phrase describing the transformative goal of Seeker:

THE STRUCTURE OF THE SCENARIO JOURNEY (agree upon one and calibrate):

Reminder: The facilitator should aim to take a minor role in the scene, making space for participants to engage as much as possible while nudging the scene along. If less than 4 in the group, remove one of the roles.

1. Rite of passage: Transitioning from one phase of life to another through a scenario. This new phase is usually accompanied by an external shift in social role, but not always. If you plan to design a ceremony, make sure to allow space for the participants to improvise, e.g., a scene discussing the process before and after.

- **Role 1:** Officiant of the scenario, should speak minimally (facilitator)
- **Role 2:** Person undergoing the change
- **Role 3:** Supportive person/deity engaging in scenario action based on previous phase of life
- **Role 4:** Supportive person/deity engaging in scenario action based on new phase of life

2. Conflict transformation: Enacting the main parties in a conflict, working toward mutual

understanding and brainstorming win-win paths forward.

- **Role 1:** Mediator holding space for the process, should speak the least (facilitator)
- **Role 2:** Person A in conflict (main affected)
- **Role 3:** Person B in conflict (main affected)
- **Role 4:** Person C in conflict (less affected, supportive or onlooker)

3. Advocacy: Standing up for oneself or others in a confrontation with inner and/or outer resistance. Making clear requests to get needs met.

- **Role 1:** Neutral onlooker**,** should speak the least (facilitator)
- **Role 2:** Person A in conflict (advocating for self or others)
- **Role 3:** Person B in conflict who has Interest X (resistant to change, motivated otherwise)
- **Role 4:** Person C in conflict who has Interest Y (sympathetic to the cause but motivated otherwise)

4. Navigating the unconscious: Embodying symbolic or allegorical representations of the situation to explore deeper dynamics. The roles are symbolic manifestations surrounding the goal.

- **Role 1:** The person's unconscious, briefly describes the visual/narrative aspects of the scene (facilitator)
- **Role 2:** A symbolic representation of the person as the protagonist in their own mind;
- **Role 3:** A symbolic representation of their resistance to change (will try to discourage)
- **Role 4:** A symbolic representation of their curiosity for the unknown (will try to encourage)

WORKSHOP

In a short paragraph, describe the scenario content and the transformative goal connected to it. (The facilitator will read aloud this at the beginning of the workshop.)

WORKSHOP EXERCISE (choose the one most appropriate for your scenario):

1. **Hot seat (focus on getting to know characters):** The facilitator will ask 1-3 relevant questions to each participant, which they will answer as their role. Participants may listen, but do not know this information as their role when the scenario starts.
2. **Ball of yarn (focus on creating relations):** Participants will pass around a ball of yarn to one another one at a time (literal or invisible). Each participant will offer a piece of fiction linking their role in the fiction with someone else's, e.g., a shared background, interest, or memory. The person receiving the yarn may accept or decline. If they decline, they should offer another piece of fiction until both agree. Then, they pass the yarn to the next person until each role has two relationships in the scenario.

JOURNEY

Countdown*:* The facilitator will count down from 10 to 1. Participants can choose to close their eyes if comfortable doing so. Optionally, the facilitator can include fictional details reminding players of the scenario situation to help them ease into the fiction at 7 and 3, e.g., "You haven't spoken since the conflict erupted, but today you will see each other" etc. At 1, the scenario starts with the participants in role.

Journey*:* The scenario should focus on 1-3 short scenes depending on what is needed based on the chosen structure. The facilitator frames the scene in time and place. Whenever possible, also give opportunities for physical action rather than just talking.

METATECHNIQUES

Monologue*:* The facilitator can ask for a monologue from a player, who will briefly reveal their characters' inner thoughts. Similar to the Hot Seat.

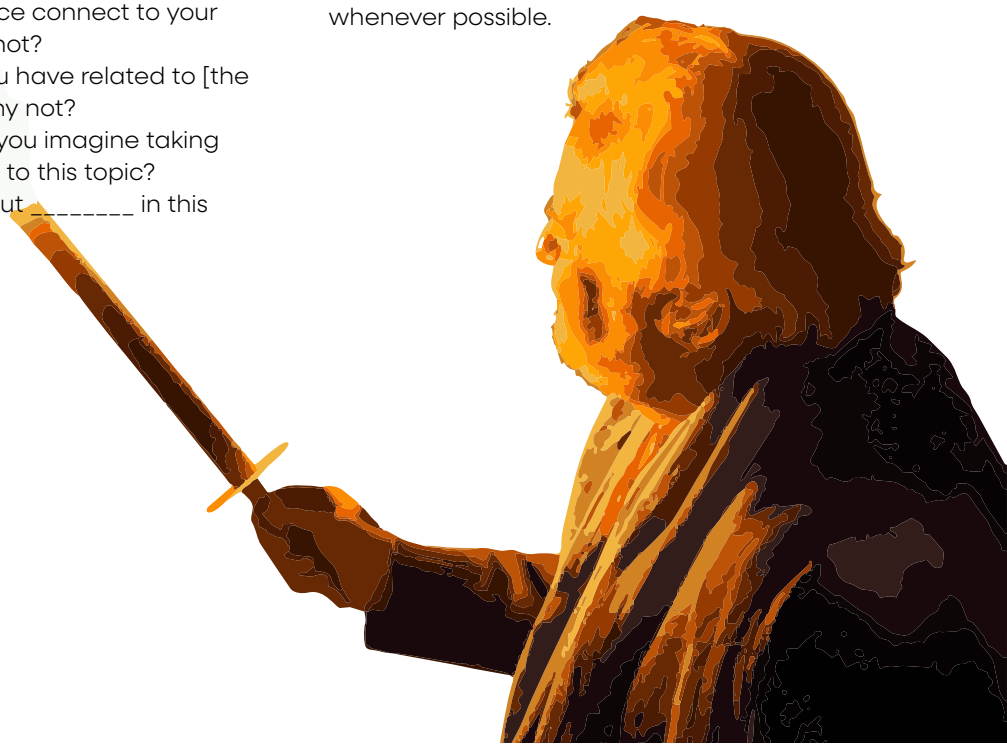
- **Bird-in-ear***:* The facilitator can approach a participant's ear and whisper their role's inner thoughts. The participants can hear but their roles cannot. The person can choose to use this information to inform their behavior or not.
- **Last line***:* The facilitator can call for the "last line" of the scene, indicating that role gets the last word and the scene will end afterwards.
- **Pause***:* Anyone can pause as needed to discuss matters outside of the scenario, including the need to opt-out.
- **Scene***:* The facilitator can also say "scene" to end the scene or entire sc

STRUCTURED DEBRIEF (choose 1-3 questions)

Each participant should have 1-3 minutes to answer each chosen question without interruption, so time and facilitate accordingly. No cross-talk/conversation unless all questions have been answered. Feedback on the scenario itself should not occur during the debrief, so moderate accordingly

1. What was emotionally impactful about this experience?
2. How does this experience connect to your life, if at all? If not, why not?
3. What takeaways do you have related to [the goal], if any? If none, why not?
4. What action steps can you imagine taking moving forward related to this topic?
5. What did you learn about _____ in this scenario?

Check-in buddy: Assign pairs who will check-in with each other after the scenarios are complete, ideally individuals they did not co-design with. You can also approach Assistant Guides for further processing. Use this option especially if participants need support during the next scenarios (if applicable). The facilitator should focus on conducting the scenario whenever possible.



Appendix K — Ritual: Encountering Challenge

Note: This ritual takes place as part of the fiction, and you as facilitators are playing your guide characters giving the workshop to the characters, not the players.

Tasks to complete before the ritual

* Familiarize yourself with the script.
* Make sure there are items that could be useful in a ritual available, such as for example sashes, drums, etc.

What happens in this ritual

In this ritual, the characters will brainstorm, create, and perform a ritual with the intent of creating opportunities for characters to transform their conflict in some way. This could for example take the form of catharsis, expressing suppressed emotions, confronting fears, defeating their internal resistance to change, etc.

What to do

1. Invite the characters to join the Encountering Challenge Ritual in their Challenging pairs. If one member of a pair does not want to join, a Guide can step in instead, or you can ask them to adapt the ritual accordingly.

2. One Guide is chosen to lead the ritual. This is tasked with providing the instructions, but should not take an active role in the ritual planning process. The goal of this exercise is to allow the characters an opportunity to make larger group experiences together based on emergent creativity.

3. Break the characters into groups of 6-8, keeping them in their challenging pairs.

4. Ask the group to brainstorm ways to encounter challenges through ritual.
    a. For example: Some members of the group could represent the challenge symbolically, and the characters experiencing the challenge will need to interact with this symbol in some way.
    b. Remember to remind them that the goal is to brainstorm and enact a ritual that will allow characters to transform their conflict in some way: experience a catharsis, express their emotions, confront their fears, defeat their resistance, etc.

5. When the groups are ready to perform their ritual, have them enact it in the center of the room while the other members form an outer circle around them.
    a. Ideally, the other characters should also take part in some way based on the direction of the ritual group, for example, chanting, drumming, clapping, or other forms of participation.
    b. The ritual group can also choose to enact the ritual somewhere privately. If so, we recommend having a place already in mind set aside for this purpose.

6. Each Guide should hold a short debrief for each group, allowing them to share about the experience and ground back into themselves.

Appendix L — Debrief Scripts: Mid-Game and End of Larp

Approximately 60 minutes each.
An introduction to structured debriefs

This script details the structured debrief designed for Lumen. Like all activities at ***Lumen***, the debrief is considered opt-out rather than opt-in, meaning the default is that players will participate and pass or opt-out completely only if needed.

Below you will find a description of how the debrief should work, then two workshop scripts: one for the mid-game debrief and one for the End of Game Debrief.

Structure of the debrief

You should debrief at the end of every day of the larp. The nightly debriefs in between acts are shorter, with only the first set of questions. The debrief after the rest of the larp includes the last set of questions as well and gives recommendations for integration practices.

The facilitator should ask players to sit in a circle of no more than 12 players, with the facilitator in the circle as well. If multiple facilitators are present, smaller groups are preferred with one facilitator assigned to each.

If you have many players and only one facilitator, ask them to form groups of 3-4, and for one person in each group to volunteer to be the small group leader. Ideally, all groups are in the same room and the facilitator has a microphone or can project so all people can hear. In that case, the facilitator can read out each question at a time. Small group leaders can raise their hand to indicate when their group is done. The facilitator then says they can continue to talk freely if they do so quietly and seriously. When all groups are done, the facilitator can read the next question. The facilitator should not move between groups and instead monitor the room as a whole, watching for raised hands.

In other cases, the facilitator may have to hand out instructions to the small group leaders, e.g., if they need to move to a different room.

All participants are asked to answer the debrief questions one at a time in order of their place in the circle. If a player passes, the facilitator should return to them at the end of the round in case they feel ready to share, but should not push them to share if not willing.

The facilitator explains to the players the following instructions. We do not recommend deviating from the script, as the components have been intentionally chosen. Practice is recommended when working with scripts, so that the explanations feel more natural.

Importantly, the goal of the debrief is for each player to be able to share their experience for roughly the same amount of time (no more than 5 minutes per round). The facilitator should keep time, but should moderate gently and sensitively. For example, if a participant is sharing an important story, the facilitator can wait until the story is over before moving to the next participant, even if time is technically up. If the participant is describing many details that do not seem necessary for the emotional core of the story, they can gently interrupt and remind the player that time is short and to focus on the emotional core.

This skill requires practicing a silent, patient demeanor and holding space for others to talk rather than one person (including the facilitator) dominating the conversation. Similarly, while the facilitator might be tempted to individually comment on the sharing of each participant, doing so may take time away from other players or, worse, inadvertently invalidate

the experience of the person who just shared. Avoid lecturing or commenting unless absolutely necessary, e.g., to connect the sharing to one of the transformative goals of the game. The facilitator should also avoid excessively sharing about their own experience and instead debrief with other staff members.

Debriefs should be serious in tone and focus on the participant's own experience rather than the experience of others. Therefore, participants should avoid crosstalk, meaning engaging with other participants directly in dialogue or commenting on their sharing. In practice, such comments will likely happen and do not need correction from the facilitator, for example if players were in the same scene and describing their respective experiences. However, we want to avoid such interactions becoming a dialogue that takes over the debrief, a long narrative about unessential details, or, worse, becoming accusatory. Since players may be quite emotional, one function of the debrief is to allow them to process any bleed they may be experiencing, e.g., frustrations with the actions of another character, and experience that player off-game as a supportive group member rather than adversary. In such situations, the facilitator should gently interrupt and remind players to avoid making assumptions or accusatory comments towards others, and rather focus on their own experience and feelings, i.e., "I"-statements rather than "You"-statements.

Facilitators should be able to determine between debriefing and telling a "war story": a long narrative, usually in a humorous tone, about a sequence of events that happened in the game. While such stories can be enjoyable, they often deflect from the seriousness of the debrief and thus often have minimal value in terms of helping players process challenging or complex content. The players can share such stories with others after the debrief if others consent to listening to them.

Finally, facilitators should be able to discern the difference between feedback and debriefing. Debriefing focuses on processing the game experience as a player. While game design elements can obviously affect these experiences, giving feedback about the design or implementation can, again, turn into a "You"-statement focused on giving organizers advice for improving the game. Such advice is valuable, but better saved for after the debrief is officially concluded, e.g., a phase after the debrief session itself, or in a feedback form after the larp. Otherwise, players may miss important opportunities to process their feelings, identify takeaways, or analyze their personal experience according to the learning objectives. If a player strays into feedback during the debrief, gently remind them to save feedback for later and focus on the play experience, but understand that some experiences may be inextricable from the design, e.g., the player's reaction to a certain ritual or mechanic within the game.

Debrief Script: Mid-Game

Facilitator instructions to participants

[Instructions to the facilitator will be in brackets like these]

[Read aloud] Welcome to the ***Lumen*** debrief! This space is here for you to process your personal experience from today or the larp as a whole. Each of you will have roughly 3-5 minutes to answer each question in turn, going around the circle. If you do not feel able to share you can pass, but please listen attentively to others. When sharing, please focus on your own experience, using "I" statements. Avoid commenting on what others have said or trying to engage in a dialogue with them; in other words, no crosstalk. When someone is speaking, please let them share without questioning the validity of their experience. Avoid making accusations about something that their character did in-game or assuming the intentions of others. Avoid debating about which interpretation of events is whether people's experience is "the correct one." Each character's story belongs to the player of the character. Honor their sharing as what is true for them in this moment.

"The debrief is intended to be serious and make space for you to share content that might otherwise be difficult to talk about. Therefore, please avoid "war stories," which are usually long, humorous narratives told after a game. If other players consent, you can share such stories with them after the game.

Finally, the debrief is not a space to give feedback about the game. You will have the

opportunity to give feedback [choose one or both: directly after the debrief / directly after the game ends / a week from now when we email you the feedback form].

1) De-roling

[Read aloud]. We will now have a brief de-roling exercise. By de-roling, we gently return to our daily identities. This script might feel awkward or stilted, but please use the words given. De-roling from character to player can be a complex process, and it starts with creating language that separates the two. We will go around the circle now.

"Hello. My name is [Player Name]. In this larp, I played [Character Name]. Right now I need [Name what I need, if you need anything (e.g., To talk / hug/ think / sleep, etc]."

2) Short talk about character/ player and bleed

[Read aloud] After play ends, some people find it helpful to talk about their characters, actions, feelings, and relationships in the third-person, for example, "When Ally came up to Jan and said..." rather than "When I came up to you and said..." This can help **othe**r players distinguish between the character that you played and you as a person, but it also can help **you** process and reflect on the actions taken by your characters. However, you do not have to worry about using third-person language during the debrief if you find it difficult right now.

Also, I would like to remind us about bleed. When emotions, opinions, physical states, relationship dynamics, and similar spill over from your character to you as a player, we call ***bleed***. Bleed is sometimes experienced as confusing and can even feel destabilizing sometimes. It is similar to the emotional drop that we can experience after leaving other great experiences for our "real lives," for example the drop after a fan convention, Burning Man event, or similar. Bleed is a complex phenomenon, and although it can be an unpleasant experience, being aware of it is a huge step towards learning how to process it.

Bleed is not only completely natural, but it is also very common when playing with emotionally charged themes for extended periods of time. Do not worry. You are not alone in experience it.

Also, some players do not experience bleed or strong emotions at all after a game experience. That is also totally normal and fine!

3) Debrief round questions

A. What was the most profound or intense moment for you?

B. Next, think of a ***golden moment*** -- a moment interesting, amazing, or extraordinary in some way. We can also call this ***larp magic.*** The moment could also be something challenging but meaningful for you.

[Be careful to not let this run off the rails. The important thing is to share short positive experiences to bring people into a mode of reflecting on their experience.]

Appendix M — Website Text

In this section we share the text and structure of the website used for Lumen. You are welcome to use these words for your own run of the game, but obviously you will need to update dates and names and details as appropriate

Lumen: The Journey to Hope

About Lumen

Lumen is a larp about a group of seeming strangers – the ***seekers*** – who attend a retreat at a mysterious location known only as ***Hope.*** There is magic to be found at Hope, for those who truly need it. Through unorthodox rituals and mystical practices the seekers confront their deepest struggles and guide others through processes of transformation. Secrets unravel, bonds form, and relationships are tested. Will they find healing—or something far more unexpected?

Embrace the journey of change, build a community, support others, and rediscover hope in this unique, immersive experience. Lumen is designed to teach elements of transformational analog role-playing game design through play itself.

Practical

Dates: [Insert your dates here]

Location: [Insert your location here]

Price: [Price], including lodging and food over the course of the larp.

Not included in the price of the larp is transport to and from the location. Participants will be able to purchase taxi rides at a discount at around 60-80 euros for both ways.

Note that the location is a former convent and is not a hotel. Towels, blankets, and bed linens are provided. Players will be expected to bring their own toiletries. (See below accessibility information for more details).

Timeline:

As *Lumen* is run within an Erasmus+ funding framework, the larp will involve a multi-step application process. See the Application Process section for more information.

[DATE] : Player's Handbook available, including safety mechanics and Code of Conduct.

[DATES]: Applications open for sign-up. Players will fill out an online form to apply.

[DATE]: First round of selections announced. List of potential attendees sent out for flagging.

[DATES]: Short Zoom conversations with potential participants (maximum 30 minutes).

[DATE]: Final participant list and waitlist sent to applicants.

[DATES]: Online activities related to the story world, design, and content. We aim to make some of these activities open to the public, not only participants.

[DATES]: *Lumen* takes place.

[DATES]: Optional online integration activities after the completion of the larp.

Who is organizing this larp?

Lumen has been designed and organized by the EDGE Consortium, an Erasmus+ Cooperation Partnership for curriculum development in transformative game design between Uppsala University, Avalon Larp Studio, Chaos League, Dragons' Nest, and Turku University of Applied Sciences. For more information, please visit https://erasmusedge.eu/

Experience

Overview

Lumen is a larp about a group of seeming strangers who attend a retreat at a remote and mysterious location known only as ***Hope.*** These ***seekers*** – all of whom are dealing with various forms of emotional, psychological, or physical distress – are searching for healing, transformation, or escape from their personal struggles. There is magic to be found at Hope, for those who truly need it. Through unorthodox rituals and mystical practices, the seekers confront their deepest struggles and guide others through processes of transformation.

What is this larp about?

Lumen is a larp about struggle and transformation. This psychological drama revolves around a group of individuals who attend a retreat at a remote and mysterious location known only as ***Hope.*** These ***seekers***, all of whom are dealing with various forms of emotional, psychological, or physical distress, are searching for healing, transformation, or escape from their personal struggles. Characters will draw power from the pantheon of Roman mythology and age-old archetypes as a means of discovering their own personal and collective power.

The ***Guides*** at Hope have their own struggles in their backgrounds and favour unorthodox methods for helping their guests. Over the course of the retreat, the Seekers are introduced to magical rituals that will question their perceptions, challenge them on many levels, and prepare them to face their journey and guide the others through it. As the story unfolds, secrets are revealed, and the Seekers begin to connect with each other in unexpected ways, with some forming close bonds and others clashing, but ultimately working together to change themselves and – perhaps – the world around them.

What is this larp not about?

This is not a larp about a cult. Nor is it about a dysfunctional hierarchy or manipulation by those in power. While dysfunction in relationships may be present, the goal is not to merely escalate such conflicts for high drama, but rather to play towards a resolution or work toward conflict transformation.

Learning objectives

Lumen is an educational role-playing game (edu-larp) geared toward players in helping professions who plan to use RPGs with specific populations. Funded by an Erasmus+' Higher Education grant, the goals of the game are connected to specific learning objectives that all participants should aim to experience. These learning objectives are:

1) Design, playtest, and give feedback on transformative role-playing games with specific growth-related goals.
2) Explore through play one's own specific growth-related goal(s) and assist other participants in exploring their own.
3) Apply theories and best practices of transformative analog role-playing game design within a larp experience.

The larp will include educational materials before, during, and after play to assist players in achieving these goals. The larp will also feature off- and in-game workshops and debriefs at specific periods that players are expected to attend for full participation. While

players can opt-out of any game activity for emergency reasons, in order to fulfill our financial commitment to Erasmus, please only sign up if you consent to participating in all activities.

Themes

The larp will explore themes of healing, identity, and the processes of personal redemption or reinvention. ***Lumen*** is designed not only to catalyse processes of personal and social change in players, but also to teach elements of transformational analog role-playing game design through play itself. You will be involved in creating rituals and guiding each other through them.

Characters will be co-designed in workshops. The larp is intended to work with aspects of the player's own lives, which is up to you to choose how to incorporate. To play this larp indicates a willingness to potentially transform oneself and a commitment to guiding others through their own process of change.

Content advisory

This larp will deal with some heavy themes, and plays on the idea that even in a controlled, serene environment, the process of healing can be tumultuous and unpredictable, especially when people are exploring their edges of growth. While not a therapeutic larp, the design emphasises psychological safety practices and is informed by mental health professional expertise.

Whilst it may contain some intense emotional scenes, this larp is primarily about hope in the face of adversity.

As the aim of the larp is to construct a redemptive narrative arc for one's **own** life, not just the character's, we recommend that you play a character as close to home as you feel comfortable exploring.

Storyworld

Lumen is set in the present day.

Is this larp for me?

Lumen is a larp that may contain a number of adult themes.

Whilst participants will always be in control of their own bodies and will have methods to calibrate and control their own play, they may be invited to participate in or witness scenes played out by others. Themes that may be present in backstories and in-game discussions include but are not limited to, mental health challenges, addiction, burnout, past history of oppression and/or marginalisation, relationship challenges, abuse, trauma, spirituality, religion, paganism, birth/rebirth, war, loss, grief and death. Some difficult themes may come out in play. Planned scenes based on these themes are possible to play, but will be carefully calibrated and should be played in black-box spaces only.

Lumen will be played in English. All genders, ethnicities, and sexualities are welcome to sign up for and play at this larp. There will be extensive mandatory workshopping and discussion within your small group of players on the above themes before the larp to ensure that activities are simulated safely and well calibrated. You always choose who to touch. You will always have control over who touches you. You can always leave any scene at any time. There will be a space outside the play area where you can take a break from the fiction as needed.

Not every larp is for every person. The best way to figure out if this larp is for you, is to consider whether you would be comfortable playing on the themes above. Are you able to play on serious themes without resorting to comedy? If the answer is "no" to either of these we'd urge you not to sign up.

Extensive workshopping and debriefing activities frame the play experience. Play takes place in three acts of 4-5 hours with debriefs and calibration workshops in between. Players are expected to participate in all off-game activities except in emergency situations.

What will I be doing during the larp?

The characters will spend their time at Hope learning about magic and figuring out how to use it in order to solve their problems or the problems of the world. There will be a number of set sessions facilitated by NPC characters - the Guides - that will involve exercises, discussions,

rituals, and learning “magical” techniques. Characters may meet or speak with the divinities that provide the magic and be challenged or guided by them. There will also be plenty of time to interact with the other Seekers, to learn one another’s stories and to explore the past of other characters - using the magic of Hope - in order to better understand one another. Characters will undergo rituals that relate directly or indirectly to their established transformative goals. Then, characters will design short rituals using principles of transformative game design to guide others through a process of change. There will probably be some exercise too for those that want it. It will be a slow larp in as much as it is about the journey of transformation, and the – sometimes painful –process of healing. There will be no external threats, monsters, or puzzles to solve, unless well-being is a puzzle and the characters are searching for corner pieces.

Playstyle

Our larp is a place for collaborative storytelling. Rather than trying to best our co-players, we aim to engage in mutually fulfilling play. This means there will be situations in which you will come out on top and others where your role will be to suffer a dramatic loss. The most gratifying stories are a good mix of failure and success.

Do’s

- Slowly escalate into physical touch and request permission.
- State your boundaries in verbal negotiations.
- Say “Yes and”...
- Use the safety and game mechanics provided by the organisers.
- Treat all co-players with dignity and respect.
- Respect the personal expression of your co-players.
- Co-create an environment in which all people are welcome provided they follow the Code of Conduct.
- Involve people in your play, such as inviting quieter characters with questions in conversations, offering an empty chair at meals, inviting characters to rituals, etc.
- Dare to end scenes or ask for off-game calibration if needed.

Don’ts

- Touch people who haven’t indicated their enthusiastic and ongoing consent.
- Use any safety or game mechanics NOT in the game design.
- Exclude players based on their physical appearance, quality of costume, age, gender, etc.
- Engage in intense play with others without first engaging in off-game calibration with the players in question.
-

Location

[Put in the details of your location here, consider the accessibility wording we have included and update and amend to fit your location]

Accessibility

We acknowledge that there are many types of accessibility needs and that everyone is unique. The statements below should be considered a starting point not an end point. If you have specific needs or requirements or concerns that are not discussed below we’d invite you to contact us.

Physical access

With regret, we must state that as the location is an old building, with parts of the building dating back to the late Roman imperial period and other parts built in the early 18th century; it does not have step-free access. There are a number of staircases and no lifts; all bedrooms are upstairs. While some players with limited mobility are able to manage at the location, the site is not wheelchair accessible. Some of the larp will take place outdoors, including scenes on uneven ground and stone paths.

Please note that the building is old and may contain mold or dust, which can present challenges for players with respiratory issues. We recommend bringing your own blanket if you are allergic to wool or down feathers.

Sound and light

Parts of the venue and grounds may be dark at times and relying on stage lighting and LED candles for illumination. There will be an amplified soundscape with background music and sound effects playing at certain times in the venue. At certain times, we will ring the convent bell. The building produces an echo which means it is rarely truly quiet indoors. If you have sensory needs please discuss them with us; we may be able to reduce or remove certain frequencies, or increase the lighting if possible.

Food and drink

Meals will be served at regular times. All meals are vegan by default. If you have specific dietary requirements, we will work to meet them if we can. Please make it clear at the time of booking if you have any specific allergies or intolerances so we can ensure that all foods are clearly labelled. There will be no planned interruptions by the organisers during mealtimes. If you need to bring your own food, you may store it in the onsite fridge or in your room.

There will always be access to food, coffee, tea, and drinking water.

Accommodations

Please note the venue is not a hotel with regular service and amenities. The bedrooms include one double bed or 1-4 single beds. Bed linens and towels are provided, but players should bring their own toiletries. Showers are possible as long as they are short due to limited hot water in the tank. In most cases, restrooms, and showers are communally shared with other players.

At the site, wifi and phone signal are highly limited. We are investigating solutions to set up a wifi router for certain parts of the site, but in the event we cannot, please do not assume you will be able to make calls or use the Internet.

Timekeeping

There will be no artificial manipulation of the passage of time. All clocks will show the correct time at all times to the best of our ability.

Electricity & Heating

The location is heated and has electricity. However, not all bedrooms may have plugs that accommodate larger plugs such as laptop power cords. If you have special needs regarding access to power, e.g., to plug in a CPAP, please let us know when you sign up.

Printed Material

The larp does involve printed material that will be used in-game. We will create large print versions of any printed materials if required; please inform us of this during your application.

Opting-out

As ***Lumen*** is an educational larp, we strongly recommend taking part in all in-game activities for maximum learning and community building potential. However, players may opt-out of specific activities if needed. Furthermore, players should calibrate with co-players before initiating physical touch, engaging in romantic play, integrating sensitive content, etc., so that co-players can choose whether or not to opt-in to such experiences. We will practice how to calibrate in the pre-game workshops.

An off-game space is available to all players. You are welcome to enter this space at any time to be alone, decompress, or request help from a safety team member. This space should not be used for animated off-game conversations. Please use bedrooms for that purpose or go for a walk together away from in-game activities. Sleeping is also off-game, and play will cease at 11 PM every night to give all participants time to rest.

Neurodiversity

We acknowledge the spectrum of neurodiversity and the individual needs of players on this spectrum. If there is anything that you need, or if you have any questions, please feel free to contact us on <insert your safety email

here>

Data Security

We will ask participants to disclose some personal and possibly sensitive information at the time of their booking to accommodate their needs at the larp. This information will be kept either in a password protected Gmail account or in a high-security encrypted storage at Uppsala University and not disclosed to any third parties unless required by Erasmus and/or the European Commission. Only the organisers of the event will have access to this data.

Safety contacts

If you have safety needs or concerns before or after the larp, please email <insert your safety email here>. This gmail account is accessible by members of the safety team. While we will try to adhere to confidentiality requests when possible, in some cases, the rest of the organizing team will need to be informed or, in extreme instances, legal authorities.

We will release a Code of Conduct closer to sign-up. This Code will expressly forbid harassment of any kind and detail actions that the safety team will take in case of incidents. All applicants must agree to follow the Code of Conduct in order to participate.

Application process

Due to funding requirements and the educational nature of the larp, players will undergo a multi-stage application process. First, players will submit a written application describing their personal and professional interests in the larp's content.

If selected for the next stage, they will undergo an interview, alone or in a group, with one of the larp organizers. During this stage, a flagging process will occur in which potential players can identify other players on a list with whom they would love to play, they would prefer to avoid in-game, they cannot play, or they have solid reasons to believe is a safety risk.

Selection criteria

Selection will be based on the following criteria:

a) The participants' level of involvement and progress within a helping profession suitable for integrating transformative analog role-playing games, e.g., an established therapeutic practice; a position in a relevant NGO or company; a permanent teaching position in a primary or secondary school, technical college, or university; regular employment at a youth camp or after school program. Our ideal player already has access in a professional capacity to target groups with whom they plan to apply the skills they learn during the larp process in a professional manner according to growth-related goals;
b) The participants' level of understanding and interest in the themes and activities required by the larp.
c) Whilst role-playing experience is not required, related activities are desirable; a proportion of places may be allocated to applicants with larp or tabletop experience.
d) The participants' willingness to undergo their own process of personal transformation and run exercises that help guide others through their own;
e) The participants' level of commitment to increasing the psychological and physical safety of themselves and others;
f) The participants' fitness with the group as a whole;
g) The participants' geographic location in their professional work. Priority will be given to candidates residing in Erasmus+ Programme countries, which can be found linked here.

As we have limited spots in the larp and requirements from our Erasmus funder, the goals of the process is to assemble a diverse player base who are committed to the transformative goals and are able to implement the curriculum in their own contexts around the world soon after the larp, thereby spreading this knowledge and practice.

What if I don't get a spot?

We are well-aware of the anxieties around sign-ups for larps and experience them ourselves. As we have a limited number of slots, we cannot guarantee everyone who signs up can play. However, we plan to host some community building activities online for players interested in learning more about the larp's design and trying out some of its techniques, about which you can opt-in to receiving details. More information will be provided on these opportunities later.

Currently, we do not have plans to re-run the larp, but that might change in the future. However, the larp script will be available in 2026 for facilitators to rerun in their communities and localize in terms of cultural content, which we highly encourage.

Finally, EDGE will have many other ways to access our curricular materials, including two textbooks, the full curriculum for four courses at the Master's level on transformative analog game design, and a Tech Toolkit. More information is available at https://erasmusedge.eu, including how to join our mailing list.

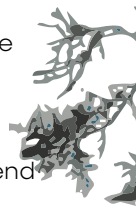
Character creation

Players will co-create their characters together with organizers in a multi-step process that requires some pre-game work before the larp and extensive work during the onsite workshop. This workshop will also establish character relations and facilitate calibration between players. Thus, there is no official casting process or organizer-written relations. As such, we urge all participants to arrive without a set character concept in mind.

Character creation will involve establishing the player's personal growth-related goal(s) and exploring these goals through the fiction.

Characters are based on Jungian-inspired archetypes and will fictionally explore magical powers that derive from metaphysical connections with one or more deities from the Ancient Roman pantheon.

Covid Policy



The safety of our players and crew are paramount. We do not know what the future will bring and so this policy is subject to change up to and during the event itself. We ask all participants to take a Covid test on the day of arrival to the event. If you are travelling from abroad prior to the day of arrival we recommend that you take a test before you set out.

If your test is positive, whether you are symptomatic or not, we ask that you do not attend the site.

Even if you test negative, please always ask permission before touching another participant. While the spaces are small and we cannot ensure social distancing, please respect others who wish to mask and avoid extensive physical contact.

Questions

Please contact us as early as possible to discuss your individual needs at <insert your email here>

Credits

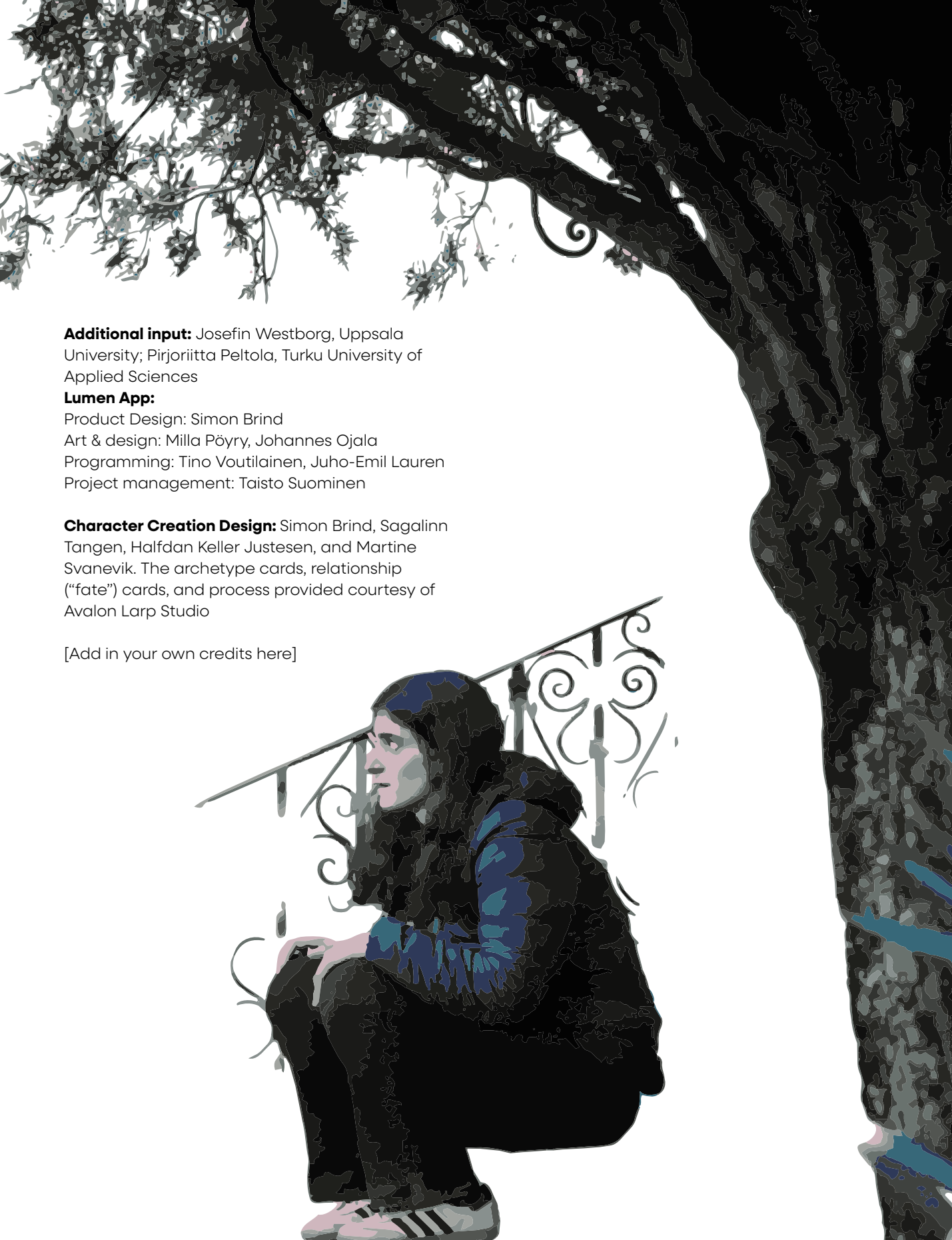
The larp was co-designed and produced by the EDGE Consortium, an Erasmus+ Cooperation Partnerships in Higher Education, with funding from the European Commission. The design had the following leads:

Logistics: Alessandro Giovannucci and Mafalda Morganti, Chaos League

Safety: Sarah Lynne Bowman, Kjell Hedgard Hugaas, and Josephine Baird, Uppsala University; Elektra Diakolambrianou and Angie Bandoesingh, Dragon's Nest

Technology: Taisto Suominen, Turku University of Applied Sciences; Josephine Rydberg from Stockholm University of the Arts (volunteer);

Graphic design: Andrea Giovannucci, Chaos League; Simon Brind, Avalon Larp Studio.



Additional input: Josefin Westborg, Uppsala University; Pirjoriitta Peltola, Turku University of Applied Sciences

Lumen App:
Product Design: Simon Brind
Art & design: Milla Pöyry, Johannes Ojala
Programming: Tino Voutilainen, Juho-Emil Lauren
Project management: Taisto Suominen

Character Creation Design: Simon Brind, Sagalinn Tangen, Halfdan Keller Justesen, and Martine Svanevik. The archetype cards, relationship ("fate") cards, and process provided courtesy of Avalon Larp Studio

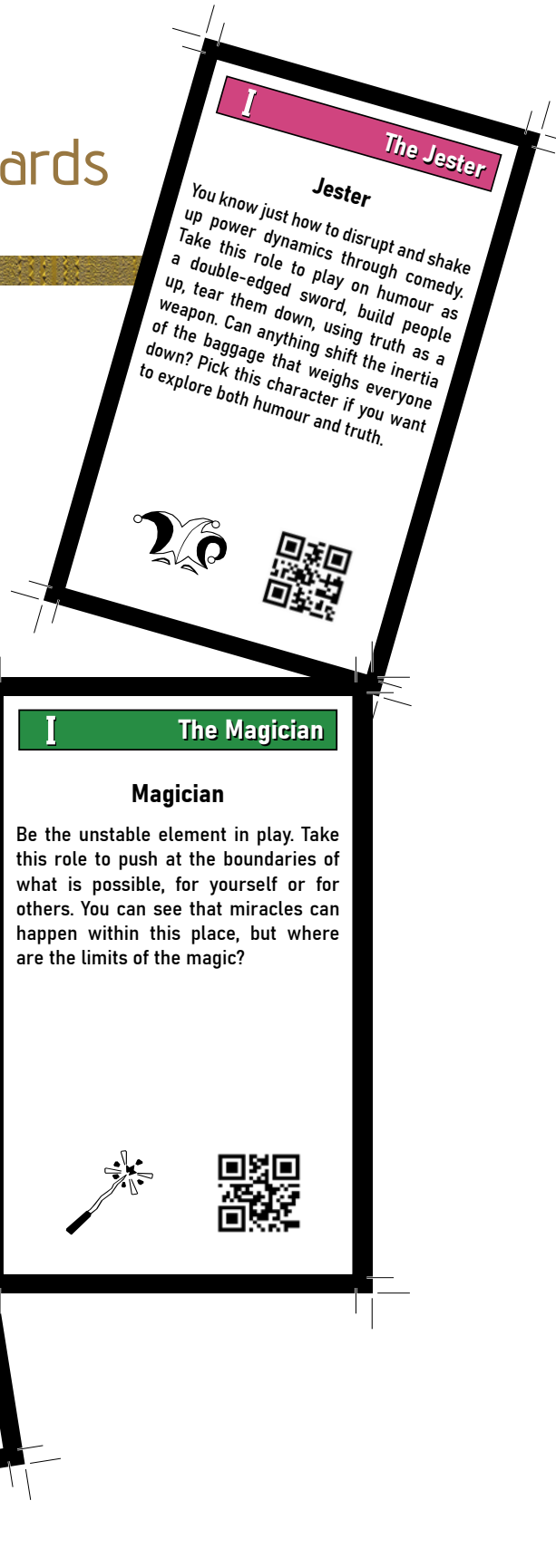
[Add in your own credits here]

Appendix N — Archetype Cards

As a part of the character creation process for the larps The Quota and Avalon, Avalon larp studio designed a set of playable archetypes. These were derived from Jung but sorted into 'families' extending the twelve basic archetypes to a set of one hundred and four that could be used as a design tool. For Lumen, a subset of these archetypes form the basis for character creation (see Appendix G).

These archetypes are provided as printable assets on the following pages. They are colour coded into their twelve 'families.' They are also available in the LumanAR app.

You are welcome to print these pages out.



I The Magician

Magician

Be the unstable element in play. Take this role to push at the boundaries of what is possible, for yourself or for others. You can see that miracles can happen within this place, but where are the limits of the magic?

II The Magician

Visionary

You can always imagine a better purpose, and you know how to get people believing in it too. Pick this character to play the charismatic leader. How can you make your dreams into reality?

III The Magician

Catalyst

Change is inevitable, in this environment you have the immense privilege of often being the cause. In the outside world this character is the fight starter and sometimes the accidental hero who started revolutions, but here they are the spark that ignites change. Pick this character to play someone who initiates transformation, on a small or larger scale. Are you brave enough to initiate a change in your own life?

IV The Magician

Enchanter

There is a power to you. You know what you want and how to get people to want the same. Pick this character if you want to draw people in and create a pack of followers. There aren't that many games to play in this place, but you know how to run them. Can you learn to use this power for good?

V The Magician

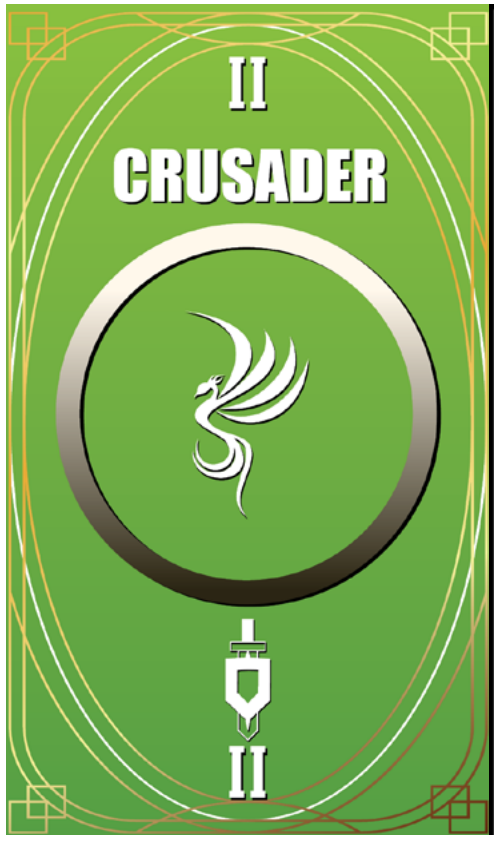
Charmer

A smooth talking person of action. When others may back down and admit defeat you will be there to smooth things over and bring others over to your way of thinking. The purpose of this character is to have someone who solves conflicts and soothes tensions. Pick this character to play someone who brings people together, even in dire circumstances. You are a bringer of peace, but can you find peace inside of yourself?

I The Hero

Hero

Lend your strength to others who are struggling. Inspire hope even where no hope can be found. Take this role if you want to rally people and inject energy into the larp. Can you inspire people to be the best they can be? Can you stay strong no matter what, with so many people depending on you?



II The Hero

Crusader

The Crusader is a catalyst for change. Use your voice and reach out in the protection of others. Take this role to be an agent of change, the champion of the suffering, even where they don't want it. Can you keep on track even when others beg you to stop? Can you find a way to rest and to allow yourself to heal?

III The Hero

Rescuer

People in peril? Well, it's time for you to act. Are you courageous enough to wade into danger in support of those who need it? Do you search for someone to rescue? Who will in turn save you? Pick this role if you want to save others, but be aware that they will want to help you too; it is not selfish to accept their assistance!

IV The Hero

Martyr

The world is a dangerous place, sensible people may keep their head down and avoid trouble but someone has to take a stand even if it means their own demise. Do you have the strength of conviction to stand against the tide no matter the cost? Pick this role if you are willing to sacrifice yourself for others, but try to find a way to accept that you are loved; can you find a way to save others without destroying yourself?

V The Hero

Champion

The purpose of this character is to highlight an issue, to raise it with the authorities and fight to change it. The world is unfair and many inequalities will present themselves to you. Do you have what it takes to take up a cause, even if it seems impossible? Can you bring others with you and share a victory with others? Pick this character if you are driven to stand up for something you believe in.

I The Lover

Lover

Love, they say, conquers all. As The Lover, you can always find light in the darkness through your intense emotions and genuine care for another, or for others. Pick this character if you wish to play on the power of love in both its selfish and selfless guises. To see if love is enough, Can you use it to inspire others to love?

II The Lover

Enthusiast

There is something you have a passion for, something so distracting that even the sorrows and challenges of your life. You like to talk about it to others even if they don't, so expect some characters to lose their temper with you on occasion. Are you using it to hide your true feelings or can it be the light that drives you forwards? Pick this character to explore the ways you can give energy and knowledge to others by sharing your passion.

III The Lover

Confidante

The listener and the best friend. This character has no ulterior motive behind their need to support those they care about. Play this character if you want to be someone who will always be there for the characters they are close to, always ready to listen and offer advice no matter what is going on in their life. You are so good at listening to others, but can you find the strength inside to allow someone else to listen to your heart?

IV The Lover

Brokenhearted

There is something inside you that seems irrevocably broken. You might not set out to get yourself hurt, but you end up there every time. Or perhaps you merely try to replicate in reality the pain that is already inside you? The purpose of this character is to set themselves up for failure to find a way back from there. Pick this character if you wish to start play lost and alone. Can you find a way to connect with others and allow yourself to be healed?

V The Lover

Romantic

This character believes in some kind of fantasy where they - or another hero - will swoop in to save the day. Play this character if you want to play someone who believes everything will work out in the end. Can you see the truth? Can you find a way to a happy ending?

I The Jester

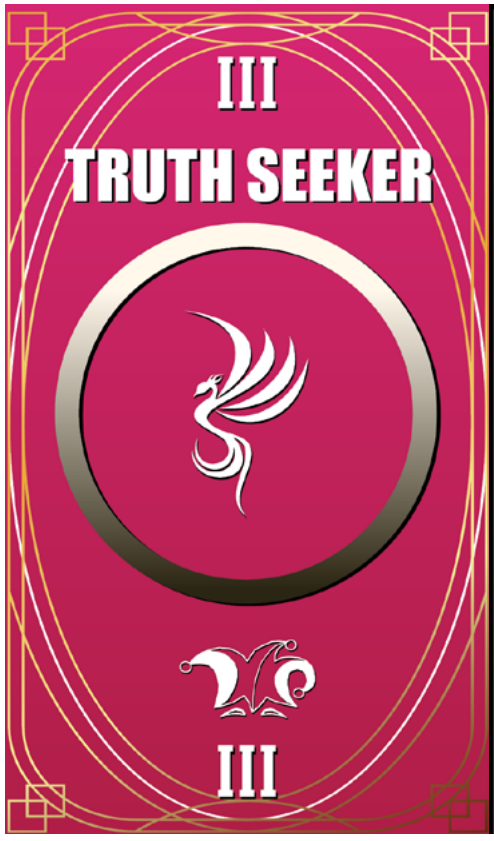
Jester

You know just how to disrupt and shake up power dynamics through comedy. Take this role to play on humour as a double-edged sword, build people up, tear them down, using truth as a weapon. Can anything shift the inertia of the baggage that weighs everyone down? Pick this character if you want to explore both humour and truth.

II The Jester

Fool

This character thinks they know it all but they don't. Play this character if you want to lead others into danger, failure and potentially despair when they realise you aren't what you claim to be, but find a way to admit your mistakes and to seek wisdom in the end.



III The Jester

Truth Seeker

This character cannot be silenced, they will speak out even if it costs them dearly. Playing this character will give you the opportunity to break lies and quash the spread of false information. To some you will be a hero and others a nuisance. Are you willing to tell the truth to yourself? Pick this character if you want to ask questions - sometimes difficult questions - but be prepared to answer those questions as well.

IV The Jester

Comedian

Bring gallows humour to the darkest places and off-set the bleakness of the place with clever jokes. Of course you might be laughing on the outside, but on the inside it is a different matter. Play this character if you want to explore the conflict of someone who wants to make others happy but who is hurting inside. Can you find a way to bring joy and laugher to the comedian as well as the audience?

V The Jester

Joker

Your situation may be dire but humour is the best medicine. How much does it cost to always put up a happy face? Can you let down the armour that your have created yourself and allow yourself to be vulnerable and then to be free? Pick this character if you want to be the funny one, the person that others need to lighten the mood even at the most dire of times.

I The Everyperson

Everyperson

The everyperson is someone who stays on the narrow path, playing within the system rather than against it. Not to rock the boat and try to come out the other side. Take this character to attempt to conform and survive in a world that is arbitrary and may or may not reward you. How can you turn this position into one that will allow change?

II The Everyperson

Critic

The purpose of this character is to strip away the illusions people carry. This can be done for their own good or maliciously. Take this role to antagonise and to try to get people to open their eyes. Only with their eyes open will they have a chance of finding what they are seeking. But not everyone wants to see the world the way you do. Can you find a way to change this character into one who can help others, and can you learn to heal yourself?

III The Everyperson

Realist

The Realist believes it's important to keep people's dreams from running away with them, keep them focussed on the practical issues. Take this role to butt up against more extreme and maverick characters. Will you be the voice of reason or the voice of doubt? Will you give up trying to make others understand and go it alone? Can you let go of your certainty and allow yourself to fly?

IV The Everyperson

Stalwart

See and support the strength in other characters, believe, not in the place you find yourself but in them, as individuals, and their ability to grow. Take this role to be a good friend, loyal and unwavering. You can achieve more together as a group. Can you be as good a friend to yourself as you are to others?

V The Everyperson

Fatalist

At the start, you are the voice of hopelessness. The one who has, for good reason, convinced themselves that there is no happy ending to be had for anyone. Pick this part if you want to push people to give into despair and to provide others with someone to argue against if they want to keep believing. What is the cost to you of always keeping hope at arms length? Can you find a happy ending?

I The Caregiver

Caregiver

You provide a sanctuary in a hostile place. You give of yourself in a place that is hungry for emotional sustenance and validation. Pick this character to make a difference by means of real emotional connections between players. Can you learn that self-care is a radical act?

II The Caregiver

Altruist

The altruist considers the need of the many over the need of the few. The purpose of this character is to have someone who will pull people together and seek to make a difference for everyone. Pick this character to explore tensions between your own personal needs and the good of your group. Can you find a way to look after your own needs too?

III The Caregiver

Mediator

The Mediator is someone whose key ability is to foster understanding between people. The purpose of this character is to act as a bridge between individuals who otherwise wouldn't see eye to eye. Pick this character if you wish to try to soothe tensions and help build community. Is the joy you feel from helping others enough? How can you find peace?

IV The Caregiver

Humanitarian

Be the one who consistently puts others' needs before their own. A safe haven in a place with few comforts. The core values for the humanitarian are compassion, empathy and care. Pick this character if you want to play someone who is fierce in their care for others and who has a strong faith in the human spirit. Can you bring joy to others by finding your own safety and see your joy reflected in their love?

V The Caregiver

Parent

The parent has unconditional love, care and understanding for their children, whether biological offspring or the people they consider family. The purpose of this character is to have someone gentle and caring towards their own, and unconditionally protective of their needs. Will you do whatever it takes to protect your family? Can you come to appreciate their love for you?

I The Ruler

Ruler

You know how to get people to follow you, to rally those within the centre and try and build unity through leadership. Take this role to give others orders to follow and a clear sense of direction. Can you steer between decisiveness and tyranny? Is effective leadership possible when the ruler is broken; can you heal yourself without losing those who follow your rule?

II The Ruler

Leader

The leader cannot help but take control, this is not malicious just merely part of their character. With their guidance, any obstacle can be overcome and damned be those who do not follow your lead. Play this character to explore public speaking and team leading even in the direst of situations. Leadership is inspirational and collaborative, can you heal by example?

III The Ruler

Politician

Popularity is a means to both control your environment and guard yourself. Play this character to be the popular one using whatever means necessary. If it means lying to some to gain the favour of the many then so be it.

IV The Ruler

Manager

Management is a skill and uses a number of well understood techniques to get the best out of people. Play this character if you are interested in leading your group towards a set of SMART objectives which may include some or all of them finding what they are looking for. Will you be an effective manager, or will your well meaning words and processes ultimately fail; after all, not every situation is like the work place.

V The Ruler

Diplomat

There is always a third option, the world of the diplomat may be one of peace or simply about finding the quickest resolution to a conflict. Pick this character if you wish to make deals both between groups and perhaps with the divinities themselves. Can you find a settlement that can give you peace?

I The Creator

Creator

You use creativity and ingenuity to find new and better ways of doing things. The creator is someone who sees the potential for creating something beautiful even in the darkness. Take this role to look for positive opportunities in the world. Is it possible to make the place better using only the limited resources to hand?

II The Creator

Innovator

Tinker with systems and relations in pursuit of something better. A pragmatist who nonetheless seeks to improve both how things run and how people interact. Take this role to keep prodding at things that might seem fixed, choose risk over stability. Shake things up. Can you create something you end up wanting to stay and protect?

III The Creator

Poet

You know how to create an alternate reality for themselves and others, a garden of bright images into which to escape. Take this role to dream and seek to share your dreams. To move others and collect their stories. Is it possible to create beauty out of personal darkness or struggles?

IV The Creator

Builder

You believe in stability, and solid construction. The purpose of this role is to consolidate what they can scavenge and build something new both physically and metaphorically. Play this character if you want to be a leader or a creative type working for the betterment of all around them. Can you build a new world for yourself and your community?

V The Creator

Inventor

The inventor is looking outside the box to make life easier for themselves and maybe others around them. With one improvement made they will be on to the next task, another opportunity to show how clever they are. But can you invent a machine for fixing yourself?

I The Innocent

Innocent

Provide a wide-eyed counterpoint to many of the more cynical characters. Take on this character if you want to play on vulnerability as strength, and create scenes where others are drawn to protect, despise or be inspired by your innocence. Can you persuade the world that it is possible to still see people as essentially good?

II The Innocent

Saint

The Saint can introduce a note of gentle otherworldliness to inspire other characters, to help them believe in themselves and find redemption (however you interpret that). Take this role to play someone whose reserves of sympathy can absorb the pain of others, whose compassion seems boundless. There is so much pain here, though. How can you find redemption and share your grace with others?

III The Innocent

Empathic

Listen to the stories of the other characters and to spread those stories in an attempt to achieve understanding. Take this character to play a key role in helping other characters embody their roles. See them in the way they want to be seen. You will gain a great deal of knowledge of the other characters in this larp, can you use this for the good of your community?

IV The Innocent

Dreamer

Inspire and remind others of pasts and futures in the world outside. Take this role to offer relief to others by sharing and encouraging them to dream a better future and remember past happiness and perhaps, to find a way to bring your dreams into reality?

V The Innocent

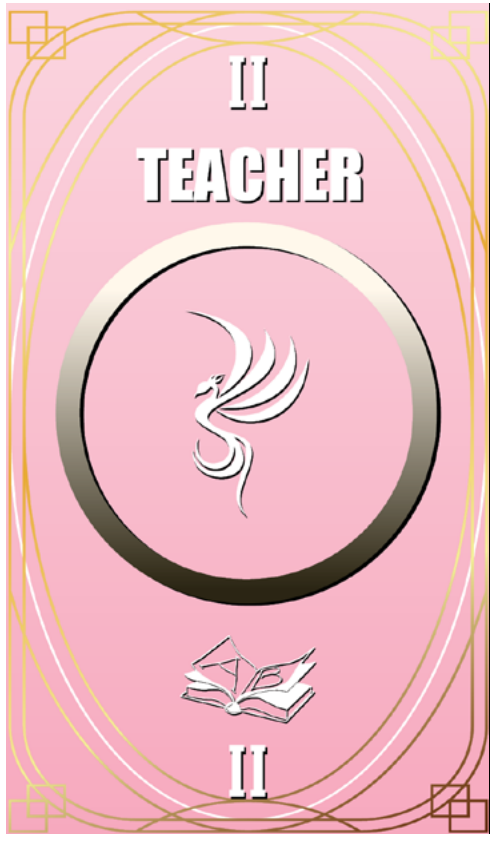
Survivor

The purpose of this character is to inject perseverance and ingenuity into the action. Without taking sides, you'll do whatever it takes. Pick this role to play on the unshakable will to survive that may or may not be destructive to others. Can you learn to let go?

I The Sage

Sage

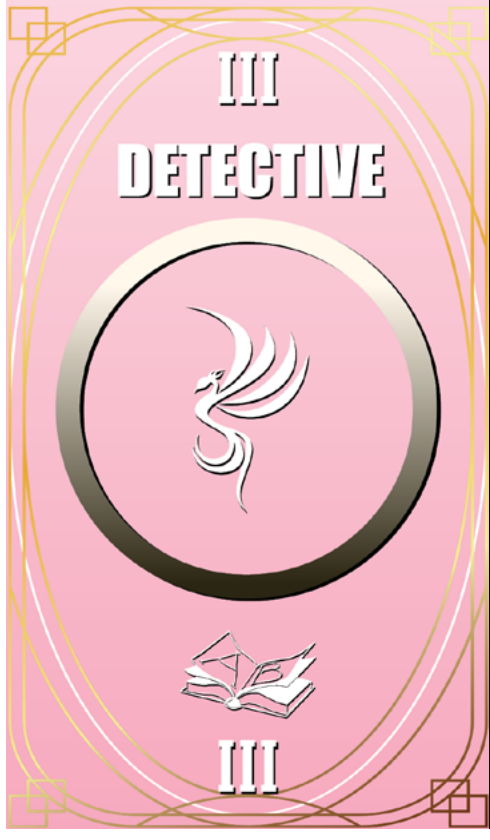
Provide clarity (or this illusion of it) to other characters who are seeking it. Take this role to play on wisdom and spiritual leadership. To see if it is possible to rise above the hopelessness of the world. A clear mind and a peaceful soul will always see the path.



II The Sage

Teacher

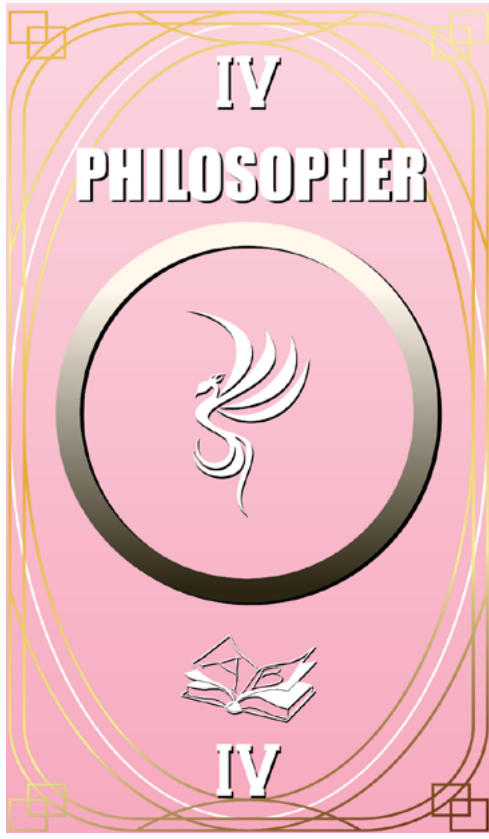
The teacher cannot standby watching others struggle, they will offer assistance in the form of advice and the sharing of knowledge. Play this character if you wish to play a kind and caring character who seeks to help others. What is the lesson that you need to learn?



III The Sage

Detective

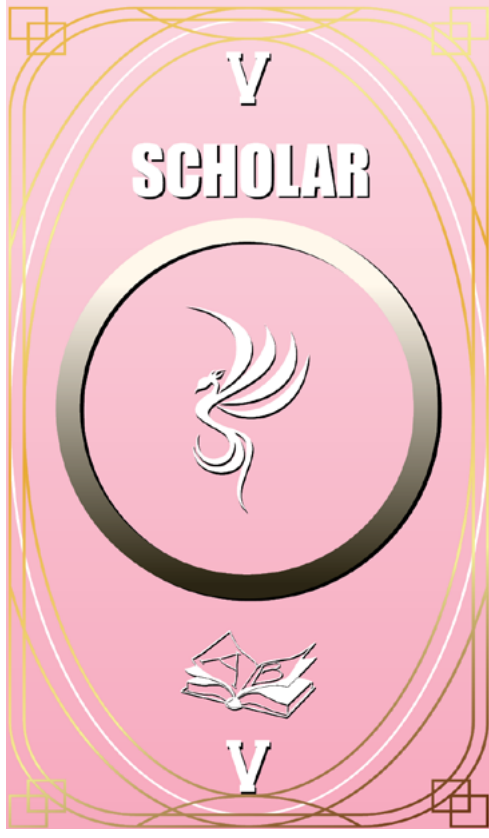
There is always a mystery to solve. Understanding people and their motives - what makes them tick - and getting to the bottom of anything that happens is crucial. Someone has to ensure that the truth is discovered. Play this character if you want to bring a little hard-boiled noir to the larp. You'll see the world in terms of extremes, light and dark, good guys and bad guys. Can you solve your own case, the hardest mystery of them all?



IV The Sage

Philosopher

Questioning the meaning of truth, existence and reality is what you do. The philosopher has an analytical and inquisitive mind. Pick this character to play someone who takes a step back and considers the meaning behind the writing on the wall. What is the true purpose of this place? What does it really mean to be a part of it? Can the love of knowledge include knowledge of yourself?



V The Sage

Scholar

The scholar is someone who burrows into topics. Whether that means endless nights chasing information on Wikipedia or digging into old archives in university, this character has a drive for knowledge and understanding that cannot be stopped. Can you uncover the truth that you need?

I The Explorer

Explorer

The Explorer believes in the power of new experiences. The purpose of this character is to encourage risk taking and escalation within the larp. Take this role to be a focal point of energy for fellow-participants. To see whether a buccaneer attitude is rewarded or punished by the spirits here. In the end will the adventure be its own reward? If not, can you find a way for your adventurous spirit to set you free?

II The Explorer

Pilgrim

The purpose of this character is to go on a metaphorical journey in search of some truth or to find peace. Take this role if you want to encourage others to travel with you in order to receive some truth or treasure. Can you explore doubt in what you believe in, ride a rollercoaster but come out the other side and find the end of the rainbow?

III The Explorer

Seeker

The seeker is always looking for enlightenment, finding answers and encouraging others to do the same. Take this role if you want to be a hub of knowledge and to ask a lot of questions and assimilate a lot of answers. There are hidden truths in the larp and in the people you will meet. What will you find and how can it heal you?

IV The Explorer

Wanderer

The Wanderer is rarely at peace. Always chasing that elusive "somewhere else" where they can finally experience a sense of belonging, never quite finding it. The purpose of this character is to explore the edges of human experience, to make other players question their own contentment. Pick this character to go on a physical and spiritual journey. Can you find your centre in this and how will you find somewhere to call home?

V The Explorer

Gambler

One way or the other, the gambler is always calculating odds, stacking the cards in their own favour, playing people against each other. Pick this character if you wish to manipulate others, whilst calculating what is the best side to be on at any given moment.

I The Outlaw

Outlaw

The Outlaw has no respect for authority or anyone else's rules but their own. The purpose of this character is to stand up to authority and to refuse to be cowed by them. You will be unpopular with those in authority, and because of your behaviour you may not have many friends. Sometimes you need to inspire others to take a stand, can you find a way to salvation along this sometimes lonely path?

II The Outlaw

Rebel

Rage against the system, finding ways of subversion or small moments of rebellion. Pick this part if you wish to push people to question their complacency, choices and preconceptions. Somehow you need to find a way to turn that need to rebel into a path to self discovery - what is it you are rebelling against? What have you got?

III The Outlaw

Revolutionary

You believe in change and you know how to talk with enough zeal and fervour to win others to your side. Sometimes your radical belief can be transformational but sometimes it leads to defeat. How can you make a change that will truly make a difference but without coming full circle?

IV The Outlaw

Free Agent

Not aligned with any particular group or cause your primary function is to facilitate negotiation, to defuse tension, and to spread rumour. Play this character if you are at your best outside of a team, or if you want the challenge of operating without back-up. In the end you re looking for reconciliation and a way to join in with others sometimes this involves giving up that freedom. Does it have to be that way?

V The Outlaw

Individual

This character takes great steps to make sure they are different from others. Play this character if you want to push the limits of self-imposed isolation or a longing to be "unique." How do you make use of this singular nature and use that energy for growth?

Appendix O — Fate Cards

The fates cards are a tool for creating playable relationships between characters in role-playing games. Originally designed by Avalon larp studio as a tool for character writers, this set was customised specifically for Lumen. They are offered as printable assets on the following pages and should be used in conjunction with the instructions in Appendix G.

They show two different aspects to a potential relationship and include questions for the players or character writers for them to consider.

Fates

Fates

Forbidden Romance

We don't choose who we fall in love with and some romances happen against all probability and are unsupported even by friends and family. How did you meet? How did you come to be in love? What is the very best thing about the other?

Forbidden Romance

Being in love in secret is hard and often heartbreaking. Why are you are not allowed to be together? Who or what is stopping you? How could this be resolved?

Fates

Fates

Rivals

Your characters have some sort of rivalry between them, what is it? In what ways has your rivalry pushed each other towards greatness? What caused/inspired your rivalry? What do you respect most about the other?

Rivals

What are the destructive aspects of this rivalry? What is the worst thing you have done in your attempt to outperform the other? How could one of you finally win and what would the consequences be?

Fates

Fates

Inseparable Siblings

You have been inseparable since day one. Whatever may come, you'll always be each other's first best friend, and nothing can sever that bond. How did your childhood mold you into a team? In what ways are you similar to one another? What have you forgiven each other for?

Inseparable Siblings

No one can get on your nerves like those closest to you. You love your sibling, but that doesn't mean your relationship is entirely without turbulence. Why do you still think the other person needs to grow up? How do you push each other's buttons on purpose? What was your latest conflict about? Why wasn't it resolved?

Fates

Fates

Estranged Siblings

There was a time when your relationship was, if not good, at least neutral. All hope is not lost; perhaps you can find your way back. How do you remember the best part(s) of your relationship? Why do you want to repair your relationship? What would it take for you to forgive your sibling?

Estranged Siblings

You two are always at each other's throats; family events are a nightmare. Being expected to not only love, but also like each other, only turns hatred into bitterness. Why do you blame each other for your relationship? In what ways are you irreconcilably different? What old grudges do you still hold against each other?

Lovers

You mean the world to each other. When and how did you meet? How long have you been together? Why is the other your soul-mate?

Lovers

You risk co-dependency, you isolate each other. In what ways are your needs not being met in this relationship? When did you last cross a boundary with each oth-er? Why would an ending thrust you into despair?

Best Friends

How long have you been friends for? Where and how did you meet? What is the mean-ing of 'Best Friends' to each of you?

Best Friends

You know one another so well, in what ways does friendship become controlling or toxic? What was the worst argument you have ever had about? In what ways do you reinforce one another's bad be-haviours?

Fates

Fates

Mentor and Protégé

How have you already caused each other to improve? What have you taught or learned from one another?

Mentor and Protégé

How do you adversely affect each other's independence? What are the aspects of this relationship that need to be resolved?

Fates

Fates

Parent and Child

This can be a biological relation or a symbolic one. How do you care for one another? What is the most important thing about your relationship?

Parent and Child

Why do you think the other person ought to be more grateful? What bars you from understanding one another? When and how have you disappointed each other in the past?

Fates

Fates

Long-Lost Siblings

Somehow you always knew that you had a sibling; describe how this manifested.

Long-Lost Siblings

Time has changed both of you - how? What is the nature of the distance between you? How can you regain your relationship?

Fates

Fates

Secret Admirers

Tell the player of the character you admire what is it that you admire about their character. The character, of course, does not know this.

Secret Admirers

There must be a reason why you have chosen not to reveal this admiration; what is it? At its most extreme, why are you afraid to reveal this secret?

Enemies Turned Allies

Adversity sometimes helps people come together. What is the story here? Why were you in opposition and how did you come together?

Fates

Fates

Enemies Turned Allies

Are there some aspects of this antagonistic past you have not yet addressed? What still needs to be resolved or forgiven?

Unlikely Allies

You may not have been adversaries, but there is something unusual about your friendship. In what ways were you different and how did you come together?

Fates

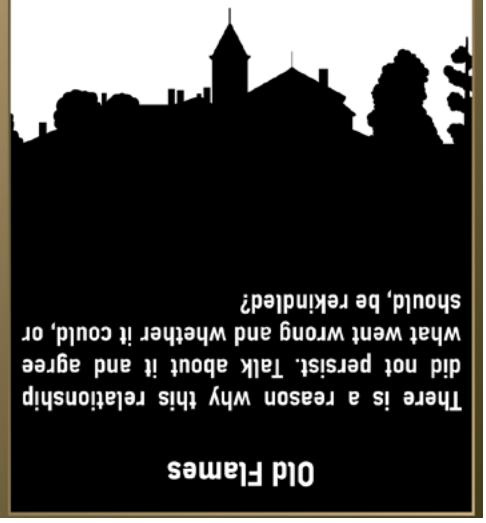
Fates

Unlikely Allies

What happens when your alliance is no longer needed? Discuss the frictions in your relationship and what would be needed to protect it.

Old Flames

In every love story there is a perfect time and place. What is your character's "We'll always have Paris" moment? Remember the best night of your time together.



Old Flames

There is a reason why this relationship did not persist. Talk about it and agree what went wrong and whether it could, or should, be rekindled?

Master and Servant

Rather than being a literal description of a relationship, this is a metaphor for an unequal power balance. What does this term mean to you, how did in manifest in positive ways?

Master and Servant

What are the negative aspects of this imbalance. How do you take advantage of each other?

Partners in Crime

This term can refer to youthful hijinx rather than real criminality; make up a story or two you can share. If you do want it to be criminal, consider the balance of the larp and keep it realistic.

Fates

Fates

Partners in Crime

You are headed or have travelled down a dark path together, discuss this. What had gone wrong. What is the downside of this relationship and now could it become something else?

One-time Enemies

What happened all those years ago that set you against one another? Why did (the aftermath of) that one moment have a positive influence on your life?

Fates

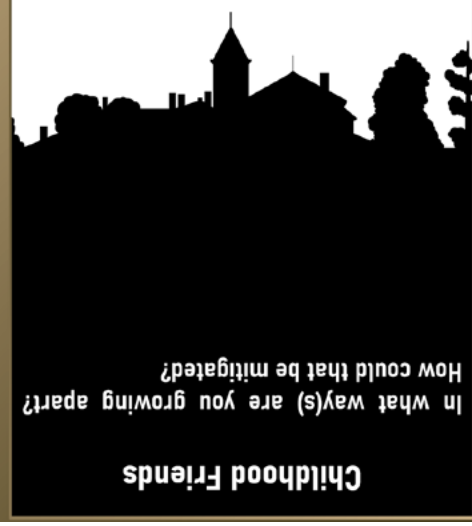
Fates

One-time Enemies

What is stopping you from letting go of the past? What would it take for all signs to be forgiven?

Childhood Friends

How old were you when you met? Find a shared memory. What is an inside joke you have that no one else gets?



Childhood Friends

In what way(s) are you growing apart? How could that be mitigated?

Fates

Fates

Estranged Family Members

It is sad when family members fall out, but tell one another about the happy times.

Estranged Family Members

Why did you fall out with one another? Why are you struggling to reconnect? What would it take for a reconciliation?

Fates

Fates

Bitter Exes

You used to be good to (and for) each other. What happened? How does your antagonism for one another play out?

Bitter Exes

You bring out the worst in each other. Think about your behaviours and how these could be identified and worked on so that you could work towards some forgiveness.

Fates

Fates

Shared Addiction

You understand each others struggle in a way no one else can. What is the nature of the addiction. How did (or does) it manifest.

Shared Addiction

Talk about the ways that you enable each other but pivot from here into finding a way you can support one another's recovery.

Fates

Fates

Secret Siblings

Why can you never tell the world that you are related? Tell about a time you still managed to be together.

Fates

Fates

Secret Siblings

How does your secret put you at risk? What would it take to release you from the past?

Criminal Past

How was it that you met? Tell a tale of a time you got away with a crime. Try to keep the crime realistic, small scale rather than murder or espionage.

Fates

Fates

Criminal Past

You will take each other down if one of you falls. Consider how to unpick this web of crime and find a way to find justice, or redemption.

Teacher and Student

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters? What have you already learned from each other?

Teacher and Student

How will you react when the student surpasses the master? What is the benefit of this relationship beyond what you have taught or learned from one another? How can it become a friendship built on mutual respect?

Fates

Fates

Distant Relatives

Blood is thicker than water, find some family connection that binds you. What is this wedge and how can it be released?

Distant Relatives

There is implicit loyalty, yet family politics have driven a wedge between you. What is the nature of this wedge and how can it be released?

Fates

Fates

Co-workers

Strange to find a co-worker at Hope. Find some common ground or tell a story of your shared work place.

Fates

Fates

Co-workers

How do your work roles bleed into your relationship? How can a colleague become a friend? What does it take to build trust?

Fates

Leader and Follower

What does this term mean to you, how does it manifest in positive ways?

Fates

Leader and Follower

How might the leader be willing to sacrifice the follower? What would cause the follower to leave? With these in mind, what would it take to cement the relationship and remove any perceived imbalance?

Fates

Fates

Savior and Saved

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters?

Savior and Saved

Is there is a debt to be repaid here? How can the imbalance in this relationship change into something mutual?

Fates

Fates

Frenemies

Agree on the positive aspects of your strange frenemy relationship. What do you like about one another?

Frenemies

When have you gone too far in the past? What would happen if you did again? What would it take for you to be true friends?

Neighbors

Strange to find someone who lives close at Hope. Find some common ground or tell a story of your shared community.

Fates

Fates

Neighbors

How far are you willing to go to keep the peace? How can you build true trust with someone you only vaguely know?

Comrades in Arms

This does not necessarily involve literal warfare, find a shared story either of adversity or victory.

Fates

Fates

Comrades in Arms

Sometimes you need to lay down your arms in order to move forward. How do you stop each other from doing that? Find a way to strengthen the bond that you have that transcends the shared struggle.

Fates

Fates

Healer and Patient

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters?

Healer and Patient

There is always a risk that something will go wrong. When was the last time that happened, and what did it look like? How do you change the nature of this relationship into something that will last?

Fates

Fates

Detective and Informant

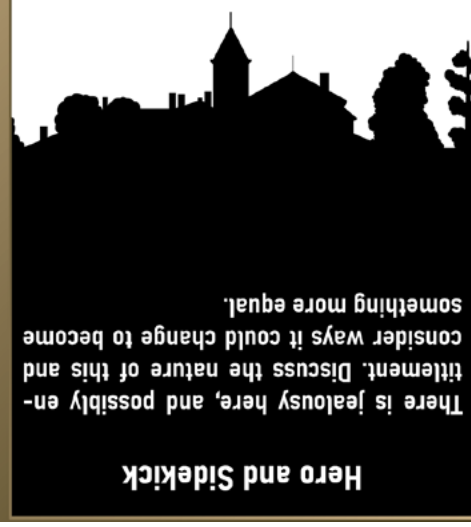
This is not necessarily a literal detective, but it could be. One of you wants information from the other; what is this information? How was it that you met? Tell a tale of a time you helped one another out. Do you trust one another?

Detective and Informant

How do you put each other at risk? Is there anything about this relationship that is not transactional. How to you change the nature of this relationship so that it is built on a foundation of trust?

Hero and Sidekick

You are an unstoppable duo but one of you is slightly in the shadow of the other. Talk about this and explain why the relationship works for you both.



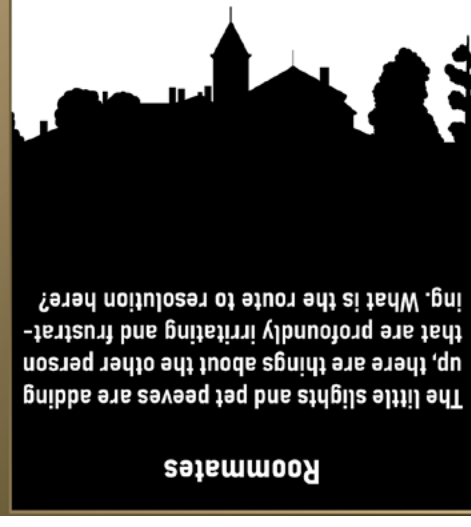
Hero and Sidekick

There is jealousy here, and possibly entitlement. Discuss the nature of this and consider ways it could change to become something more equal.

Fates

Roommates

Strange to find someone who lives with you at Hope. Find some common ground or tell a story of your shared household.



Roommates

The little slights and pet peeves are adding up, there are things about the other person that are profoundly irritating and frustrating. What is the route to resolution here?

Fates

Fates

Fates

Business Partners

You work together and have clearly been successful. Make some shared stories about your business successes.

Business Partners

Why would/could you usurp each other? How is the business changing and what - if not changed - will lead to you abandoning one another? What is the nature of the change that needs to be made?

Fates

Fates

Old Rivals

How has your rivalry settled down. What is the best thing about your old rival?

Old Rivals

You may fall back into old patterns. What are these patterns and how can they manifest in the game? How can they be resolved?

Fates

Fates

Adoptive Family

Some say that the family we choose is the most important kind of family. Discuss this choice and find some powerful bonds.

Adoptive Family

Why is the adoptive bond not enough for you? What do you need to consolidate the love you have for one another?

Fates

Fates

Pen Pals

Discuss the letters or messages you have sent to one another and how this long distance - written - relationship has grown.

Pen Pals

You have not actually met prior to this. How might you disappoint each other? How can this disappointment be forgiven?

Fates
Fates
Amicable Exes
You were in love once. How did you fall for each other? What broke you up?
Amicable Exes
What parts of yourselves are you giving up in order to maintain a positive relationship? Can it be rekindled? Should it be? Or can you find a way to stay friends?

Fates
Fates
Friendly Competitors
What does competition mean to you both? Make some shared stories that are primarily about fun.
Friendly Competitors
When do you become unfriendly? What are the risks of you both being here? Is there a way for you both to win?

Rebel and Authority Figure

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters?

Fates

Fates

Rebel and Authority Figure

How are you purposefully misunderstanding each other? What are the steps towards mutual respect?

Idol and Fan

This phrase can be interpreted in different ways; what makes sense for your characters?

Fates

Fates

Idol and Fan

In what ways is this relationship unhealthy? What happens when the idol steps/falls off their pedestal? How can this relationship become something more mutual, or is there a way to replace toxicity with kindness and respect?

Fates

Fates

Found Family

Some say that the family we choose is the most important kind of family. Discuss this choice and find some powerful bonds.

Found Family

Your fear of losing this family is preventing you from setting clear boundaries. What needs to be done to make this bond a healthy and sustainable one?

Fates

Fates

Friends to Enemies

You were friends, once. What are your most treasured shared memories?

Friends to Enemies

How/why did you fall out? What does the path to forgiveness look like?

Opposites Attract

What is it that you see in one another?

Opposites Attract

This cannot end well; you are an explosion waiting to happen. What could be the trigger? How can this be defused?

Fates

Fates

Political Rivals

Find some grounds for mutual respect. You might disagree on politics but where do you agree?

Political Rivals

You may corrupt one another. How might this play out? What is the reconciliation path?

Fates

Fates

War Buddies

This does not necessarily involve literal warfare, find a shared story either of adversity or victory.

War Buddies

You excuse each other's behaviour because of your shared story. How can you call one another out and help each other to be a better person?

Survivors of Trauma

Please discuss your shared trauma and how you have supported one another in the past.

Survivors of Trauma

You are each other's triggers. Find a way or ways to help each other find a way to break the cycle.

Survivors of a Tragedy

Please discuss your shared tragedy and talk about how you have supported one another in the past.

Fates

Fates

Survivors of a Tragedy

Which one of you suffered the most? In what ways are you not supporting one another? In what ways are you in competition? Find a different path towards healing.

Childhood Bully and Victim

One of you has an outlet for their insecurity, the other for their rage.

Fates

Fates

Childhood Bully and Victim

Your old wounds have festered. Plan an opportunity for working through your issues. Is forgiveness possible?

Terrible Secret

You are fiercely loyal, because betrayal isn't an option. What is this secret? (If the secret is too terrible, consider whether it should come out in open play. Check the lines and veils of co-players.)

Fates

Fates

Tragic Secret

Your grief has bound you together. (If the secret is too tragic, consider whether it should come out in open play. Check the lines and veils of co-players.)

Fates

Fates

Appendix P — Workshop: Plot Design

Our ability to communicate not just our own experiences but the experiences of others enables us to transcend personal frameworks and take on wider perspectives. This attribute, together with its international, transhistorical and transcultural usage, makes storytelling a powerful learning tool. (Alterio and McDrury 2003, p. 7)

Introduction

Like many larps, Lumen has a simple three act structure. In act one we introduce the seekers to the story world and show them how to interact with it, In the second act there is rising action as they learn to use the transformational magic and then the larp moves towards a resolution in act three after they have used the magic to complete their journeys.

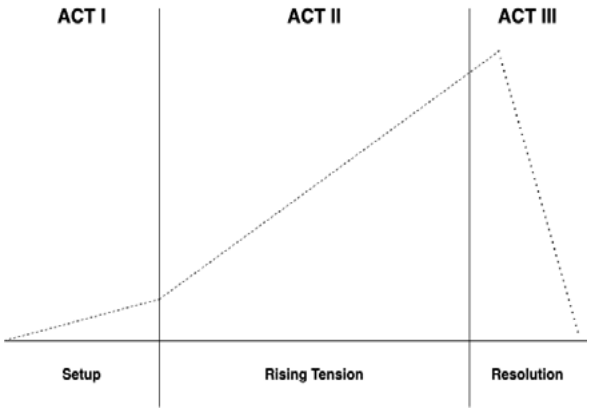


Figure 1: Three-act narrative structure.

In the final act of the larp, we want the players to find a satisfactory conclusion for the overall story arc of the game. This will help to consolidate the learning, as many people remember experiences better as a part of a narrative. However we must recognise the subjective nature of stories, and the individuals who will play the Guides. You, as Guides, need to be able to deliver the plot to players in a way that does not disrupt their play or adversely affect you as people.

In this short document we will explain the purpose of the final act, and then give you the "plot" of the larp, which you will run during the larp. "Plot" is used in the sense of plotting a series of events or occurrences planned by the organisers that the players can interact with. The function of a plot in the literary sense is to connect with readers and to provide a structure that enables them to navigate through the story (Bell 2004): the emergent part of larp as a form.

In this larp, the plot is that the time has come for a changing of the Guides. There is a limit to how long a Guide can channel divinity before they lose the connection to the gods, and some (not all) of the Guides at Lumen are nearing this point. Think of it like a metaphor for burnout: one can only go so long at this intensity level to awaken others before one needs to stop. But if the Guides leave Lumen or stop channeling divinity, then how will new seekers reach their transformation? And how will the Guides feel ready to move on when the time comes?

It is up to the players to find a way to resolve this, most probably by helping the Guides to resolve their own paths and find their way forward -- using the same tools they themselves have been Guided to learn. That way the stories of the two groups -- Seekers and Guides - will mirror each other and each can influence the other. This will also give the seekers a possibility to practice the tools they have learned during play. We use the word 'probably' here because there is no right or wrong solution for this sort of plot, only that the seekers make use of the lessons they have learned to solve the plot in a

way that makes narrative sense.

As this is a larp designed to teach the players tools to use stories to impact learning, it is important that the plot compliments the core experience rather than distract from it. Lumen is a larp about hope and transformation. We want the story to be that transformation is both something that is done together, that brings unity and growth and something that requires personal effort.

For some seekers their own journey will be enough: As any wider plot will be unimportant to them, said plot needs to be run in a way that is opt-in, rather than opt-out: For example, a plot that, if unresolved, would lead to the failure of the magic of Hope, is not opt-in, as it is too far reaching. Therefore, not all Guides should be at the end of their tenure.

For other seekers the plot will be fundamental to their experience, as many players find narrative fulfilment through the interaction with a wider story. Both approaches are valid. Your group of Guides needs to be aware of both and -- as NPCs -- create play for and facilitate both play preferences.

There is another reason why this larp needs a plot. It serves as a practical exam for everything that has been taught. It is not a pass/fail exam, but rather an opportunity for you to assess the learning of the players and to identify areas that they could follow up.

The plot needs to be understandable, accessible, scaleable, and resolvable. This means that participants need to be able to easily comprehend what is going on.

Plot high concept

The Guides are embodiments of divinity, they bring the magic to Hope with their bodies and their souls. The embodiment of divinity is taxing on the human body and mind, however. Although it is profound and meaningful, it also takes a toll. There is a limit to how long a Guide can channel divinity before they lose the connection to the gods, and some (not all) of the Guides at Lumen are nearing this point. Think of it like a metaphor for burnout: one can only go so long at this intensity level to awaken others before one needs to stop.

For some of the Guides, the time has to focus only on their own personal journey and not the Guides', and all of that is valid (as long as it does not derail the larp to a point where it becomes something like "stop the Gods" as that would be the wrong point to make).

Task for Guides

Before the larp begins, decide how far along the journey each of you are as Guides, and how you will show the players that some of you need guidance and help. Let the players ask questions and eek out what is going on slowly. This is how the players find out about the plot.

Remember that Lumen is a relatively short larp, so all players should have the option to hear about this plot by the end of day one. Remember also that Lumen is a larp that is predominantly about the individual seeker's transformational journey, so do not make the story about how the seekers help the Guides, but rather how everyone is on their own transformational journey.

Accessible

All players who want to be involved in the plot should be able to find out about it. It also needs to come out early enough for players to think about it, but not at a time that will affect their personal journey or learnings. We suggest planning when and in which scenes the Guides will reveal the information so you know it will spread through the player group. For instance, each Guide can be in charge of sharing part of the information to one group of players, making sure the information is spread during the first evening of play in different ways but with the same message.

Task for Guides

Make sure the plot is presented to all players. Go through each group and the schedule and find out which scenes should introduce the plot for which groups.

come to move on. But how will they find their new path? Will they pass on the channelling of the deity, or sever the connection? Will they stay at Hope as a kind of acolyte, assisting in running the place but excluded from the work with the deities? Will they leave and start a new life elsewhere? Or do they perhaps need to stay as a new generation of seekers, in order to figure out who they are and what they want to do at this new crossroads? The Guides will be Guided by the seekers in this at the same time as the seekers themselves learn about their own transformation.

This story is about transformation, sacrifice, joy and sharing. Is helping people and growth worth it even if there is a price to it? How do you come to terms with losing your path and finding a new one?

Understandable: How can the players impact the story?

In the larp, some of the Guides are at the beginning of their journey, and some are nearing the end. The seekers can choose to opt in and discover more of this, or to ignore it if it does not fit their story. Some seekers might decide to become Guides in order to take on You might

Scaleable

Not all Guides need to be reaching the end of their tenure. In fact, it should probably be limited to one or two in order to keep the focu have a run of Lumen where ALL the seekers want to be a part of the plot, conversely you may have a run where most or all of them are more interested in completing their own personal journeys. That is OK.

the channeling of the deity, some might offer comfort and love to a Guide embodying the divine for the last time, some might try to help the Guides find a new path, some might choose s of the transformational journey on the players rather than the NPCs. It should be possible to choose not to interact with this and focus on your own journey only. At the same time, this should be a larger echo of the journey each character is on.

It may be that it is not so easy to let go. Perhaps the Guides each have an unresolved issue that they need help with? Perhaps it can mirror the unresolved issues of the seekers? See what your player group is like and play with it.

Resolvable

Ultimately, Lumen is not a larp with a tragic ending. Whilst catharsis is powerful, character death or failure would break the model. The seekers will need to to find out what is going on, understand why the Guides can't continue channeling the divinities indefinitely, and then decide what to do next. We don't need a prescriptive 'right or wrong' solution to that "what to do next," but we do need to seed the problem and make sure that the answers to the "what is going on" question are consistent.

One thing we all know is that players will think of solutions that are different than what we imagine. That is part of the magic of larp! As long as they follow the general arc you want to convey (transformation is painful but meaningful and requires work from you but also connection and community); this is not a problem.

Tasks for the facilitator for the larp

As the facilitator you are responsible for ensuring that the plot is understood before the larp is run. Here are some concrete tasks you need to do before the larp begins:

* Share the plot with all the Guides ahead of time.
* When the Guides create their characters, they also need to decide how far along the journey they are and if they are nearing the end. Make sure not everyone is at the end or everyone is at the beginning.
* In collaboration with the Guides, decide which Guide will tell which group of players and when and how. It should be within the end of play on the first day, but not so early that the players have yet to start on their own transformational journey.

* If you notice during runtime that the story of the larp is about to go off the rails - if some seekers for instance is trying to figure out if the Gods are evil or to stop Lumen from functioning, the first step for you and the Guides will be to in-character remind the seekers of what the story is about and why they are here (personal growth, transformation, etc). If this does not work, then gently take them aside and remind them what the larp is about off-game and help them find a different path for their character journey.

Appendix Q — Dearest V Plot

In this letter a mysterious person who signs their name as M gives a hint that they have discovered some magical secret. In the letter they reveal this to V, but the letter is also a farewell as they are dying. And so our story begins with tragedy and loss even for the NPC -- V -- who is a part of Hope.

My Dearest V,

There are two secrets I kept from you in the years that we have known one another. The first, the one that you now know, is that I am dying. I told myself that it was right not to share that with you; we are all dying a little every day after all. I did not want you to grieve for me while I was still alive. Does that make sense? Perhaps you think it a betrayal, or a lack of trust, or perhaps that it was selfish? I wanted to remember your smile - always your smile, and the glow in your eyes that brought such joy, such love, and such peace to those around you, and especially to me.

I hope that you will find a space in your heart for forgiveness. You might regret not having the chance to say 'goodbye,' but I do not believe in goodbyes, only in saying thank you. The last time we spoke you whispered to me, "Thank you for being in my life," I could wish for no better parting words and they sustain me – even now – as I know my time will soon be over; by the time you read these words, I shall be at peace.

The other secret is a parting gift to you, and to yours. I had hoped to share this with you in person, but it was not to be, there is no time left for me. I have discovered something so profound that I hardly know how to describe it, but let me try as though you were sitting here with me now. There are different ideas that originate from the hearts of humanity. Yes, there is always

darkness, but it is insignificant next to the light that shines. I have found a way to call that light, my love. Whether it is The Divine, a shared consciousness, some spirit of universal love, or a perfect manifestation of poetry I cannot say. The work has only just begun and there is no time for me to finish it; that is for you to do now, and for you to bring

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Appendix R — Lumen Badges and Deity Cheat Sheet

On the following pages you will find the templates for the badges worn by the players, guides, safety team members and organisers, and a 'cheat sheet' to remind you about the various deities and the spheres of influence. You are welcome to print and use these.

Lumen

the journey to hope

Seeker

They/	She/	He/
Them	Her	Him

Lumen

the journey to hope

Organizer

They/ Them	She/ Her	He/ Him

Guide

They/	She/	He/
Them	Her	Him

Lumen

the journey to hope

Safety

They/	She/	He/
Them	Her	Him

Guide

They/	She/	He/
Them	Her	Him

- **Jupiter** - GOLD
  - Authority and Leadership
- **Juno** - SILVER
  - Righteousness and determination
- **Neptune** - NAVY BLUE
  - Emotional calm in the storm and adventurousness
- **Mars** - RED
  - Strength and protection in conflict
- **Minerva** - GREY or LIGHT BLUE
  - Wisdom and strategizing
- **Ceres** - LIGHT BROWN or BEIGE
  - Providing comfort and tending to growth
- **Apollo** - ORANGE
  - Foresight and clarity

- **Diana** - DARK BROWN
  - Advocacy and independence
- **Venus** - PINK
  - Magnetism (not coercive) and intimacy
- **Vulcan** - BRONZE
  - Alchemy from one state to another and forging creativity
- **Mercury**- YELLOW
  - Adaptability and mediation
- **Pluto** - BLACK
  - Accepting finality and acquiring abundance
- **Proserpina** - PURPLE
  - Processing grief and transitioning
- **Bacchus** - GREEN
  - Living in the present and letting go

Appendix S - Selection and Interview questions

In this appendix you will find the questions we asked candidates when they signed up for a place on the larp AND the interview questions that we asked people who got through the first round of the selection process.

Lumen Application Form

Welcome to the Lumen application form! Due to funding requirements through Erasmus+ and the educational nature of the larp, players will undergo a multi-stage application process. In this stage, players submit a written application describing their personal and professional interests in the larp's content. The goal of the process is to assemble a diverse player base who are committed to the transformative goals and are able to implement the curriculum in their own contexts around the world soon after the larp, thereby spreading this knowledge and practice. For more information, click here. By filling out this form, you are stating that you understand that your information will be securely stored using Google Drive's data security procedures and only used for the purposes of this edu-larp. Alternatively, you may email your responses to edge-speldesign@uu.se.

Email

Full Name

Pronouns

Date of Birth

Nationality

Country in which you are currently living

How would you rate your level of English

The working language of the event will be in English without possibility of permanent translation. Therefore, a good level of English (to be able to understand and to communicate) is required.

1-5 (Basic to Fluent)

Other details

Please include any other details about your cultural background you wish to share.

Motivation & Background

Are you currently part of an organization, e.g., a company, university, or NGO? List as many as you can think of and try not to overthink the question.

If yes, please describe briefly the main activities of your organisation and your role. Are you on the board? Are you a student, researcher, or teacher? Does your organization have a website/page/channel? Share it with us! (If not, type N/A.)

What is your connection to the topic(s) explored in this edu-larp? (e.g., transformation, community building, mental health, role-playing in education).

Please describe how you plan to use the experience and skills gained in this edu-larp in your professional, personal, or community context? (Type N/A if not applicable.)

Which groups, if any, do you plan to work with or engage after this experience using these skills? (e.g., young people, marginalized communities, educators, friends and family) (Type N/A if not applicable.)

Are you willing to personally and interpersonally explore serious themes related to the players' own lives, such as transformation, emotional growth, and community building in a group setting? (Goals can be related to emotional growth, skill training, community building, etc. You will choose your own goals.)

Yes/No

Describe a specific growth-related personal or professional goal you'd like to explore through your participation. Goals will help you focus your intention during play. You may change your goal later if needed (or have multiple goals). We can also help you set goals during the larp.

Have you participated in a larp or other role-playing experience before?

Yes/No

If yes, briefly describe your experience.

If not, have you engaged in adjacent related activities? Be specific. (Type N/A if not applicable.)

Do you have any accessibility needs to share? (e.g., mobility, sensory, dietary)

Do you have any triggers or topics you do not want to experience in the larp? If yes, please list them. You will also have the opportunity to share topics before the larp. (Type N/A if not applicable.)

Consent and Agreements

I have read and agree to abide by the Lumen's Code of Conduct.
Yes/No

I understand that my information will be securely stored using Google Drive's data security procedures and only used for the purposes of this edu-larp.
Alternatively, you may email your responses to edge-speldesign@uu.se.

Yes/No

Lumen may involve sensitive themes that require me to emotionally calibrate with other players. The edu-larp also encourages players to emotionally support one another. I understand that this edu-larp is not a form of therapy. I will advocate for myself during the larp with co-players and the safety team when possible.
Yes/No

Is there anything else you'd like to share with the organizers?

Lumen Interview Questions

Thank you for coming to the interview on such quick notice! The purpose of this meeting is to get to know those of you we don't know already. We would also like to hear more about your motivations and expectations from the game, so that we can arrive at a decision for the participants as fairly as possible. But even if you end up on the waiting list, I hope we can all also enjoy getting to know each other better, as building the wider community is important for us as well.

- Quick introductions: name/pronouns/current location
- What drew your interest in the larp?
- Tell us a bit about some of the target groups you would like to work with. How might this curriculum help you?
- How comfortable do you feel supporting other people in processing their personal issues during the larp, and possibly off-game?
- Do you have any questions for us?

PHOTOGRAPHS FROM LUMEN

Over the following pages you will see some photographs taken at the first run of Lumen.
These were taken by Camilla Missaglia and are included here to give you some visual inspiration for your own run of the game.

SAN FRANCESCO

This larp was created within Empowering Game Design Education with Transformative Roleplaying Games (EDGE), a joint Erasmus+ Higher Education Cooperation Partnership project in the Higher Education sector between Uppsala University, Dragons' Nest, Avalon Larp Studio, Chaos League, and Turku University of Applied Sciences. Project # 2023-1-SE01-KA220-HED-000153279. https://erasmusedge.eu/

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